A Boy in a Girl Parade Army

A cleaned and edited edition

Written by Yahya

Chapter 1

A Boy in a Girl Parade Army Chapter 1: The Beginning The First Day

In the morning, I woke up on the first day of school. I was still sleepy, but I knew I had to get ready. While I was preparing for school, my mom received an email. The email said that I was going to CIS Middle School JR. G. At first, I thought everything was normal. It was just another school, and I expected to have a regular first day, meet new classmates, attend lessons, and return home. I had no idea what was waiting for me. After getting ready, I left home and headed to school. When I finally arrived at CIS Middle School, I walked through the entrance and looked around. Then I stopped. Every person I could see was a girl.

I looked around again, thinking I might have entered the wrong school. But no, the school name was correct. I was definitely at CIS Middle School JR. G. I stood there for a moment, trying to understand what was happening. *Wait... why are there only girls here?* I continued walking, hoping there would be some boys inside the school. But as I walked farther into the building, I noticed something strange. Suddenly, everyone started looking at me. The girls turned their heads in my direction. Some whispered to their friends, while others stared at me with wide eyes. And then I noticed something even stranger. **They were blushing.** Almost every girl who looked at me seemed to have the same reaction.

Meanwhile, I was completely confused. *Why am I here?* I hadn't done anything special. I had literally just arrived at school! I continued walking, trying to ignore all the attention. The All-Girls School

As I explored the school, I began to realize that the situation was much worse than I had imagined. Everywhere I went, there were girls. The classrooms? Girls. The hallways? Girls. The cafeteria? Girls. Everywhere I looked, I saw girls. At this point, I started wondering whether I was actually the only boy in the entire school. Then I needed to find the bathroom. I looked around for the signs and tried to find a male bathroom.

But all I could find were girls' bathrooms. I looked again. Nothing. I walked a little farther, hoping there might be another bathroom somewhere else. Still nothing. I stood in the hallway, staring at the signs. *Please tell me there's at least ONE male bathroom in this entire school.* I sighed. *Am I seriously the only boy here?* I couldn't believe this was happening on my first day. I just wanted to attend school normally. Was that really too much to ask? The Classroom

Eventually, I made my way to my classroom.

I walked inside and looked around. Once again, every student was a girl. I found a seat and sat down, hoping that things would finally become normal. Unfortunately, I was completely wrong. As soon as I sat down, several girls started approaching me. "Can I sit beside you?" one girl asked. "No, I want to sit beside him!" another girl said. Before I could even respond, more girls started asking me the same question. I just stared at them. *What's going on? Why does everyone want to sit next to me?* Then the notes started arriving. One girl quietly passed me a folded piece of paper. I opened it.

It said: *I like you.* I stared at the note for a moment. Then I threw it into the trash. A little later, another girl passed me a note. I opened it. *I think you're cute.* Into the trash it went. Then another note arrived. And another. And another. Some girls kept passing me notes saying that they liked me, while others were trying to get my attention. I collected the notes and threw them into the trash. I wasn't interested in any of that. I was just trying to survive my first day of school.

Meanwhile, the girls continued whispering to one another and blushing whenever they looked at me. I leaned back in my chair and sighed. *I JUST WANT TO STUDY! WHY IS THIS HAPPENING TO ME?!* The Developer

Then I decided to open my laptop. Finally, something normal. I opened it and went straight to the website I was developing. I started looking through my project, checking my work and focusing on the code. For a few moments, I completely forgot about everything happening around me. Then a girl sitting nearby leaned toward me. "What are you doing?" "I'm developing a website," I answered. Her eyes widened. "Wait, you can make websites?"

Before I could reply, another girl turned around. "What kind of website are you making?" Then another girl asked, "Did you make it yourself?" And another one joined in. "Can I see it?" Within seconds, girls from all around the classroom were asking me questions. "What are you working on?" "How do you code?" "How did you learn to make websites?" "Can you teach me?" I looked at the girls surrounding my desk. Then I looked at my laptop. Then I looked at the code on my screen. *First, they were passing me notes saying they liked me. Now they're all interested in my coding?*

I turned back to my laptop and continued working. I just wanted to finish developing my website in peace. But with everyone asking questions, concentrating was becoming almost impossible. *BRO, CAN I JUST CODE?!* The Escape

Finally, after what felt like the longest school day of my life, the bell rang. **RIIIIING!** The moment I heard it, I closed my laptop, grabbed my bag, and rushed out of the classroom. I wasn't going to waste a single second. I hurried through the hallways, heading straight for the school entrance. I could already imagine the peaceful moment when I would finally reach my mom and go home. But then I heard voices behind me. "Yahya! Wait!"

I turned around. Several girls from my class were following me. I turned back and continued running. Then I heard even more voices. "YAHYA!" "WHERE ARE YOU GOING?" "WAIT FOR US!" I looked behind me again. More girls were following me! I couldn't believe it. *WHY ARE THEY FOLLOWING ME?! I JUST WANT TO GO HOME!* I rushed toward the school gates as quickly as I could. Then, finally, I spotted my mom waiting outside. "MOOOOOM!" I sprinted toward her as if my entire life

depended on it. My mom turned around, surprised to see me rushing toward her. "Yahya? Why are you running?" I reached her, trying to catch my breath. "Mom... we need to talk." Before she could ask what I meant, dozens of girls came out through the school gates behind me. "YAHYAAAA!" Some waved at me. Others called my name, while several were still blushing. I stared at them in disbelief. Then I slowly moved behind my mom. My mom looked at the girls. Then she looked at me. A smile appeared on her face. "Oh! Looks like you've made some friends already!"

I stared at her. *FRIENDS?! MOM, THIS IS A WHOLE ARMY!* One girl waved at me again. Another called my name. I couldn't take it anymore. "Mom, please. Can we just go home?" My mom laughed as she headed toward the car. I practically teleported into the passenger seat. As soon as I got inside, I looked through the window. The girls were still waving goodbye. I sank into my seat and covered my face with my hands. *Day One.* *I had survived exactly one day.* *And tomorrow, I had to go back.* I looked at the school one last time as my mom

drove away. I had arrived that morning expecting a normal school experience. Instead, I had discovered that I was surrounded by girls, couldn't find a male bathroom, received countless love notes, attracted an audience just by opening my laptop, and had to sprint to escape a crowd of girls after school. I leaned back in my seat. *What have I gotten myself into?* And that was only the beginning. **END OF CHAPTER 1.**

Chapter 2

A Boy in a Girl Parade Army Chapter 2: The Disaster The Second Day

The next morning, I woke up and prepared for school. After what had happened on my first day, I wasn't looking forward to returning to CIS Middle School JR. G. I got dressed, packed my bag, and grabbed my laptop. Before leaving, I looked at myself in the mirror. "Okay, Yahya. Today is going to be different." I nodded confidently. "Just go to class, focus on your work, and come home. Easy." I left the house and headed to school. When I arrived, I walked through the gates and made my way toward the lockers. For a few moments, everything seemed normal.

Then I noticed the girls looking at me again. Some whispered to their friends. Others smiled and blushed. I sighed. *Here we go again.* Suddenly, one girl approached me near the lockers. "Yahya!" I turned around. Before I could ask what she wanted, she cornered me near the lockers and leaned toward me, trying to kiss me. My eyes widened. *WHAT THE—?!* I quickly dodged to the side. She missed. "Wait!" she said. "Nope!" I replied, stepping away.

I tried to leave, but she followed me. Then she pulled out some lipstick and began applying it while watching me. I stared at her in disbelief. *Is she seriously preparing for another attempt?!* I turned and hurried down the hallway. She followed. I changed direction. She followed again. I walked faster. She walked faster too. Soon, other girls began approaching me, and I had to keep dodging them as they tried to get close enough to kiss me. Left. Right. Step backward.

Quick turn. I was dodging everything like I was playing a game on the hardest difficulty. *WHY DO I NEED BOSS-FIGHT REFLEXES JUST TO GET TO CLASS?!* I finally managed to put some distance between myself and the girls. I stopped and caught my breath. Then I looked back. They were still following me. One of them was even reapplying her lipstick! I stared at her. *THEY'RE PREPARING FOR ROUND TWO?!* I immediately hurried toward my classroom. All I wanted was to attend my lessons, work on my website, and have a normal school day. Apparently, that was too much to ask. The Longest School Day

I finally reached my classroom and sat down. I opened my laptop, hoping that working on my website would help me forget about the morning's chaos. I started looking through my code. For a little while, I managed to concentrate. But every time I looked up, I noticed girls staring at me or whispering to one another. I sighed and returned to my screen. *Focus, Yahya. You're here to study.* The lessons continued, and I did my best to get through the day. Eventually, I began counting down the minutes until the final bell. When it finally rang, I packed my laptop, grabbed my bag, and rushed out of the classroom. *FREEDOM!* I hurried through the hallways and headed toward the exit. But the moment I stepped outside, I saw the girls

again. The exact same thing that had happened that morning started happening all over again. "YAHYA! WAIT!" "WHERE ARE YOU GOING?" "COME TALK TO US!" I looked behind me. More and more girls were following me. I couldn't believe it. *NOT AGAIN!* I rushed toward my bicycle, climbed on, and started pedaling home. I wasn't going to stop. I wasn't going to turn around. I just wanted to reach my house, close the door, and enjoy some peace. I pedaled as fast as I safely could. Finally, I arrived home.

I parked my bicycle, rushed inside, and closed the front door. "YES! I MADE IT!" I dropped my bag and breathed a huge sigh of relief. "Finally. Peace and quiet." I walked farther into the house, already imagining myself sitting at my desk and developing my website. Then I heard the front door open. I slowly turned around. My eyes widened. **HOW WERE THEY HERE ALREADY?!** Somehow, the girls had arrived at my house. Before I could even figure out how they had gotten there, they entered and surrounded me. I looked left. Girls.

I looked right. More girls. I looked behind me. Even more girls. I was completely surrounded in my own house! *NAH. THIS HAS TO BE A GLITCH IN THE MATRIX.* The Girlfriend Question

Just then, my mom walked into the room. She looked at the crowd of girls surrounding me. Then she looked at me. Then she looked back at the girls. She raised an eyebrow. "Yahya, who are all these girls?" I opened my mouth. "Mom, I can explain—" She suddenly smiled.

"Wait a minute! Which one of you is Yahya's girlfriend?" For one second, the room went silent. Then— **EVERY SINGLE GIRL RAISED HER HAND.** "ME!" "ME TOO!" "I AM!" "HE'S MY BOYFRIEND!" I stared at them in complete disbelief. My mom looked delighted. I looked at the girls. Then at my mom. Then back at the girls. My brain had officially stopped working. "WHAT?!" I threw my hands into the air.

"**NO! GET THE FUCK OUT OF HERE!**" The entire room went silent for a moment. I pointed toward the front door. "I DON'T EVEN KNOW HALF OF YOU! WHY ARE YOU ALL CLAIMING TO BE MY GIRLFRIENDS?!" Some girls blushed, while others started talking among themselves. I couldn't take it anymore. "NOPE! I'M DONE! I JUST WANT TO BE LEFT ALONE!" I tried to make my way out of the crowd. My mom was still trying not to laugh. I picked up my bag and hurried toward my bedroom. I closed the door and leaned against it. Finally, I could breathe. I sat at my desk, opened my laptop, and returned to my website. *Please. Let me have at least five minutes of peace.*

But my peace didn't last long. The Bedroom Disaster

I had barely started working when— **BANG!** My bedroom door slammed open. I nearly jumped out of my chair. Standing in the doorway was my mom. Behind her were the girls. I stared at the crowd. *YOU HAVE GOT TO BE KIDDING ME.* My mom stepped inside. "Yahya, we need to talk." "About WHAT?!" I asked. Before she could answer, I heard another voice coming from downstairs. "I'm home!"

I froze. **MY DAD.** Slowly, I turned toward the doorway. My dad appeared and looked into my bedroom. He noticed my mom. Then he noticed the crowd of girls. Then he looked at me. "... Yahya?" "Hi, Dad." He pointed toward the girls. "Why are there so many girls in our house?" I opened my mouth. Closed it. Opened it again. "I HAVE NO IDEA!" One girl raised her hand.

"I'm Yahya's girlfriend!" "ME TOO!" another shouted. "AND ME!" "ME AS WELL!" Once again, the girls were claiming to be my girlfriends. My dad stared at them in complete silence. My mom was struggling not to laugh. I slowly covered my face with both hands. *Oh no. Here we come.* My dad crossed his arms. "Yahya, would you care to explain what's happening?" "DAD, I LITERALLY JUST WENT TO SCHOOL!" One girl smiled at him. "We really like your son!" My dad looked at me again.

I pointed desperately toward my laptop. "I WAS DEVELOPING A WEBSITE! THAT'S ALL I DID!" He glanced at the screen, then at the girls. Finally, he sighed. "Son, it's been two days." "I KNOW!" "Two days." "I KNOW, DAD!" "And somehow, our house is full of your classmates." I threw my hands into the air. "THAT'S WHAT I'VE BEEN TRYING TO TELL EVERYONE!" My mom finally burst out laughing. My dad rubbed his forehead. Meanwhile, the girls continued whispering among themselves. I turned toward my laptop and hoped that if I ignored the situation long enough, it might

disappear. *I need a new school.* *I need a new house.* *I need a new planet.* I looked at my dad. "Can I please just finish my website?" He stared at me for a moment. Then he looked at the crowd again. "... We definitely need to talk." I leaned back in my chair. *IT'S OVER. I'M FINISHED.* 9:00 PM — The Family Meeting

Finally, at 9:00 PM, the house was clean again. After what felt like an entire war, we had finally managed to get all the girls out of the house. I was exhausted.

My laptop was sitting on my desk, my bag was still lying on the floor, and I had barely made any progress on my website. I walked into the living room, where my mom and dad were waiting. Dad looked at me. "Son, sit down. We need to talk." I sat on the sofa. Mom sat beside him. For a few seconds, nobody said anything. Then Dad finally spoke. "Yahya, what exactly happened today?" I took a deep breath. "Dad, I went to school. That's literally all I did." Mom raised an eyebrow. "And all those girls?" "I DON'T KNOW!"

Dad leaned back. "Apparently, every girl in your class claims she's your girlfriend." I stared at him. "DAD, I THREW THEIR NOTES IN THE TRASH! I NEVER SAID ANYONE WAS MY GIRLFRIEND!" Mom tried to hide her smile. "So you're saying none of them are your girlfriends?" "YES! NONE!" I threw my hands into the air. "I DON'T EVEN KNOW HALF OF THEIR NAMES!" Dad nodded slowly. "Okay. Calm down. We're listening." I took another breath. "First, I arrived at school, and everyone was a girl. Then everyone started staring at me and blushing. In class, girls kept asking to sit beside me and passing me notes. When I opened my laptop to work on my website, the whole class

started asking me questions." Mom listened carefully. "And then?" she asked. "Then, after school, they followed me! I rushed home on my bicycle, thinking I'd finally get some peace. BUT SOMEHOW, THEY SHOWED UP AT OUR HOUSE!" Dad rubbed his forehead. "And the kissing?" I immediately sat up. "THEY KEPT TRYING TO KISS ME! I DODGED THEM! I DIDN'T WANT THAT!" My dad's expression became serious. "Listen, son. You have every right to decide who gets close to you. If you don't want someone kissing you, they need to respect that." Mom nodded. "And nobody should be following you home or entering our house without permission. We'll make sure that doesn't happen again." I finally relaxed a little.

"Thank you." Dad looked at me. "Tomorrow, we'll contact the school and find out what's going on." I blinked. "Really?" "Really," he replied. "You're there to learn, not to spend your entire day trying to escape a crowd." For the first time all evening, I felt like someone actually understood me. Then Mom asked one final question. "So... what about your website?" I froze. "My WHAT?" "Your website. You said you were developing one." I slowly looked toward my bedroom. My laptop was waiting.

My code was unfinished. My progress was practically zero. I stood up. "GOOD NIGHT, EVERYONE. I HAVE WORK TO DO." Dad laughed. "At least somebody in this house has their priorities straight." I rushed back to my room, opened my laptop, and returned to my project. Finally. Peace. I started typing. *Tomorrow, I'm going to school, attending my lessons, and coming straight home.* *No distractions.* *No chaos.* *No disasters.*

I nodded confidently at the screen. "Day three is going to be normal." I had absolutely no idea how wrong I was. **END OF CHAPTER 2.**

Chapter 3

A Boy in a Girl Parade Army Chapter 3: The Next Disaster — But Better 8:00 AM — The One-Dollar Incident

I arrived at school that morning, hoping that Day Three would finally be normal. After everything that had happened during the previous two days, I just wanted to attend my lessons, work on my website, and go home without having to deal with another disaster. Was that really too much to ask? Apparently, yes. I walked into the classroom, put my bag beside my desk, and took out my wallet. Inside was one dollar. Just one dollar. I looked at it for a moment before putting it on my desk. Big mistake. A girl sitting nearby noticed the money.

"Yahya, is that your money?" I looked at her. "Yeah? Why?" She smiled and immediately took out her lunch money. "Here! You can have mine!" I blinked. "Wait, what?" Before I could even react, another girl walked over. "Yahya, take mine too!" Then another girl approached. "Mine as well!" Within seconds, girls were walking toward my desk, offering me their lunch money. I stared at the growing pile of cash. Then I stared at my original dollar.

Then I stared at the girls. **Me:** "BRO, I DON'T NEED ALL THAT!" Nobody seemed to understand what I was saying. One girl placed her money on my desk. Another carefully put hers beside my laptop. A third girl asked, "Is this enough, or do you want more?" I nearly fell out of my chair. "MORE?! WHY WOULD I WANT MORE?!" I had brought one dollar to school. ONE. And somehow, I was now running an unofficial financial institution. I hadn't even finished taking out my books. 8:15 AM — THE BANK OPENS

I tried to return the money. "Here, take yours back."

I handed one girl her money. She looked disappointed. "But I wanted you to have it." "WHY?!" "Because I wanted to!" I turned toward another girl. "Please take your money back." She shook her head. "No, Yahya. It's yours." "IT WAS NEVER MINE IN THE FIRST PLACE!" At this point, I began to suspect that nobody in this school understood the concept of personal finance. Then I noticed something even worse. Girls were lining up beside my desk. There was an actual queue. I slowly turned my head toward it.

One girl was standing at the back, holding her lunch money with both hands. I pointed at the line. "WHY IS THERE A QUEUE?!" The girl at the front smiled. "We're waiting for our turn." "YOUR TURN FOR WHAT?!" "To give you our money!" I stared at her in complete silence. My brain had officially stopped working. **Me, internally:** *I NEED AN ADULT. NO, WAIT. I NEED AN ECONOMIST.* Then another girl raised her hand. "Yahya, do you accept coins?" I slammed my hands onto the desk. "THIS IS NOT A BANK! I DON'T HAVE OPENING HOURS! I DON'T HAVE A CUSTOMER SERVICE DEPARTMENT! AND I DEFINITELY DON'T HAVE A MONEY-DEPOSIT SYSTEM!"

The classroom went quiet for approximately two seconds. Then somebody asked: "So... can we still give you the money?" I buried my face in my hands. 8:30 AM — THE TEACHER DISCOVERS THE CRISIS

Just when I thought things couldn't get any worse, the classroom door opened. Our teacher walked in. "Good morning, everyone." "Good morning, Miss!" I raised my head slowly. The teacher walked toward her desk, stopped halfway, and looked at the enormous amount of money scattered across mine. She blinked. Then she looked at the queue. Then she looked at me.

"Yahya." I sat up straight. "Yes, Miss?" "Would you care to explain why half the class is standing around your desk with money?" I took a deep breath. "Miss, I brought one dollar." She stared at me. "One dollar?" "YES, MISS!" "And this happened because you brought one dollar?" "I DON'T KNOW, MISS! I JUST GOT HERE!" A girl near the front raised her hand. "Miss, we just want to give Yahya our lunch money." The teacher looked even more confused. "But why?"

The girl smiled. "Because it's Yahya!" I slowly turned toward the window. *Please let me teleport. Please let me teleport right now.* The teacher rubbed her forehead. "Everyone, put your money away. Yahya does not need your lunch money." Finally. Someone with common sense. I nodded gratefully. "THANK YOU, MISS!" The girls began collecting their money. I watched as the pile on my desk slowly disappeared. My dollar remained exactly where I had left it. I picked it up and put it safely inside my wallet.

Then I zipped the wallet shut. Then I put it inside my bag. Then I zipped my bag shut. I was taking absolutely no chances. 10:30 AM — RECESS: WHERE IS THE FOOTBALL

FIELD?! After surviving the one-dollar incident, I finally made it to recess. For once, I was actually excited. I reached into my bag and pulled out my football and boots. Finally. Something normal. I had my football, my boots, and some free time. I could finally play football instead of dealing with girls trying to give me their lunch money. I put on my boots, picked up the ball, and walked outside. Then I looked around. I saw students talking, girls sitting together,

and people walking around the school. But something was missing. I looked to my left. Nothing. I looked to my right. Still nothing. I walked a little farther and searched the area. Then I stopped. **THERE WAS NO FOOTBALL FIELD.** I stood there, holding my ball, trying to process what I had just discovered. I looked down at my boots. Then at my football. Then back at the school. "Wait a minute." I turned around and looked everywhere again. "WHERE IS THE FOOTBALL FIELD?!"

A girl nearby looked at me. "What football field?" I slowly turned toward her. "THE FOOTBALL FIELD! YOU KNOW, THE PLACE WHERE PEOPLE PLAY FOOTBALL?!" She shook her head. "We don't have one." I froze. For a few seconds, I said absolutely nothing. **Me, internally:** *Nah. There's no way. This school has classrooms, computers, a cafeteria, and apparently an entire financial system built around me—but NO FOOTBALL FIELD?!* I looked at the ball in my hands. I had brought everything I needed. My boots? Check. My football? Check. My excitement? Gone.

I had prepared for a football session, and the school had prepared absolutely nothing for football. I sighed and looked up at the sky. "First, I get chased around the school. Then everyone tries to give me money. Now there's no football field." I shook my head. "What kind of school is this?!" The girl beside me glanced at my football. "So... can you teach us how to play?" I slowly looked at her. I had a feeling that my peaceful recess was about to become another disaster. 10:35 AM — THE GIRLS WANT A FOOTBALL

MASTERCLASS I was still standing there, holding my football and wondering how a school could possibly have no football field, when I noticed something strange. The girls were looking at me.

Again. I looked behind me. Nobody. I looked to the sides. Nobody else was holding a football. I slowly turned back. "Oh, no." Before I could even think about leaving, the girls began gathering around me. One stood to my left. Another stood to my right. Then more arrived until I was completely surrounded. I looked around at the circle of girls. "Bro, what now?" One of them pointed at my football. "Yahya, teach us a crazy football move!"

Another girl immediately joined in. "Yeah! Teach us one of your special moves!" "I want to learn a skill that nobody else can do!" "Teach us something legendary!" I stared at them. I had brought my football because I wanted to play. Now I was apparently expected to become an entire football academy during recess. "GUYS, I HAVEN'T EVEN FOUND A FOOTBALL FIELD!" They ignored that little detail. "PLEASE, YAHYA!" "JUST ONE MOVE!" "SHOW US YOUR BEST TECHNIQUE!" I sighed. There was no escaping this.

I placed the football on the ground and stepped back. "Fine. You want to see a crazy move?" Every girl immediately became quiet. I looked down at the ball. Then I remembered something. A move I had invented myself. A technique that combined quick footwork, lightning-fast changes of direction, and a phantom-like feint designed to confuse anyone trying to predict where the ball would go. I smirked. "All right." I positioned

my feet beside the ball. "But don't blame me if your brains need a software update afterward." One girl tilted her head. "What does that mean?" I raised my eyes.

"**DOMAIN EXPANSION… INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM.**" 10:37 AM — DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE

INSTINCT PHANTOM For one second, everything was silent. Then I moved. My right foot rolled the ball sideways. Before anyone could follow its direction, I shifted my weight and pulled it back with my other foot. I added a quick stepover, changed direction, and flicked the ball across my body. Then came the final feint. I moved as if I were going left— —but the ball went right. I accelerated after it, caught up with it, and finished the combination with a sharp turn that sent the ball rolling neatly back to my feet. I stopped it beneath my boot.

Perfect control. No wasted movement. I stood there with my arms slightly outstretched. "That's the Infinite Instinct Phantom." I looked at the girls. "Basically, you make your opponent believe you're going one way, then you go the other way before they can react." Silence. Complete silence. One girl blinked. "WAIT. WHERE DID THE BALL GO?!" I pointed at the ball under my foot. "Right here." Another girl stared at me. "DO IT AGAIN!" "AGAIN!"

"TEACH US!" Within seconds, the entire circle erupted. I took one step backward. "Hold on! I said I'd show you the move, not start a twelve-week training course!" One girl was already trying to copy my footwork. She stepped over an imaginary ball, turned around, and nearly walked in the opposite direction. I pressed my lips together, trying not to laugh. "Close enough." "YAHYA, TEACH ME THE PHANTOM PART!" "HOW DO YOU MOVE THE BALL THAT FAST?!" "CAN YOU TEACH ME THE DOMAIN EXPANSION?!" I stared at the crowd. "THE DOMAIN EXPANSION IS JUST THE NAME!" Nobody listened. They were too busy asking me to demonstrate it

again. I picked up my football and hugged it against my side. "Bro. I came here to play football." One girl smiled. "And now you're our football teacher!" I slowly looked toward the sky. "Somebody get me out of this school." Then the recess bell rang. I had never been so grateful to hear a bell in my entire life. I grabbed my boots, picked up my bag, and started walking toward class. Behind me, I heard one final shout. "YAHYA! NEXT RECESS, TEACH US YOUR NEXT DOMAIN EXPANSION!" I stopped walking. Slowly, I turned my head.

"My NEXT WHAT?!" The girls waved excitedly. I faced forward again and continued walking. **Me, internally:** *I'm never bringing a football to school again.* Then I glanced down at the ball in my hands. A tiny smile appeared on my face. *Actually... maybe I will.* After all, it wasn't every day you invented a football move that made an entire classroom demand a masterclass. But next time? I was bringing a contract. And charging tuition. 3:00 PM — OPERATION: GET OUT OF THIS SCHOOL

Finally, the school day was over. I packed my laptop, put my books in my bag, grabbed my football, and got ready to leave.

I had survived the one-dollar incident. I had survived the missing football field. I had even demonstrated my newly invented move, **Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom**, to an entire crowd of girls. Honestly, I thought I deserved a medal. But there was one problem. Yesterday. I remembered exactly what had happened yesterday. The girls had followed me after school, and some had tried to kiss me even though I kept dodging them. Somehow, they had even managed to show up at my house. I was NOT letting that happen again. I looked toward the school gates. Then I looked behind me. A few girls were still talking near the classroom. I immediately tightened the straps of my

backpack. **Me, internally:** *Okay, Yahya. Stay calm. Walk normally. Don't attract attention. Get to the exit. Go home. Open your laptop. CODE.* I took one step. Then another. I was almost at the corridor when I heard a voice behind me. "Yahya!" I froze. **Me, internally:** *NO.* I turned around slowly. Three girls were walking toward me. One waved. Another smiled. The third called my name again. I immediately turned forward. "Nope."

I started walking faster. Then faster. Then I heard footsteps behind me. "YAHYA, WAIT!" I looked over my shoulder. More girls were coming. **Me:** "BRO, WHY IS THERE ALWAYS A SECOND WAVE?!" I picked up the pace. My football was tucked under one arm, my backpack was bouncing against my shoulders, and I was heading toward the exit like I had just received a mission from the president. **MISSION OBJECTIVE: REACH THE SCHOOL GATES.** **SECONDARY OBJECTIVE: AVOID ANOTHER CHASE.** **FAILURE CONDITION: YESTERDAY REPEATS ITSELF.** I could practically hear boss music playing in my head.

I finally reached the gates. Freedom was right there. I stepped outside and looked back. The girls were still inside the school grounds, calling my name. I breathed a huge sigh of relief. "Finally." I turned around and started heading home. Then I remembered something. Yesterday, I had thought I was safe too. I stopped walking. Slowly, I looked over my shoulder again. **Me:** "Wait a minute..." I scanned the area. Nobody was immediately beside me. Nobody was grabbing my arm. Nobody was trying to kiss me.

For once, I had a little space to myself. I adjusted my backpack and continued walking, keeping my eyes open and hoping nobody would follow me home again. **Me, internally:** *Today, I'm going straight home. Nobody's coming inside. Nobody's chasing me. And nobody is touching me without my permission.* I nodded confidently. "Easy." Then I remembered the girls' reaction to my football move. I remembered the money. I remembered yesterday. My confidence disappeared. "Actually, I'm never saying anything is easy again." I hurried home, determined to enjoy the one thing I had been fighting for all day. Peace.

My laptop was waiting. My website was unfinished. And for once, I just wanted to get home without another disaster. 3:30 PM — SHE SHOWED UP AT MY HOUSE?!

I finally made it home. I had escaped the school gates, avoided the chasing crowd, and made it all the way back without anyone trying to kiss me. For the first time all day, I could finally relax. I threw my bag onto my bed, put my football beside my desk, and opened my laptop. "Finally," I whispered. "Peace and quiet." I started working on my website. For about five minutes, everything was perfect. Then the doorbell rang. I stopped typing.

Ding dong. I looked at the door. "Who's that?" I wasn't expecting anyone. I walked over and opened it. And then— **I SAW HER.** One of the girls from school was standing right outside my house. I stared at her. She smiled and waved. "Hi, Yahya!" I stood completely still. My brain needed approximately three business days to process what I had just witnessed. Then I finally reacted. **Me:** "FAHHHHHHHHHH?! "

I looked behind her. Then down the street. Then back at her. "HOW?!" She tilted her head. "What do you mean?" "WHAT DO YOU MEAN, WHAT DO I MEAN?! YOU'RE AT MY HOUSE!" She smiled again. "I wanted to see you!" I took one step backward. **Me, internally:** *BRO. I ESCAPED THE SCHOOL. I ESCAPED THE CORRIDORS. I ESCAPED THE FOOTBALL ACADEMY THAT I NEVER AGREED TO TEACH. HOW DID THE MISSION FOLLOW ME HOME?!* I glanced toward my bedroom. My laptop was still open. My website was waiting.

My peace had officially been deleted. "FAHHHHHHHHHHH!" The girl looked confused. "Yahya, are you okay?" I pointed toward the street. "HOW DID YOU EVEN FIND MY HOUSE?!" I couldn't believe it. I had spent the entire day trying to avoid another chase, and somehow, a girl had appeared at my front door like a

surprise character in a game. **Me, internally:** *DAY THREE IS WORSE THAN DAY TWO. WHO DESIGNED THIS GAME?!* I took a deep breath. "Listen, I need you to understand something. I want to go home after school, work on my website, and play football. I don't want people following me home without permission." I made sure to keep the doorway clear and called for my parents.

Because seriously, I was thirteen. I wasn't running a school fan club from my bedroom. I looked at the girl one more time. Then I looked toward the ceiling. **Me:** "FAHHHHHHHHHH. " At this point, I wasn't even asking for a normal school day anymore. I just wanted one uninterrupted coding session. Was that too much to ask? Apparently, in my life, it was. I glanced at my laptop one last time. My website was still unfinished. My football was sitting beside my desk. My one dollar was safely in my wallet. And my school problems had somehow followed me all the way home. I shook my head. "Tomorrow," I whispered, "I'm bringing absolutely nothing to school." Then I paused. "Wait. They'll probably find a way to turn my empty pockets into another disaster." I closed my laptop halfway and sighed. **Day Three was officially over.** And somehow, I already knew that Day Four wasn't going to be normal either. **END OF CHAPTER 3.**

Chapter 4: FIRST KISS

The day Yahya finally stopped running away… and the girl with pink braids changed everything. 7:00 AM — The Developer Has a Problem I woke up and stared at the ceiling. Today was the day. The day I was supposed to see Lara again. I grabbed my phone and checked the time. 7:00 AM. "Okay, Yahya. Calm down. You're just going to school." I got out of bed and started getting ready. But my brain had other plans. What do I say to her? Do I wave? Do I say good morning? What if I accidentally say something completely stupid? I stopped brushing my teeth. "BRO. WHY AM I OVERTHINKING A NORMAL CONVERSATION?!" I'd spent days escaping an entire school full of girls. I'd invented Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom on a football field that didn't even exist. Yet the thought of seeing one girl had me fighting for my life before breakfast. I was finished. Absolutely finished.

I packed my schoolbag, grabbed my things, and headed downstairs. Today, I had two missions: - Mission 1: Survive school. - Mission 2: Talk to Lara without embarrassing myself. Difficulty level: Impossible. 7:45 AM — The Girl with Pink Braids I arrived at CIS Middle School JR. G. For once, I walked through the gates without immediately searching for an escape route. Then I saw her. Lara. Her pink hair was styled into those perfect braids again. Somehow, they looked even better than I remembered. I stopped walking. There she is. For a moment, all the chaos of the previous days disappeared from my mind. No girls demanding my lunch money. No interrogation squads asking why I liked Lara. No surprise visitors at my house. Just Lara. I walked toward her, trying to look confident. Inside my head, however, an entire emergency meeting was taking place. BRAIN: Say something normal. HEART: SHE'S HERE! BRAIN: I SAID SOMETHING NORMAL! HEART: SHE'S GOT PINK BRAIDS, BRO! I finally reached her.

"Hey, Lara…" Before I could say anything else, she surprised me. She kissed me. I froze. MY ENTIRE OPERATING SYSTEM CRASHED. I had imagined a thousand different ways this morning might go. Not one of them had involved Lara making the first move before I could finish saying hello. I stood there, completely stunned. WAIT. DID THAT ACTUALLY JUST HAPPEN? 7:46 AM — The Unexpected First Kiss I looked at Lara, still trying to process what had happened. I'd spent the previous night thinking about her. I'd worried about what to say, how to act, and whether tomorrow would be awkward. Now the moment was actually happening. And despite my nervousness, there was something I knew. I liked Lara. And she had told me she liked me too. So, when we both wanted to continue, I kissed her back. For those few moments, I stopped worrying about what everyone thought. I wasn't trying to impress her. I wasn't performing a football trick. I wasn't escaping from a crowd. I was simply sharing a moment with someone I

genuinely liked. And then I discovered something unbelievable. THE KISS LASTED FIVE WHOLE MINUTES. Five minutes! BRO, THAT WAS LONGER THAN SOME OF MY CODING SESSIONS BEFORE I GOT DISTRACTED! And the entire school seemed to be watching. 7:51 AM — THE AUDIENCE DISCOVERS THE PLOT When Lara and I finally separated, I looked around. Every girl was staring. Every. Single. One. For a few seconds, nobody said anything. Then the school exploded. "FIVE MINUTES?!" "YAHYA AND LARA?!" "WHY HER?!" "WHAT ABOUT ME?!" "HOW DID THIS EVEN HAPPEN?!" One girl stared at us as if she'd just watched the biggest plot twist in television history. Another looked at Lara's pink braids, then at me, then back at Lara. Someone whispered, "She actually did it." I stood there, blinking. Bro. I came here to attend lessons. HOW DID MY MORNING BECOME A LIVE ROMANCE FINALE?! I had spent the previous days dodging girls who tried to kiss me without asking. Now I had shared a kiss with someone I actually

liked, and somehow the entire school had turned into an audience. The difference mattered to me. I hadn't chosen Lara because she was chasing me. I hadn't chosen her because she was competing with the other girls. I

liked her because she was Lara. And the other girls were going to have to accept that my feelings weren't a competition. 8:00 AM — Yaya's Brain Has Left the Building

The first bell rang. Nobody moved immediately. I looked at Lara. Then I looked at the crowd. Then I looked at Lara again. My brain attempted to form a sentence. Nothing happened. I tried again. Still nothing. Yahya, SAY SOMETHING! I finally managed to think clearly enough to realize that I was smiling. I was nervous, sure. But I was happy, too. Lara had surprised me in a way I never expected, and the morning had become something I would remember for a long time. Meanwhile, my imaginary anime narrator was working overtime. "After surviving countless days of chaos, the legendary Yahya had finally encountered an

opponent he didn't wish to defeat." "Her name was Lara." "Her weapon was a pair of perfect pink braids." "And her special ability was bypassing Yahya's entire defensive system in a single move." SPECIAL MOVE UNLOCKED: PINK-BRAID SURPRISE. 8:05 AM — The Jealousy Arc Begins As we headed toward class, I could practically feel the other girls' eyes following us. Yesterday, they'd questioned me after school. Why Lara? Why not me? Today, they had witnessed us sharing our first kiss. I could already imagine the questions waiting for me. "Yahya, why do you like her?" "Are you two together now?" "Does this mean you won't talk to anyone else?" I sighed. Here we go again. I wasn't going to be mean to anyone, but I wasn't going to change my feelings just to make everyone happy. I could be friendly with people without liking them romantically. And I could like Lara without turning the whole school into a competition. That seemed pretty reasonable to me. Unfortunately, CIS Middle School JR. G. had apparently banned reasonable behavior. 8:15 AM — The Girl I Actually Wanted to See We reached the classroom.

I opened my bag and took out my laptop. My website was waiting for me. My code was waiting for me. My projects were waiting for me. And yet, for once, I didn't immediately start typing. I glanced toward Lara. Her pink braids caught my attention again. I remembered the previous evening, when I'd spent hours trying to work while thinking about her. Now she was right there. I shook my head with a small smile. Yaya, you've got work to do. I opened my project. Then I glanced at Lara again. BRO. FOCUS. I returned to my screen. At least I was trying. And that was progress. 3:00 PM — The School's Biggest Headline By the time school ended, I knew one thing. There was no way the other girls had forgotten what they'd witnessed that morning. I packed my laptop, put on my backpack, and prepared for the usual escape mission. But this time, I wasn't running away from Lara. I wanted to see her again. That was the strange part. A few days earlier, I'd been desperate to get away from everyone. I'd rushed home on my bicycle, hoping to work on my website and play football in peace.

Now, I was looking forward to seeing one person. One person out of an entire school. I still wanted my personal space. I still wanted to code. I still wanted an actual football field. But I also wanted to get to know Lara better. And I knew that five minutes of kissing didn't mean we suddenly knew everything about each other. There would be plenty of time to talk, laugh, and figure out what being together might mean for us. For now, I was happy to take it one day at a time. I stepped outside and looked toward the school gates. My imaginary narrator spoke one final time. "The boy who had spent his days escaping the girl parade army had finally found someone he wanted to walk beside." "But with an entire school watching, the next chapter promised more chaos than ever." I adjusted my backpack. "Tomorrow," I said. Then I smiled.

End Of Chapter 4 — First Kiss

Chapter 5: The New Boy — A Warning from Yaya

One boy had survived the chaos. Then another arrived. 3:15 PM — One Name, One Girl After the most unforgettable morning of my life, I was finally walking with Lara. The whole school was still talking about our five-minute first kiss. Girls were whispering in the hallways. Others were staring at us like we'd just become the main characters of the most popular romance anime in history. Honestly, I just wanted to get through the day. I turned toward Lara. "Hey, Lara?" She looked at me. "Yeah?" "There's something I want you to call me." She tilted her head curiously. "Don't call me Yahya. Call me Yaya." I smiled. "That's what I prefer." Lara smiled back. And just like that, she'd learned something special about me. But the girls standing nearby had heard everything. "WAIT! SHE GETS TO CALL HIM YAYA?!" "WHY DOES SHE GET A SPECIAL NAME?!" "I'VE BEEN CALLING HIM YAHYA THIS WHOLE TIME!"

"THIS IS UNFAIR!" I slowly turned toward them. "Guys. It's literally a nickname." Nobody listened. One girl stared at Lara as if she'd just received VIP access to the entire universe. Another whispered, "First the kiss, now the nickname?!" I rubbed my forehead. Bro, what's next? Are they going to get jealous because she knows my favorite programming language? Lara and I continued walking. I wasn't about to stop using my preferred nickname because the entire school had declared it an international emergency. Yaya was Yaya. And Lara could call me that. The Next Morning — A New Player Enters the Server

The next day, I arrived at CIS Middle School JR. G. My objectives were simple. - Attend class. - Work on my website. - Avoid unnecessary drama. - Hopefully see Lara. A perfectly reasonable plan. Then I noticed something unusual. There was a new boy. I stopped walking. Wait. Another boy?

He stood in the school hallway looking around, probably trying to figure out where he was supposed to go. Then the girls noticed him. One approached. Then another. Then three more. Within moments, a crowd had formed around him. "What's your name?" "Which class are you in?" "Can I sit beside you?" "Do you play football?" I watched the situation develop. My eyes widened. No way. THEY WERE DOING IT AGAIN. The new boy looked increasingly confused as more girls gathered around him. I knew that expression. I'd worn it myself five days earlier. I slowly walked toward him. Poor guy. He has no idea what he's signed up for. 8:10 AM — Yaya's Survival Briefing I finally reached him. "Bro." He turned toward me. "Yeah?" "Listen carefully. I'm going to tell you something important." He looked confused. "Okay…?"

I glanced at the crowd surrounding him. "You're new here, right?" He nodded. "Then you need to understand something about this school." I gestured toward the girls. "They might follow you around, constantly ask for your attention, and make your entire day chaotic." He looked at the crowd again. "Wait, seriously?" I nodded. "Bro, I'm telling you from experience." I pointed toward the classroom. "Don't be surprised if you can't eat lunch in peace. Don't be surprised if everyone wants to sit next to you. And if you want personal space, make that clear." He stared at me. I continued. "And whatever happens, don't let anyone pressure you into anything you're uncomfortable with. You decide who you like." He nodded slowly. I crossed my arms. "Welcome to CIS Middle School JR. G." Then I gave him the most serious look of my life. "Good luck, bro." 8:15 AM — "BRO, WHAT HAPPENED TO YOU?" The new boy looked at me. "Wait. What happened to you? Why are you acting

like you've survived a war?" I stared at him. Then I looked at the girls. Then back at him. I took a deep breath. "OH MY GOD, BRO. IT ALL STARTED FIVE DAYS AGO." He raised an eyebrow. "Five days?" I nodded slowly. "Five. Whole. Days." He waited for me to explain. I looked into the distance like a veteran remembering the most ridiculous battle in history. "Okay, bro. You're about to hear the craziest story of your life." Unfortunately, the girls were still trying to talk to him. "Actually, forget finding somewhere to sit. Just listen." I began my story. Day One — The School That Made No Sense "It started when I woke up one

morning, thinking I was going to a normal school." The new boy nodded. "My mom got an email saying I was going to CIS Middle School JR. G. I thought nothing of it." "Reasonable," he said. "EXACTLY! Then I arrived." I pointed around the school. "Bro. EVERYONE WAS A GIRL." His eyes widened.

I continued. "Girls everywhere. Classrooms? Girls. Cafeteria? Girls. I was looking for a male bathroom and questioning every decision that had led me there." The new boy slowly looked around. "Wait…" "YES, BRO. WAIT." I explained how the girls wanted to sit beside me, passed me notes, and constantly asked what I was doing on my laptop. "And when school ended? I ran to my mom like my life depended on it." He stared at me. "That was day one?" "THAT WAS DAY ONE!" Day Two — The Great Escape "Day two was worse." I told him how girls tried to kiss me, how I dodged them, and how I rushed home on my bicycle. He interrupted. "Wait. They followed you home?" "YES!" I threw my hands up. "They somehow showed up at my house! My mom asked who my girlfriend was, and every single girl raised her hand!" The new boy covered his mouth. "I told them to leave, and later my parents talked to me about boundaries. They agreed that nobody should follow me home or enter without permission."

He nodded seriously. "Okay, that's actually important." "EXACTLY. FINALLY, SOMEONE UNDERSTANDS." Day Three — The One-Dollar Economy "Day three started with me taking one dollar to school." The new boy waited. "And?" "AND ALL THE GIRLS STARTED GIVING ME THEIR LUNCH MONEY!" He blinked. "Why?" "BRO, I ASKED MYSELF THE SAME QUESTION!" I explained how I'd told them I didn't need all that money. Then I told him about discovering that the school had no football field. "So I got my football and boots and started showing off my skills." The new boy leaned forward. "Okay, that's more interesting." "WAIT. I'M NOT FINISHED." I told him about the girls surrounding me and demanding that I teach them a crazy football move. DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM.

I described my legendary football technique. The new boy stared at me. Then he asked, "Bro, what anime did you escape from?" I pointed at him.

"YOU'RE NOT READY FOR THIS SCHOOL." Day Four — Lara Changed Everything My expression changed. The new boy noticed. "Wait. Why do you look different now?" I sighed. "Day four… was different." I told him about Lara. The girl with the perfect pink braids. The girl I'd confessed my feelings to. The girl who told me she liked me too. The girl I'd passed notes to while the other girls became jealous. "And when school ended, they all started asking why I liked Lara instead of them." The new boy shook his head. "That's crazy." "IT GETS CRAZIER." I explained how I'd escaped the interrogation squad and spent the evening trying to work on my website. Except I couldn't focus. Because I kept thinking about Lara. The new boy smirked. "Bro got distracted from coding." I looked at him. "Don't start." "Developer by day, romantic by night?" "I SAID DON'T START." Day Five — The First Kiss I took another deep breath. "And then… today happened."

The new boy leaned closer. "What happened?" I looked toward Lara's classroom. "She surprised me." He waited. "She kissed me first." His mouth fell open. "NO WAY." I nodded. "And we shared our first kiss. It lasted five minutes, and the entire school was watching." The new boy stood there in complete silence. Then he finally managed: "Bro… FIVE MINUTES?!" I shrugged. "Yeah." "And everyone watched?" "EVERYONE." "And now all the girls are jealous?" I gestured toward the crowd. "LOOK AROUND, BRO!" He looked at the girls, then slowly turned back toward me. "Yahya—wait, Yaya, right?" I smiled. "Now you're getting it." 8:30 AM — The Survivors' Alliance The new boy took another look at the girls surrounding him. Then he looked at me. "Okay, Yaya. I believe you."

I nodded. "Good. Because I wasn't exaggerating." He sighed. "So what do I do?" I put a hand on his shoulder. "Be yourself. Be respectful. Set boundaries. Don't let anyone pressure you into anything. And if you find someone you genuinely like, get to know her instead of treating it like a competition." He nodded. I started

walking toward class, then turned around one last time. "Oh, and one more thing." "What?" I gave him the most serious look I could manage. "NEVER UNDERESTIMATE THE POWER OF PINK BRAIDS."

He stared at me. I walked away. Behind me, the girls were still gathering around him. I shook my head. Poor bro. Day one hasn't even finished. For the first time since arriving at this school, I wasn't the only boy wondering how on earth he'd ended up there.

End Of Chapter 5.

Chapter 6: The Second Victim — The Great House

Invasion Yaya wasn't the only survivor anymore. But the new boy had a problem of his own. The New Boy's Confession — "BRO, YOU TOO?!" After I'd finished explaining my first five days at CIS Middle School JR. G., the new boy stared at me. Then he shook his head. "Bro, I thought I was the only one!" I looked at him. "WAIT. YOU TOO?!" He nodded. "Yeah! The girls keep surrounding me, asking questions, and trying to sit beside me. I barely get any peace!" I stared at him for three seconds. Then I burst out laughing. "HAHAHAHA! BRO, WE'RE THE ONLY TWO PLAYERS IN THIS ENTIRE SERVER!" He laughed too. Finally, someone understood the struggle. We weren't just classmates anymore. WE WERE THE SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE.

But then he mentioned something that made me stop laughing. He'd been absent from school for one day because he was sick. And apparently, that single day had created a whole new problem. Day Six — The Absent Boy The new boy explained what had happened. "One day, I was sick, so I stayed home." "Okay…?" I replied. He looked at me. "Yaya, you won't believe what happened next." I narrowed my eyes. "Bro, after everything you've told me, I believe literally anything." He took a breath. "Every girl except Lara went to my house." Silence. I stopped moving. My brain froze. Somewhere inside my head, an imaginary Windows error sound played. DING. "EVERY GIRL?!" He nodded. "Every girl." "TO YOUR HOUSE?!" "YES!" I put both hands on my head. "BROOOOOOOOOOOOOOO!" I had spent five days dealing with the chaos

myself. Now this guy had missed ONE DAY because he was sick, and the girls had apparently organized a field trip to his home. I looked at him with genuine disbelief. "How did they even find your house?!" He explained that the girls had all shown up while he was home recovering. I shook my head. "This school needs a software update." 4:00 PM — The Great House Invasion I imagined the scene. The new boy was at home, sick, probably trying to rest. Maybe he had a blanket, some water, and a plan to sleep for the afternoon. A peaceful day. A quiet day. A day with absolutely no school drama. Then— DING-DONG. He opened the door. And there they were. The girls. Every girl. Except Lara. I could practically hear the imaginary anime soundtrack building. The new boy must have been thinking: I AM SICK. HOW DID I UNLOCK A SCHOOL EVENT AT MY OWN HOUSE?! And Lara?

She was the only girl who hadn't joined the expedition. I mentally gave her one point for not participating in the surprise visit. Then I remembered my own experience: the girls had also shown up at my house without permission. Apparently, this wasn't just my problem anymore. It was a pattern. And it needed to stop. 4:15 PM — Two Boys, One Mission I stood beside the new boy and crossed my arms. "Bro, we seriously need to establish some boundaries with these people." He nodded immediately. "AGREED." I continued. "Our houses are private spaces. Being classmates doesn't mean someone can just show up whenever they want." "Exactly." "And if we're sick, we should be allowed to rest." "EXACTLY!" "And if we want to code, play football, or literally do nothing…" "WE SHOULD BE ALLOWED TO DO THAT TOO!" We shook hands. It was official. We were no longer two confused boys dealing with the same school separately. We were a team.

YAYA + THE NEW GUY = THE SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE. Our objectives were clear: - Protect our personal space. - Survive the school day. - Keep working on our projects. - Play football whenever possible. - Be friendly without feeling obligated to return someone's romantic feelings. - Make sure nobody mistakes a crush for permission to ignore boundaries. And most importantly… NEVER GET SICK WITHOUT A PLAN. I looked at him. "Bro, one question." "What?" "Did you at least get to sleep?" He stared at me. I stared at him. Then we both burst out laughing. Because honestly? At CIS Middle School JR. G., even being absent could become an entire season of an anime.

Final Scene — The Beginning of a Brotherhood

As we headed back toward class, I thought about everything that had happened. Five days ago, I had arrived at this school believing I was the only boy in a bizarre situation. Now there was another boy who understood exactly what I meant. We had both experienced the attention, the

confusion, and the constant interruptions. But we weren't going to let the chaos define us. I still had my website to build. I still had football to play. And I still had Lara to get to know. The new boy had his own life, his own interests, and his own boundaries to protect. We didn't need to fight every girl or be rude to anyone. We just needed people to understand that attention isn't the same as permission, and liking someone doesn't mean you own their time. I looked at my new friend. "Ready, bro?" He nodded. "Ready." We walked toward the classroom together. Two boys. One school. Absolutely zero peace. And a whole lot of story left to tell.

End Of Chapter 6 — The Survivors' Alliance.

Chapter 7: The New Boy, Amir Dolla Dolla

Two boys. One girls-only school. And a level of chaos that should be illegal.

Scene 1: Another Normal Day… NOT!

I woke up that morning, stretched my arms, and stared at the ceiling. Another day at CIS Middle School JR. G. Another day surrounded by girls. Another day trying to work on my website while somehow avoiding the most chaotic school environment in human history. I got dressed, grabbed my schoolbag, and headed downstairs. Mom: "Have a good day at school, Yahya!" Yaya: "Thanks, Mom!" I left the house, got to school, and walked through the gates. Immediately, girls started whispering. "He's here!" "Good morning, Yahya!" "Can I sit beside you?" I sighed. Yaya, thinking: Bro, I haven't even opened my laptop yet. I headed to class, hoping to get some work done. Then something unusual happened. A car stopped near the school entrance. A boy stepped out. A REAL BOY.

I stopped walking. He looked around the school, noticed all the girls, and slowly turned toward the entrance sign. His expression practically screamed: Where on Earth have I been sent? I stared at him. He stared at me. For a few seconds, neither of us spoke. Then I walked over. Yaya: "Bro." New boy: "Bro." Yaya: "You're a boy, right?" New boy: "I'M PRETTY SURE!" Yaya: "THANK GOD. ANOTHER ONE!" We shook hands like two explorers who had finally discovered another human being on a deserted island. Yaya: "Welcome to CIS Middle School JR. G." New boy: "Why are you saying that like it's a warning?" I looked at the hundreds of girls staring at us. Yaya: "Because it is."

Scene 2: The Girls Discover Their New Target

We hadn't even made it through the entrance before the girls noticed him. One girl approached. Then another. Then three more. Within seconds, he was surrounded. "What's your name?"

"Can you sit with me?" "You're so cute!" "Do you have a girlfriend?" The new boy looked at me over the crowd. His eyes were wide. New boy: "BRO! HELP!" I folded my arms. Yaya: "Welcome to the club." New boy: "WHAT CLUB?!" Yaya: "The Survivors' Club. Membership is automatic." New boy: "I DIDN'T SIGN ANYTHING!" Yaya: "Neither did I." I tried to push through the crowd to help him reach the classroom. The girls kept asking questions, but eventually, we managed to escape. We rushed into class and sat beside each other. The new boy dropped his bag onto the desk and took a deep breath. New boy: "What was THAT?!" Yaya: "Your first five minutes." New boy: "MY FIRST FIVE MINUTES?!" Yaya: "Trust me. I've got stories." He looked at me. I looked at him. Then I opened my laptop. Yaya: "First things first. What's your name, bro?" New boy: "Amir." I nodded. Yaya: "Amir…"

I paused dramatically. Yaya: "AMIR DOLLA DOLLA! " Amir: "BRO, WHAT?!" Yaya: "That's your name now." Amir: "MY NAME IS AMIR!" Yaya: "Your legal name is Amir. Your legendary name is Amir Dolla Dolla." Amir: "I'M ALREADY REGRETTING THIS SCHOOL." I burst out laughing. And just like that, I had a bro.

Scene 3: Yaya Explains the Lore

Amir leaned closer to my desk. Amir: "Alright, Yaya. Explain everything. Why are the girls acting like this?" I closed my laptop. Yaya: "You want the full story?" Amir: "YES!" Yaya: "Alright. Prepare yourself." I raised one finger. Yaya: "Day One. I arrived at this school. Every girl stared at me. They fought over who could sit beside me, passed me notes saying they liked me, and followed me when school ended." Amir blinked. Amir: "That's already insane." Yaya: "WAIT. IT GETS WORSE." I raised a second finger. Yaya: "Day Two. Girls tried to kiss me. I dodged them. Then they somehow found my house and surrounded me." Amir: "THEY FOUND YOUR HOUSE?!"

Yaya: "YES! My mom asked who my girlfriend was, and every girl raised her hand." Amir stared at me like I was describing a natural disaster. Yaya: "My parents eventually talked to me about boundaries and agreed that people needed to respect my personal space." Amir: "Okay, at least your parents understood." Yaya: "Exactly. Day Three. I took one dollar to school." Amir: "And?" Yaya: "The girls started giving me lunch money." Amir: "WHY?!" Yaya: "BRO, I DON'T KNOW!" I continued. Yaya: "Then I discovered there was no football field, so I grabbed a football and performed my move." Amir: "What move?" I leaned back in my chair. Yaya: "Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom." Amir went silent. Amir: "You named a football move a DOMAIN EXPANSION?" Yaya: "And it was magnificent." Amir: "You're actually crazy." Yaya: "Thank you. Day Four. I confessed to Lara." Amir leaned forward. Amir: "Who's Lara?" Yaya: "Pink braids. Green eyes. The girl I like." I smiled a little.

Yaya: "I told her how I felt, and she told me she liked me too." Amir: "Okay, that's actually nice." Yaya: "Then Day Five happened." I paused dramatically. Amir: "What happened on Day Five?" Yaya: "Lara surprised me with our first kiss." Amir's jaw dropped. Amir: "BROOOOO!" Yaya: "And all the other girls watched." Amir: "FIVE DAYS?! YOU EXPERIENCED AN ENTIRE ANIME SEASON IN FIVE DAYS!" Yaya: "WELCOME TO MY LIFE, AMIR DOLLA DOLLA." We both started laughing. For the first time since arriving at school, Amir didn't look like he was completely alone in this madness. He had someone who understood. Unfortunately for him, that someone was me.

Scene 4: The Warning

After we stopped laughing, I leaned forward. Yaya: "Seriously, though, bro. Listen." Amir nodded. Yaya: "You don't owe anyone your attention just because they like you. If someone makes you uncomfortable, tell them to stop. You can choose who you want to spend time with, and you don't have to rush into liking anybody." Amir: "What if they follow me home?" Yaya: "Tell your parents, just like I did. Your home is private. Nobody should show up or enter

without permission." Amir looked relieved. Amir: "Thanks, bro." Yaya: "That's what the Survivors' Alliance is for." I held out my fist. He bumped it. Yaya: "Rule One: protect your personal space." Amir: "Rule Two?" Yaya: "Never underestimate the power of pink braids." Amir: "BRO, THAT'S NOT A RULE!" Yaya: "It is now."

Scene 5: The Blonde Girl with Blue Eyes

We were finally settling into the classroom when Amir suddenly went quiet. I noticed immediately. Yaya: "What's wrong, bro?" Amir: "Nothing." Yaya: "You look like your brain just disconnected from the Wi-Fi." Amir: "There's something I wanted to tell you." I slowly closed my laptop. Yaya: "Another disaster?" Amir: "No. It's about a girl." My eyes widened. Yaya: "BROOOOO. YOU JUST GOT HERE!" Amir: "CAN YOU LET ME FINISH?!" I zipped my lips and gestured for him to continue. Amir: "There's a girl I like. Her name is

Avinia." I listened. Avinia was a blonde girl with blue eyes. Different from Lara, whose pink braids and green eyes had already become unforgettable to me. I grinned at Amir. Yaya: "So I have Lara, and you have Avinia?" Amir: "I guess." Yaya: "BRO. TWO BOYS. TWO CRUSHES. TWO DIFFERENT ANIME STORYLINES!" Amir: "Please don't make this weird." Yaya: "I CAN'T PROMISE THAT!" Amir laughed and shook his head. Yaya: "But seriously, bro, just talk to her. Get to know her. Don't try to force anything." Amir: "What if she doesn't like me back?" Yaya: "Then you respect her feelings. That's life. You can like someone without expecting them to feel the same way." Amir nodded. Amir: "Thanks, Yaya." Yaya: "Anytime, Amir Dolla Dolla." Amir: "I'M GOING TO GET YOU FOR THAT NAME!"

Scene 6: Lara and Avinia

Across the classroom, Lara walked past our desks. Her pink braids swayed as she moved, and her green eyes met mine. She smiled. I smiled back. Amir noticed. Amir: "That's Lara?"

Yaya: "Yep." Amir: "I can see why you like her." I shrugged, trying to act casual. Yaya: "She's cool. I like her for who she is." Then Avinia walked into the classroom. Blonde hair. Blue eyes. Amir immediately sat up straight. He adjusted his uniform, opened his notebook, and pretended to study. I glanced down at his desk. His notebook was upside down. I stared at him. Yaya: "Bro." Amir: "What?" Yaya: "Your notebook." He looked down. Flipped it around. Amir: "I KNEW THAT!" Yaya: "SURE YOU DID, AMIR DOLLA DOLLA!" Avinia took her seat, completely unaware of the crisis unfolding two desks away. Amir covered his face. I was laughing so hard that I nearly dropped my laptop. Amir: "If you tell anyone about this, we're no longer friends." Yaya: "Our friendship is eternal, bro. But the notebook incident will be remembered forever." Amir: "I hate you." Yaya: "Love you too, BRO."

Scene 7: The Survivors' Alliance

The teacher entered, and the classroom finally settled down. I reopened my laptop and returned to my website. Amir turned toward the board, trying to focus on the lesson. For once, things felt a little different. Yesterday, I was the only boy dealing with this chaos. Today, I had someone beside me who understood exactly how ridiculous this school could be. Amir had his own personality, his own story, and his own crush. And even though we were both still figuring things out, we didn't have to do it alone. I quietly held out my fist beneath the desk. Amir bumped it. Yaya: "Survivors' Alliance?" Amir: "Survivors' Alliance." Yaya: "Football training later?" Amir: "Definitely." Yaya: "And no more upside-down notebooks?" Amir: "YAYA!" I burst out laughing. The teacher turned toward us. We immediately sat straight. Teacher: "Is there something you'd like to share with the class?" Yaya and Amir: "NO, MISS!" The class erupted in giggles. I looked at Amir. He looked at me. We both knew one thing.

We were absolutely finished. Two boys. Two crushes. One girls-only school. And now, the Survivors' Alliance had officially begun.

End Of Chapter 7

Chapter 8: The Second Domain Expansion

One football move. Two best bros. Two crushes. And a plot twist nobody saw coming.

Scene 1: The Training Request

The school day had barely started when Amir Dolla Dolla approached my desk. I was working on my website, trying to fix a bug that had been annoying me since yesterday. Amir: "Yaya, bro. I need your help." Yaya: "If it's about your upside-down notebook, I can't help you." Amir: "IT WAS ONE TIME!" Yaya: "A legendary one." Amir pulled up a chair and sat beside me. Amir: "I'm serious. I want you to teach me your football move." I stopped typing. Slowly, I turned toward him. Yaya: "You mean…" Amir: "Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom." I stared at him. Yaya: "BROOOOOOO! YOU WANT TO LEARN THE MOVE?!" Amir: "YES!" I slammed my laptop shut. Yaya: "THEN TODAY, AMIR DOLLA DOLLA, YOUR TRAINING ARC BEGINS!" Amir: "Can you please announce things at a normal

volume?" Yaya: "NO. THIS IS AN IMPORTANT HISTORICAL EVENT!" The girls nearby turned toward us. One of them whispered, "What's a Domain Expansion?" I pointed dramatically at Amir. Yaya: "YOU'RE ABOUT TO FIND OUT."

Scene 2: Infinite Instinct Training

During our free time, we found an open space where we could practise with a football. I placed the ball on the ground and stood opposite Amir. Yaya: "Listen carefully, bro. This isn't just about kicking a ball. It's about control, timing, balance, and reading the space around you." Amir nodded. Yaya: "Watch." I started with a series of quick touches, moving the ball between my feet. Then I shifted my weight, performed a sharp feint, and accelerated into the open space. The ball followed perfectly. I stopped and turned back toward him. Yaya: "That's Infinite Instinct Phantom." Amir looked at the ball. Then at me. Amir: "Okay. My turn." He positioned himself behind the ball. First attempt. He moved too quickly and lost control.

The ball rolled away. Yaya: "BRO, THE BALL HAS LEFT THE SERVER!" Amir: "SHUT UP! I'M LEARNING!" I retrieved the ball and passed it back. Yaya: "Again. Slower this time." Second attempt. Better footwork. Better balance. But his feint was too obvious. Yaya: "You're telling the defender what you're going to do before you do it!" Amir: "How am I supposed to fix that?" Yaya: "Make your body sell one direction while the ball goes the other way. Practise until the movement feels natural." Amir nodded and tried again. And again. And again. Then something changed. He stopped thinking about every individual movement and started connecting them. Quick touches. A weight shift. A convincing feint. A sudden change of direction. The ball shot into the space beside me. I turned around. Yaya: "WAIT." Amir stopped the ball under his foot. Amir: "What?" Yaya: "DO THAT AGAIN."

Scene 3: THE SECOND DOMAIN EXPANSION

Amir stepped back and repeated the sequence. This time, it was even cleaner. His footwork connected smoothly, his feint looked convincing, and his acceleration carried him into the open space. I stood there in absolute disbelief. Yaya: "BROOOOOOOOO!" Amir: "WHAT?!" Yaya: "YOU ACTUALLY DID IT!" Amir: "I TOLD YOU I COULD LEARN!" I ran over and grabbed his shoulders. Yaya: "AMIR DOLLA DOLLA HAS UNLOCKED INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM!" Amir: "LET GO OF ME!" Yaya: "THE SECOND DOMAIN EXPANSION HAS ARRIVED!" Some girls who had been watching started cheering. "AMIR DID IT!" "YAHYA, TEACH US TOO!" I looked at Amir. Amir looked at me. We both looked at the growing crowd. Yaya: "Bro." Amir: "Yeah?" Yaya: "We need to leave." Amir: "Agreed." We grabbed our bags and the football. Yaya: "TACTICAL RETREAT!" Amir: "WHY ARE YOU RUNNING LIKE THAT?!" Yaya: "BECAUSE IT'S FUNNIER!" And off we went, laughing all the way back toward class.

For the first time, I wasn't the only person in school who could perform my signature move. The Infinite Instinct Phantom had a second user. And his name was Amir Dolla Dolla.

Scene 4: The Secret Crush

Later that day, we sat together in class. I reopened my laptop while Amir looked unusually distracted. He kept glancing toward Avinia, the blonde girl with blue eyes. I noticed. Of course I noticed. Yaya: "Bro." Amir: "What?" Yaya: "Your eyes have been tracking Avinia for the last five minutes." Amir: "NO, THEY HAVEN'T!" Yaya: "Your head is facing the board, but your eyes are facing the opposite direction." Amir immediately turned toward the board. Amir: "I WAS LOOKING AT THE CLOCK!" I checked the wall. The clock was nowhere near Avinia. Yaya: "BRO, THAT CLOCK IS ON THE OTHER SIDE!" Amir covered his face. I started laughing. Yaya: "Relax, Amir Dolla Dolla. You like her. That's normal." Amir: "I know that!" Yaya: "Then why are you acting like you've been asked to solve a thousand-digit equation?"

Amir sighed. Amir: "Because I don't know what to say to her." For once, I stopped teasing him. Yaya: "Start with a normal conversation. Ask how her day is going. Find out what she likes. You don't need a special move for everything." Amir: "Not even Infinite Instinct Phantom?" Yaya: "ESPECIALLY not Infinite Instinct Phantom." He laughed. Yaya: "And remember, bro, if she likes you back, great. If she doesn't, respect her feelings. No pressure and no competitions." Amir: "Thanks, Yaya." Yaya: "Anytime." Then I reopened my laptop. Yaya: "Now stop distracting me. My website isn't going to debug itself."

Scene 5: The Confession

Over time, Amir and Avinia began talking more. They got to know each other, shared conversations, and became more comfortable around one another. Eventually, Amir told her how he felt. He didn't try to act like someone else. He didn't use a football trick to impress her. He simply told her that he liked her. Avinia listened. And she told him that she liked him too. When Amir told me what had happened, I nearly fell out of my chair. Yaya: "BROOOOO! YOU DID IT!"

Amir: "I DID!" Yaya: "AMIR DOLLA DOLLA HAS ENTERED THE ROMANCE ARC!" Amir: "Can you stop calling it an arc?" Yaya: "No." I held out my fist. He bumped it. Yaya: "Proud of you, bro." And I meant it.

Scene 6: The Fifteen-Minute Plot Twist ■

Later, Amir and Avinia shared their first kiss. It was a moment they both wanted, and they were happy together. When Amir eventually told me how long it had lasted, I expected him to say a few seconds. Maybe a minute. Possibly two. Instead, he looked me directly in the eyes. Amir: "Fifteen minutes." I stopped breathing for a second. Yaya: "…WHAT?" Amir: "Fifteen minutes, bro." I put my hands on my head. Yaya: "FIFTEEN MINUTES?!" Amir: "YES!" Yaya: "BRO, MINE WITH LARA WAS FIVE MINUTES!" Amir: "I KNOW!" Yaya: "YOU TRIPLED THE RECORD!" Amir: "IT WASN'T A COMPETITION!" Yaya: "THAT'S WHAT THEY ALL SAY!" Amir was laughing so hard that he could barely

speak. I pointed at him like a football referee announcing a controversial decision. Yaya: "Amir Dolla Dolla, you have officially broken the Survivors' Alliance record!" Amir: "THERE IS NO RECORD!" Yaya: "THERE IS NOW!" Then I paused. Yaya: "Wait. Did you at least remember to breathe?" Amir: "YAYA!" I completely lost it.

Scene 7: Lara Finds Out

Later, Lara came over while I was sitting at my desk. Her pink braids fell neatly beside her face, and her green eyes were full of curiosity. Lara: "Why is everyone talking about Amir and Avinia?" I tried to look innocent. Yaya: "No idea." Lara raised an eyebrow. Lara: "Yaya." Yaya: "Okay, fine. They kissed." Lara: "Oh! That's sweet." I nodded. Yaya: "Yeah. I'm happy for them." She smiled at me. Lara: "And what were you two shouting about earlier?" I hesitated.

Yaya: "Football." Lara: "Really?" Yaya: "Football-related romance statistics." Lara burst out laughing. Lara: "You're impossible." Yaya: "You knew that when you chose me." She shook her head, still smiling, and took my hand. And suddenly, the whole school could have been screaming about anything. I didn't care. I was happy with Lara.

Scene 8: Two Players, Two Couples

At the end of the day, Amir and I met up again. He had Avinia. I had Lara. We stood together, looking at one another like two anime rivals who had accidentally become best friends. Yaya: "So, bro. You learned Infinite Instinct Phantom." Amir: "Yep." Yaya: "You confessed to Avinia." Amir: "Yep." Yaya: "You had your first kiss." Amir: "Yep." I folded my arms. Yaya: "And now you think you're better than me?" Amir: "I didn't say that." Yaya: "YOU TRIPLED THE KISS RECORD!" Amir: "IT WASN'T A RECORD!"

Avinia and Lara started laughing. Lara: "You two are ridiculous." Avinia: "Seriously." I looked at Amir. Amir looked at me. Then we bumped fists. Yaya: "Survivors' Alliance?" Amir: "Survivors' Alliance." Yaya: "Infinite Instinct Duo?" Amir: "Infinite Instinct Duo." Yaya: "And no more kiss competitions?" Amir: "THERE WAS NEVER A COMPETITION!" Yaya: "Sure, bro. Sure." We all burst out laughing. And for the first time, the chaos of CIS Middle School JR. G. didn't feel like something we had to face alone. We had our football. We had our friendships. And we had two girls who made the whole adventure a little more special.

End Of Chapter 8: The Second Domain Expansion

The Infinite Instinct Duo was born. Yaya had Lara, the girl with pink braids and green eyes. Amir Dolla Dolla had Avinia, the blonde girl with blue eyes. And now, the Survivors' Alliance had two official couples, two football players, and approximately one million reasons to keep laughing.

Chapter 9

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 9: The Egyptian Reveal

The Legendary Double Date — The Secret Language and the Egyptian King Scene 1: Yaya's Secret Outfit

It was finally time. The legendary double date. Me, Yaya, was going out with Lara, the girl with pink braids and green eyes. My best bro, Amir Dolla Dolla, was going with Avinia, the blonde girl with blue eyes. Four people. Two couples. One mission. **Have a normal day.** After everything that had happened at school, we deserved some peace. I was at home getting ready. I opened my wardrobe and looked at my clothes. Normally, I'd pick a hoodie, some trousers, and sneakers. Easy. Comfortable. Classic Yaya. But today, I had a different idea.

I decided to wear **Egyptian-style clothing**. I put on my outfit and checked myself in the mirror. I adjusted the clothes, stood back, and smiled. **Yaya:** "Perfect." I looked at myself one more time. **Yaya:** "Let's go." I grabbed my things and headed out. I hadn't told Lara, Amir, or Avinia what I planned to wear. I hadn't even told them that I was Egyptian. Somehow, in all our conversations about football, coding, school chaos, and our crushes, I had forgotten to mention it. How? I had absolutely no idea. But I was about to give my squad the biggest surprise of the day. Scene 2: The Double Date Begins

I arrived at our meeting place. Lara was waiting, looking lovely as always. Her pink braids and green eyes were instantly recognizable. Amir and Avinia were nearby. **Lara:** "Yaya!" She walked over to greet me. **Yaya:** "Hey, Lara!" She smiled. Then she looked down at my outfit. Her smile paused. She looked at my clothes. Then at my face. Then back at my clothes. **Lara:** "Yaya…" **Yaya:** "Yeah?"

Lara: "What's that?" I glanced down at myself. **Yaya:** "My outfit?" **Lara:** "I CAN SEE THAT!" Amir turned around. **Amir:** "What's happening?" He saw me. He stopped. He blinked. He stared again. **Amir:** "BROOOOOOOOOOOOOO!" Avinia turned toward him. **Avinia:** "WHAT?!" **Amir:** "LOOK AT YAYA!" Avinia looked at my clothes. **Avinia:** "Oh! That's different."

Yaya: "Different how?" **Amir:** "BRO CAME TO THE DOUBLE DATE LIKE HE'S ABOUT TO OPEN A MUSEUM!" **Yaya:** "Amir, shut up!" **Amir:** "I WAS EXPECTING A HOODIE! NOT A WHOLE HISTORICAL OUTFIT!" Lara was still studying the outfit. **Lara:** "I've never seen you wear anything like this." **Yaya:** "Well, now you have." **Amir:** "IS THIS A NEW CHARACTER SKIN?!" **Yaya:** "Yaya: Egyptian Edition." **Amir:** "" Avinia started laughing. **Avinia:** "You really surprised us." **Yaya:** "That was the idea." **Lara:** "Okay, I need an explanation." I sat down with the squad.

I knew there was no escaping the questions now. Scene 3: The Egyptian Reveal

Amir leaned forward. **Amir:** "Okay, bro. Serious question. Why are you wearing Egyptian-style clothes?" I looked at him. Then at Lara. Then at Avinia. I realized this was the perfect moment to tell them. **Yaya:** "Because I'm Egyptian." Silence. One second. Two seconds. Three seconds. **Amir:** "……WHAT?!" **Avinia:** "WAIT. YOU'RE EGYPTIAN?!"

Lara: "YAYA, HOW DID YOU NEVER TELL US?!" **Yaya:** "IT NEVER CAME UP!" Amir stood up dramatically. **Amir:** "HOW DOES YOUR NATIONALITY NEVER COME UP?!" **Yaya:** "I DON'T KNOW, AMIR!" **Amir:** "WE'VE TALKED ABOUT FOOTBALL! WE'VE TALKED ABOUT YOUR WEBSITE! WE'VE TALKED ABOUT YOUR SECRET FOOTBALL TECHNIQUE! WE'VE TALKED ABOUT EVERYTHING!" **Yaya:** "APPARENTLY NOT EVERYTHING!" Avinia was laughing so hard that she had to look away. **Avinia:** "This is actually unbelievable." Lara looked at me

with curiosity. **Lara:** "So you're Egyptian, and you decided to wear Egyptian-style clothing today?" **Yaya:** "Exactly." **Lara:** "That's actually really cool."

I smiled. **Yaya:** "Thanks." Amir was still processing the information. **Amir:** "Bro, your character has so many hidden details." **Yaya:** "I'm a person, not a video game!" **Amir:** "YOU HAVE FOOTBALL ABILITIES, CODING ABILITIES, A GIRLFRIEND, AND NOW AN EGYPTIAN REVEAL!" **Yaya:** "You're making this sound like a movie trailer." **Amir:** "BECAUSE IT IS ONE!" Scene 4: The Arabic Switch

Amir finally sat back down. For approximately three seconds. Then he leaned forward again. **Amir:** "Okay, if you're Egyptian, say something in Arabic!"

I raised an eyebrow. **Yaya:** "Why?" **Amir:** "BECAUSE I WANT TO HEAR IT!" **Avinia:** "Amir, let him enjoy the date." **Amir:** "THIS IS IMPORTANT RESEARCH!" I shook my head and answered him naturally in Egyptian Arabic. **Yaya:** "[redacted]!" Lara immediately looked at me. **Lara:** "WAIT! What did you say?" **Yaya:** "I told him to stop interrogating me because we're here to have fun, not conduct an investigation." Amir stared at me. **Amir:** "BRO JUST ROASTED ME IN ANOTHER LANGUAGE!" **Yaya:** "You understood the energy." **Avinia:** "Honestly, you deserved that."

Amir: "MY OWN GIRLFRIEND HAS BETRAYED ME!" **Avinia:** "I'm supporting the truth." Lara laughed. **Lara:** "Yaya, can you teach me Arabic?" I smiled at her. **Yaya:** "Of course." **Lara:** "Really?" **Yaya:** "[redacted]." **Lara:** "I understood absolutely nothing." **Yaya:** "That means 'of course.'" **Lara:** "Okay, teach me more!" **Amir:** "ME TOO!" **Yaya:** "You need to learn when to stop shouting first." **Amir:** "THAT'S NOT A LANGUAGE LESSON!" **Yaya:** "It's an essential life skill."

Avinia burst out laughing. And that was when Lara had an idea. An idea that would change our squad forever. Scene 5: The Secret-Language Promise

Lara leaned forward. **Lara:** "Wait. What if we all learn Arabic?" **Avinia:** "All of us?" **Lara:** "Yes! Then we could speak Arabic together as our secret language!" I paused. Then I grinned. **Yaya:** "[redacted] …[redacted]!" **Amir:** "WHAT DID HE SAY?!" **Yaya:** "I said that's a great idea!" Amir slapped the table. **Amir:** "BRO! WE NEED THIS!" **Avinia:** "It would be fun learning a language

together." **Lara:** "And when we're all together, we could use Arabic to have private conversations that other people around us might not understand." **Yaya:** "Exactly. We'd teach each other properly, and we'd all get better together." **Amir:** "I'M IN!" **Avinia:** "Me too!" **Lara:** "Then let's make a promise." We all placed our hands together in the middle of the table. For once, Amir was quiet. Well, almost quiet. **Yaya:** "One squad." **Lara:** "One promise." **Avinia:** "One language we're going to learn together." **Amir:** "AND ONE BRO WHO WILL BECOME FLUENT!" **Yaya:** "[redacted]."

Amir: "I DON'T KNOW WHAT THAT MEANS, BUT I AGREE!" We all burst out laughing. I translated it for him. **Yaya:** "It means 'God willing, bro.'" **Amir:** "SEE? I'M ALREADY LEARNING!" **Avinia:** "You learned one phrase." **Amir:** "EVERY MASTER STARTS SOMEWHERE!" Lara squeezed my hand. **Lara:** "I promise I'll learn." **Avinia:** "I promise too." **Amir:** "I SWEAR ON THE SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE!" **Yaya:** "[redacted]!" **Amir:** "I'M TRYING!" We laughed again. Then we agreed on our new squad rule.

**THE ARABIC PROMISE ** We would learn Arabic together and use it as our special squad language. We'd be able to share jokes, talk about our plans, and enjoy learning something meaningful together. And, of

course, we'd still respect other people's privacy and boundaries. The Survivors' Alliance had officially gained a new mission. **Learn Arabic. Together.** Scene 6: Lara's First Arabic Lesson

After making the promise, Lara turned toward me. **Lara:** "Okay, teacher. What's my first lesson?" **Yaya:** "Your first lesson is simple." **Lara:** "I'm ready." **Yaya:** "[redacted]." She repeated the words carefully. **Lara:** "[redacted]."

I smiled. **Yaya:** "Perfect." **Lara:** "What does it mean?" **Yaya:** "It means 'I love you.'" Lara's cheeks turned pink. **Lara:** "You could have told me that BEFORE I repeated it!" I laughed. **Yaya:** "You asked me to teach you Arabic!" **Lara:** "I DIDN'T KNOW THAT WAS THE FIRST PHRASE!" Amir immediately raised his hand. **Amir:** "TEACH ME ONE!" **Yaya:** "[redacted]." **Amir:** "YA AM… EHD—" **Yaya:** "It means 'Bro, calm down.'" Avinia stared at him.

Avinia: "That's literally what you need to learn most." **Amir:** "WHY DOES EVERY ARABIC LESSON ATTACK MY PERSONALITY?!" **Yaya:** "Because your personality is an easy target." The entire table erupted in laughter. Lara leaned against my shoulder. **Lara:** "I really like this." **Yaya:** "The Arabic lessons?" **Lara:** "All of it. Learning something new about you, spending time together, and making this promise." I smiled. **Yaya:** "I'm glad." For a moment, everything was peaceful. Then Amir spoke again. **Amir:** "I HAVE A QUESTION!" **Everyone:** "AMIR, NO!" Scene 7: The Egyptian King Appears

We eventually finished eating and prepared to leave. The double date had already been legendary. I'd revealed that I was Egyptian. We had made our Arabic promise. Lara had learned her first phrase, and Amir had somehow turned every lesson into an argument. I thought the day was over. Then I saw someone familiar. Someone whose face I recognized immediately. **MO SALAH.** The Egyptian football legend. The man known around the world for his incredible football career. I stopped walking.

Yaya: "[redacted]…" **Amir:** "BRO, WHAT NOW?!" I pointed toward him. **Yaya:** "[redacted]!" Everyone turned. Amir's eyes widened. **Amir:** "BROOOOOOOOOOOOOO! THAT'S MO SALAH?!" Avinia looked stunned. **Avinia:** "The footballer?!" Lara turned toward me. **Lara:** "YAYA! YOU HAVE TO BE JOKING!" I couldn't believe what I was seeing. I had come to enjoy a double date with my girlfriend. I had not expected to encounter one of Egypt's most famous footballers. **Yaya's internal thoughts:** *I came for a date. HOW DID I UNLOCK A FOOTBALL LEGEND ENCOUNTER?!*

Amir grabbed my shoulder. **Amir:** "BRO! YOU LOVE FOOTBALL! GO SAY HI!" **Yaya:** "I KNOW!" **Amir:** "THEN GO!" **Yaya:** "STOP PRESSURING ME!" Lara smiled encouragingly. **Lara:** "You can do it, Yaya." I took a breath. Then I approached respectfully, hoping I could greet him. **Yaya:** "[redacted]!" The squad watched from behind me. **Amir, whispering loudly:** "HE'S USING ARABIC!" **Avinia:** "Amir, that's the entire point of the promise!" **Amir:** "I KNOW! I'M JUST SAYING!" I tried to keep my composure.

Meeting a footballer I admired was a big moment for me. I wanted to greet him, tell him I respected his career, and maybe talk briefly about football if the opportunity allowed it. I wasn't going to assume anything or interrupt him if he was busy. But the possibility alone was exciting. **Yaya's internal thoughts:** *Stay calm. Be respectful. Don't embarrass yourself.* Behind me, Amir was having the opposite experience. **Amir:** "YAYA, REMEMBER US WHEN YOU BECOME A FOOTBALL LEGEND!" **Yaya:** "AMIR, PLEASE!" Avinia covered her face. **Avinia:** "I don't know that boy." **Lara:** "Yes, you do." **Avinia:** "Unfortunately." Scene 8: Yaya's Football Dream

For a moment, I thought about why this encounter meant so much to me. Football wasn't just a game I played for fun. It was something I genuinely loved. I enjoyed training, improving my control, learning new techniques, and challenging myself. My Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom was my own dramatic name for my special football move. And now, I had an opportunity—at least in the story—to encounter a player whose career inspired millions of football fans. I wanted to keep improving. I wanted to become a better player. I wanted to work hard and see how far I could go. I didn't need to pretend I was already a professional. I just needed to keep learning.

Yaya's internal thoughts: *One day, I want to look back and know I gave football everything I reasonably could.* I returned to my squad. **Lara:** "Are you okay?" **Yaya:** "Yeah. I'm just excited." She took my hand. **Lara:** "I'm happy for you." **Amir:** "BRO IS HAVING THE GREATEST DAY OF HIS LIFE!" **Yaya:** "Honestly? It's definitely going in the memories." **Avinia:** "And the group chat." **Amir:** "AND THE SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE ARCHIVES!" **Yaya:** "Please don't create an archive." **Amir:** "TOO LATE!" Scene 9: The Final Promise

As the double date came to an end, the four of us

stood together. The day had been completely unexpected. I'd arrived wearing Egyptian-style clothes. My friends had discovered I was Egyptian. I'd started speaking Arabic. We had promised to learn it together and use it as our special squad language. And, in this fictional adventure, I'd even encountered Mo Salah. Amir looked at all of us. **Amir:** "So, what's our first Arabic training session?" **Yaya:** "We can start with basic greetings and everyday conversations." **Avinia:** "I'm actually looking forward to it." **Lara:** "Me too." **Amir:** "I WILL BECOME FLUENT!" **Yaya:** "One lesson at a time, bro."

Amir: "FINE. BUT I'M STILL GOING TO BE THE BEST STUDENT." **Avinia:** "Let's start by learning how to say 'please be quiet.'" **Yaya:** "That's an advanced lesson." **Lara:** "For Amir, definitely." We laughed together. Then Lara looked at me. **Lara:** "I'm glad you shared this part of yourself with us." **Yaya:** "Me too." **Lara:** "And I'm glad we're doing this together." I smiled. **Yaya:** "[redacted]." **Lara:** "Translation?" **Yaya:** "Always, Lara." She smiled back.

We said our goodbyes and headed home. I had gone into the day expecting a simple double date. I left with an even closer squad, a new promise, and a memory that would stay with us for a long time. And Amir? He was already planning his first Arabic lesson. Probably loudly. Very loudly. **Amir:** "TOMORROW, THE ARABIC TRAINING ARC BEGINS!" **Yaya:** "[redacted]!" **Amir:** "WHAT DOES THAT MEAN?!" **Yaya:** "You'll learn tomorrow!" And we walked away laughing. End Of Chapter 9

**Four friends. Two couples. One Egyptian reveal. One secret-language promise. And one

unforgettable encounter with the Egyptian football king, Mo Salah.** *The Survivors' Alliance had survived school, chaos, and house invasions. Now it was time to survive Arabic lessons with Amir Dolla Dolla.*

Chapter 10: The Reality Warp

The Dream That Came True — The Third Survivor and the Infinite Instinct Mystery

Scene 1: The Dream Begins

That night, after the legendary Egyptian double date, I finally got into bed. My brain was exhausted. School chaos? Survived. Two couples? Established. Arabic lessons? Incoming. Amir Dolla Dolla? Unfortunately, still operational. I stared at the ceiling. Yaya's internal thoughts: Tomorrow, I'm going to have a normal day. No drama. No surprises. No mysterious nonsense. Just school, Lara, football, and maybe some coding. I closed my eyes. Five minutes later, I was asleep. And that's when everything got weird. In my dream, I was standing in the hallway of CIS Middle School JR. G. Everything looked normal. The lockers were in the same places. The classroom doors were open. Students were walking around and talking. Then I heard a familiar voice. Amir: "YAYA! BRO! WE HAVE A PROBLEM!" I turned around. There was Amir Dolla Dolla, running toward me

like he'd just seen the final boss of a video game. Yaya: "WHAT NOW?!" Amir: "NEW STUDENT!" I blinked. Yaya: "Okay? And?" Amir: "A BOY!" I stared at him. Yaya: "Amir, we're literally the Survivors' Alliance. We already know boys can attend this school." Amir: "BRO, I KNOW! BUT THERE'S ANOTHER ONE!" I slowly smiled. Yaya: "Wait. Another survivor?" Amir nodded dramatically. Amir: "THE SQUAD MIGHT BE EXPANDING!" We hurried into the classroom. And there he was. A boy I'd never seen before, standing beside the teacher with a backpack over one shoulder. He looked confused. Nervous. And completely unaware of the chaos he was about to experience. I leaned toward Amir. Yaya: "Bro, why does he look like he's about to enter a survival game?" Amir: "Because he just entered one." Then the teacher spoke. Teacher: "Everyone, please welcome our new student." The boy gave a small wave.

New boy: "Hey, everyone." For approximately three seconds, everything was peaceful. Then the girls noticed him. Oh, no. I knew that look. I'd seen it before. The first girl stood up. Then another. Then five more. Yaya's internal thoughts: Not again.

Scene 2: The New Boy Gets Swarmed

Within seconds, the classroom transformed into a social hurricane. Girl 1: "What's your name?" Girl 2: "Where did you come from?" Girl 3: "Do you like football?" Girl 4: "Can you sit next to me?" Girl 5: "Do you have a girlfriend?" The new boy stepped backward. New boy: "Uh… guys?" Nobody seemed to hear him. More girls approached. One wanted to know his favorite game. Another wanted to know his favorite color. Someone was already asking whether he wanted to join a group chat. I turned to Amir. Yaya: "We've seen this episode before." Amir: "SEASON ONE, EPISODE ONE!" Yaya: "Except this poor guy hasn't watched the previous seasons!"

Amir nodded seriously. Amir: "We must protect the innocent." I stood up. Yaya: "Survivors' Alliance?" Amir raised his fist. Amir: "Survivors' Alliance!" We moved toward the new boy. Yaya: "Hey, man. You okay?" He looked at me like I'd just rescued him from a thousand-player battle royale. New boy: "Honestly? Not really." Yaya: "Understandable." Amir stepped beside me. Amir: "Listen, bro. Rule number one: you don't have to answer every question immediately." Yaya: "Rule number two: your personal space belongs to you." Amir: "Rule number three: nobody gets automatic permission to follow you home." Yaya: "And rule number four: if you need peace, you can ask for it." The boy nodded. New boy: "Thanks. Seriously." I smiled. Yaya: "No problem. We've got you." For a moment, I felt proud. We'd learned something from our own experiences, and now we were helping somebody else. But then something strange happened. The new boy looked directly at me. His expression changed. New boy: "Wait… you're Yaya, right?"

I froze. Yaya: "Yeah. How do you know my name?" He opened his mouth to answer. But before he could speak— CRACK. A strange sound came from above us. Everyone looked up. The ceiling began to distort. The classroom lights flickered. The walls stretched impossibly far into the distance. Amir slowly looked at me. Amir: "Yaya?" Yaya: "Yeah?" Amir: "PLEASE TELL ME THIS IS NORMAL." Yaya: "BRO, I DON'T EVEN KNOW WHAT NORMAL IS ANYMORE!" The classroom began to change. And the dream took a turn I could never have predicted.

Scene 3: Reality Starts Breaking

The classroom stretched into an endless space. Desks floated above the floor. The windows showed a sky filled with glowing stars, even though it was supposed to be daytime. The girls disappeared into bright particles of light. The new boy stood perfectly still. Amir grabbed my shoulder. Amir: "BRO! WHAT IS HAPPENING?!" I stared at the floating desks. Yaya: "I THINK REALITY JUST GOT AN UPDATE!"

Amir: "WHO APPROVED THIS UPDATE?!" Yaya: "NOT ME!" A glowing football appeared in the air between us. Its surface shimmered with purple and blue energy. I recognized it immediately. It was connected to my signature football move. DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM. I stepped toward it. Yaya: "That's my move…" Amir looked at the ball. Amir: "WHY IS YOUR FOOTBALL MOVE NOW A WHOLE DIMENSION?!" Yaya: "I DON'T KNOW, BRO!" The new boy slowly turned toward us. New boy: "You have to find it." I frowned. Yaya: "Find what?" He pointed toward the glowing ball. New boy: "The memory." Yaya: "WHAT MEMORY?!" Before he could answer, the floor beneath us began dissolving into light. The stadium lights appeared overhead. The walls vanished. And suddenly, we were standing in the middle of an enormous football stadium floating among the stars. I looked around. There were no spectators. No coaches.

No teams. Just me, Amir, the mysterious boy, and a glowing football hovering above the pitch. Amir slowly turned in a circle. Amir: "Yaya." Yaya: "Yeah?" Amir: "I THINK WE SKIPPED THE TUTORIAL." I couldn't disagree. The football began spinning faster. A voice echoed throughout the stadium. Mysterious voice: "INFINITE INSTINCT… REMEMBERS." My heart pounded. Yaya: "Who said that?" No answer. Then the boy looked at me one last time. New boy: "You'll understand when you wake up." I stepped toward him. Yaya: "WAIT! WHAT'S YOUR NAME?!" He opened his mouth. But the entire stadium exploded into white light. Everything disappeared. And I fell.

Scene 4: The Phantom Stadium

I was falling through an endless white space. No floor. No ceiling. No sky. Just light stretching in every direction. I tried to move, but my body felt weightless. Then a football appeared beneath my feet. I landed on it perfectly, balancing as if I were standing on ordinary ground.

I looked down. Yaya: "Okay… that's actually kind of cool." The ball glowed brighter. Images flashed around me. I saw myself playing football. I saw Amir laughing. I saw Lara smiling. I saw the school hallway. Then I saw the mysterious boy again. He stood on the opposite side of the glowing pitch. This time, he was holding a notebook. I couldn't see what was written inside. Yaya: "Hey! You!" He looked up. Yaya: "What is this place? Who are you? And why do you know me?" The boy slowly raised the notebook. A page turned by itself. I saw three words. INFINITE INSTINCT PROJECT. My eyes widened. Yaya: "Wait… what?" Before I could read anything else, the page turned again. The words vanished. The boy closed the notebook. New boy: "Remember the name." Yaya: "WHAT NAME?!" New boy: "The one you haven't learned yet." I stared at him. Yaya: "BRO, THAT IS THE MOST CONFUSING SENTENCE

I'VE EVER HEARD!" He didn't answer. Instead, he kicked a football toward me. The ball flew through the air, leaving a trail of purple light. My instincts took over. I controlled it with one touch. Then another. Then I

performed the movement that had become my signature. DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM! For a moment, the entire space illuminated. The glowing pitch expanded around me. The football split into dozens of shining afterimages, each following a different trajectory. I understood the movement perfectly. Every angle. Every touch. Every possible direction. But something was missing. A memory I couldn't reach. I stretched out my hand toward the boy. Yaya: "TELL ME WHAT I'M SUPPOSED TO REMEMBER!" He answered quietly. New boy: "You'll see me again." The light intensified. The football shot into the sky. And the world vanished.

Scene 5: Waking Up

I jolted awake. Yaya: "AAAAAAAA—!"

I sat upright in bed. My heart was racing. I looked around my bedroom. My wardrobe. My desk. My laptop. My phone. My ordinary ceiling. Everything was exactly where it should be. No floating stadium. No glowing football. No mysterious boy standing in the corner. I exhaled. Yaya: "Okay. It was a dream." I rubbed my eyes. Yaya: "Just a weird dream." I leaned back against my pillow. Then I remembered the notebook. INFINITE INSTINCT PROJECT. I frowned. Yaya's internal thoughts: Why would my brain come up with something that specific? I picked up my phone and checked the time. It was morning. School day. I had to get ready. I got dressed, packed my things, and prepared to leave. Before walking out, I glanced at my ceiling one more time. Still normal. No cracks.

No portals. No reality-breaking nonsense. Yaya: "Today is going to be normal." I pointed at the ceiling. Yaya: "YOU HEAR ME, UNIVERSE?! NORMAL!" Then I left for school. I had absolutely no idea that the dream was about to become a lot more interesting.

Scene 6: Déjà Vu — "I've Seen This Before"

I arrived at CIS Middle School JR. G. Everything was normal. Students were talking in the hallway. Teachers were preparing lessons. Someone was already arguing about lunch. And Amir Dolla Dolla was standing near our classroom, eating a snack. Amir: "YAYAAAA!" Yaya: "BRO, WHY ARE YOU SHOUTING? I'M RIGHT HERE!" Amir: "IMPORTANT QUESTION." Yaya: "What?" Amir: "If you could eat one food for the rest of your life, what would it be?" I stared at him. Yaya: "THAT'S YOUR IMPORTANT QUESTION?!" Amir: "YES." Yaya: "I'M GOING TO CLASS." I walked past him. He followed me. Amir: "YOU DIDN'T ANSWER!" Yaya: "I'M NOT ANSWERING UNTIL YOU STOP ASKING QUESTIONS BEFORE 9 A. M.!"

We entered the classroom. Lara waved at me from her seat. Lara: "Good morning, Yaya!" I smiled. Yaya: "Morning, Lara!" For a few minutes, everything was peaceful. Then our teacher entered. Teacher: "Class, we have a new student joining us today." I stopped moving. My smile disappeared. A boy walked into the room. He had a backpack over one shoulder. He looked nervous. And he adjusted his backpack strap. My stomach dropped. It was him. The boy from my dream. Same face. Same backpack. Same expression. Same everything. I gripped the edge of my desk. Yaya: "No way…" Amir turned toward me. Amir: "What?" I stared at the new boy. Yaya: "I've seen this before." Amir: "Seen what before?" Yaya: "HIM." Amir looked at the new student. Then at me.

Amir: "Bro, did you meet him somewhere?" Yaya: "No!" Amir: "Then how have you seen him before?" I leaned closer. Yaya: "I dreamed about him last night." Amir blinked. Once. Twice. Then he slowly put his snack down. Amir: "You dreamed about a random boy who would join our class?" Yaya: "YES!" Amir: "And now he's actually here?" Yaya: "YES!" Amir: "BRO. WHY DIDN'T YOU DREAM ABOUT TOMORROW'S HOMEWORK INSTEAD?!" Yaya: "THIS IS NOT THE TIME!" The teacher introduced the new boy. Teacher: "Everyone, please welcome our new student." He gave a small wave. New boy: "Hey, everyone." My blood ran cold. Those were the exact words from my dream. Then the first girl turned toward him. Another girl

stood up. Three more started approaching. I remembered what happened next in the dream. The questions. The crowd. The boy stepping backward. I looked at Amir.

Yaya: "It's starting." Amir: "What's starting?" A girl called out. Girl: "What's your name?" I slowly turned toward Amir. Yaya: "THAT." Amir's eyes widened. Amir: "BROOOOO!" The new boy took a step backward. Exactly as he had in my dream. I stood up. Yaya: "AMIR! SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE! NOW!" Amir: "DEPLOYING!" We hurried toward the new student. I stopped beside him, leaving enough space so he wouldn't feel surrounded by us too. Yaya: "Hey, man. I'm Yaya. This is Amir." Amir: "Welcome to the school, bro." The boy looked relieved. New boy: "Thanks. I'm Zayn." Yaya: "Nice to meet you, Zayn." Another girl approached, but I raised my hand politely. Yaya: "Hey, everyone. Give him a second to settle in, okay? He literally just arrived." The crowd loosened. Zayn finally had room to breathe. And just like that, something changed. In my dream, the classroom had started breaking apart at this exact point. But now? The ceiling was perfectly fine.

The lights were working. The walls weren't stretching. There were no glowing footballs or floating stadiums. Reality was completely normal. I looked around the room. Then I looked at Zayn. Yaya's internal thoughts: Maybe the dream wasn't showing me everything. Maybe it was showing me a choice. I had recognized what was happening, and this time, Amir and I had helped before things got out of hand. But one question remained. Why had I dreamed about Zayn before meeting him?

Scene 7: The Third Survivor — Zayn the

Mainframe Zayn looked at me and Amir. Zayn: "You two always work together like that?" Amir immediately puffed out his chest. Amir: "We are the legendary duo." Yaya: "He's exaggerating." Amir: "We are the INFINITE INSTINCT DUO!" Yaya: "He's still exaggerating." Zayn laughed. Zayn: "Honestly, I'm glad you helped me. That was a lot." I nodded. Yaya: "We've been there, bro. Sometimes you just need someone to give you a little space." Zayn: "Yeah. Thanks." I held out my hand.

Yaya: "Listen, I'm the founder of the Survivors' Alliance." Amir immediately interrupted. Amir: "CO-FOUNDER! VICE PRESIDENT! CHIEF DOLLA DOLLA OFFICER!" Yaya: "You joined yesterday!" Amir: "AND I'VE BEEN CARRYING THIS ORGANIZATION EVER SINCE!" Yaya: "YOU HAVE DONE NOTHING!" Amir: "I PROVIDE EMOTIONAL SUPPORT!" Zayn started laughing. I shook my head. Yaya: "Anyway, our alliance is basically about looking out for each other. We respect boundaries, give people space when they need it, and help each other deal with the school's chaos." Amir: "And we occasionally play football." Yaya: "That's a pretty important part." Zayn considered it. Zayn: "So… I could join?" I smiled. Yaya: "Absolutely." Amir extended his fist. Amir: "Survivors' Alliance?" Zayn raised his fist. Zayn: "Survivors' Alliance." I joined them. Yaya: "Survivors' Alliance." THREE FISTS. ONE ALLIANCE. THE TRIO WAS OFFICIAL.

Then Amir snapped his fingers.

Amir: "WAIT! EVERY LEGENDARY SQUAD NEEDS NICKNAMES!" I immediately shook my head. Yaya: "Oh, no." Amir pointed at Zayn. Amir: "From this moment forward, your official nickname is…" He paused dramatically. Amir: "ZAYN THE MAINFRAME!" Silence. I blinked. Zayn blinked. Then I burst out laughing. Yaya: "BRO, WHAT DOES THAT EVEN MEAN?!" Amir shrugged. Amir: "It sounds cool." Zayn smiled. Zayn: "Honestly? I'll take it." I slapped the desk. Yaya: "IT'S OFFICIAL! YAYA, AMIR DOLLA DOLLA, AND ZAYN THE MAINFRAME!" Amir threw both hands into the air. Amir: "THE TRIO IS COMPLETE!" For a moment, everything felt right. We had a new friend. We had expanded the Survivors' Alliance. And we'd helped Zayn settle in without making him feel pressured. But then Zayn reached into his backpack. Zayn: "Hey, Yaya. Can I ask you something?" Yaya: "Sure, Mainframe." He pulled out a notebook.

I recognized it immediately. My smile faded. It was the same notebook from my dream. The same cover. The same strange feeling. Zayn opened it and flipped through a few pages. Zayn: "I was working on a project, and there's something in here I don't understand." He turned the notebook toward me. Written across the front were three words: INFINITE INSTINCT PROJECT. My heart started pounding. Yaya: "Where did you get that notebook?" Zayn: "It's mine. Why?" I couldn't answer immediately. Amir leaned over my shoulder. Amir: "Yaya…" Yaya: "I see it." Zayn flipped to another page. Then he pointed at a line written in bold letters. DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM. I stopped breathing for a second. Amir's mouth fell open. Amir: "BRO." Yaya: "Zayn…" Zayn: "Yeah?" I stared at the page. Yaya: "How do you know the name of my football move?" Zayn frowned. Zayn: "Your what?"

Yaya: "My football move. Infinite Instinct Phantom. That's what I call it." He looked genuinely confused. Zayn: "Wait. That's YOUR move?" Yaya: "YES!" Zayn turned the page back and forth. Zayn: "I don't understand. I wrote this down before I met you." Silence. Amir slowly turned toward me. I slowly turned toward Amir. Neither of us had a joke. Neither of us had an explanation. I looked at Zayn. Yaya: "Before you met me?" He nodded. Zayn: "Yeah. I don't even remember where I first heard the name. It was just in my notes." My mind raced. I'd dreamed about Zayn. I'd seen his notebook in the dream. I'd heard him talk about a memory I couldn't understand. And now he was standing in front of me, holding a notebook containing the name of my signature football move. A move I'd invented myself. I looked at Amir. Yaya: "Dolla Dolla." Amir: "Yeah?" Yaya: "I think my dream wasn't just a dream." Amir swallowed.

Amir: "Then what was it?" I looked at the notebook one more time. Yaya: "I don't know yet." Zayn closed it carefully. Zayn: "Guys… should I be worried?" I took a deep breath. Yaya: "No. But I think we need to figure out what's going on." Amir raised his fist. Amir: "SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE INVESTIGATION ARC!" Yaya: "For once, I actually agree with you." Zayn looked at both of us. Then he smiled nervously. Zayn: "Well… I guess I'm officially part of the team now." I nodded. Yaya: "Welcome to the Survivors' Alliance, Zayn the Mainframe." And somewhere in the back of my mind, I remembered the final words from my dream. You'll see me again. I had seen Zayn again. But the biggest mystery was still waiting. Why had I dreamed about him before meeting him? And why had he written down the name of my move before he knew it belonged to me? I had no answers. Not yet. But one thing was certain. Tomorrow wasn't going to be boring. Not with Amir Dolla Dolla, Zayn the Mainframe, and the strangest mystery I'd ever encountered.

And honestly? I had a feeling this was only the beginning.

End Of Chapter 10

Three survivors. One mysterious notebook. One dream that came true. And a football move that somehow existed in Zayn's notes before he ever met Yaya.

Chapter 11

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 11: The Fourth Survivor’s Secret

Three Survivors. Two couples. One new crush. One mysterious notebook. And a forgotten promise that might unlock everything. Scene 1: The Mainframe Has a Crush?!

Lunch had barely started when Zayn the Mainframe dropped a bombshell. We were sitting at our usual table: me, Lara, Amir Dolla Dolla, Avinia, and Zayn. Lara was eating her lunch while leaning against my shoulder. Amir was attempting to steal one of Avinia's fries and failing spectacularly. Zayn, meanwhile, was staring into the distance like an anime protagonist who had just discovered the meaning of existence. Yaya: "Bro, why do you look like your computer crashed?" Zayn: "I need to tell you something." Amir: "You're secretly a robot?"

Zayn: "No." Amir: "You're secretly a government experiment?" Zayn: "No!" Yaya: "You owe someone money?" Zayn: "WHY ARE YOUR FIRST THREE THEORIES ABOUT CRIMES?!" Lara giggled. Lara: "Just tell us, Zayn." He took a deep breath. Zayn: "I have a crush." Silence. Absolute silence. Then— Amir: "BROOOOOOOOOOO! " I nearly dropped my drink. Yaya: "THE MAINFRAME HAS DEVELOPED EMOTIONS?!" Zayn: "I'M GOING TO LEAVE THE ALLIANCE."

Amir: "YOU CAN'T LEAVE! WE HAVE A THREE-MEMBER SUBSCRIPTION!" Avinia covered her mouth, laughing. Avinia: "Okay, okay! Who is she?" Zayn's face turned red. He looked away. Zayn: "Violetta Amethyst." Lara's eyes widened. Lara: "WAIT! Violetta? Purple hair, honeycoloured eyes, always carrying that notebook?" Zayn nodded. Yaya: "Bro has a whole character profile ready." Zayn: "I KNOW HER NAME! THAT'S NORMAL!" Amir: "Do you know her favourite colour?" Zayn: "Purple." Amir: "Favourite subject?" Zayn: "Science."

Amir: "Favourite food?" Zayn paused. Zayn: "I don't know." Amir leaned back dramatically. Amir: "The investigation continues." Yaya: "Dolla Dolla, stop acting like the FBI of romance." Amir: "I WAS BORN FOR THIS." Zayn buried his face in his hands. Zayn: "Can we please discuss literally anything else?" Lara: "Absolutely!" She exchanged a look with Avinia. Both of them smiled. Lara and Avinia: "OPERATION PURPLE HONEY! " Zayn looked horrified. Zayn: "THAT IS NOT A REAL OPERATION!"

Yaya: "It is now." And just like that, the Survivors' Alliance had a new mission. Help Zayn get to know Violetta. Naturally. Respectfully. And without making him explode from embarrassment. Hopefully. Scene 2: The Notebook Strikes Again

After lunch, we returned to the classroom. Zayn opened his notebook to check his notes. Then he froze. Zayn: "Guys?" I turned around. Yaya: "What now? Did the notebook ask you to marry it?"

Zayn: "No. Look at this." He turned the notebook toward us. Written across a fresh page were the words: "THE FOURTH HEART WILL UNLOCK THE NEXT MEMORY." My smile disappeared. Amir: "Okay. Nope. That's officially creepy." Lara leaned closer. Lara: "Was that there before?" Zayn: "Absolutely not." Avinia looked at the page carefully. Avinia: "The fourth heart... Could it mean someone's feelings?" Zayn stared at the message. Zayn: "Maybe. But why would feelings unlock a memory?" I folded my arms. Yaya: "Because apparently our lives are written by an anime writer who hates explaining things."

Amir: "And refuses to give us a normal school day." Yaya: "Exactly." Zayn turned the page. Nothing. He checked the next one. Nothing. Then he returned to the mysterious message. Beneath it, in smaller writing, another sentence had appeared. "WHEN THE FOURTH HEART AWAKENS, THE NEXT MEMORY WILL RETURN." Nobody spoke. For once, even Amir had no joke ready. I looked at Zayn. Yaya: "Has anything like this happened before?" Zayn: "Not that I remember."

That answer bothered me more than it should have. Not that I remember. The notebook was talking about memories. Zayn had a mysterious notebook. And I had dreamed about Zayn before meeting him. Three things that probably shouldn't have been connected. Yet somehow, they were. Scene 3: The Fourth Heart Appears

The next lesson began. Our teacher started explaining the topic, but I could barely concentrate. I kept thinking about the notebook. Then the classroom door opened. Teacher: "Come in." Violetta Amethyst stepped inside. Her purple hair was neatly tied back, and her honey-coloured eyes scanned the room before

landing on Zayn. Violetta: "Sorry I'm late!" Teacher: "That's alright, Violetta. Take your seat." She walked toward her desk. On the way, she noticed Zayn looking at her. She smiled. Violetta: "Hi, Zayn!" Zayn immediately sat up straight. Zayn: "Hello." One word. Perfectly normal. A successful social interaction. Then he tried to put his notebook away and accidentally handed her his ruler. Violetta stared at it. Zayn stared at it.

I stared at it. Amir, sitting beside me, slowly covered his mouth. Violetta: "Um... thanks?" Zayn: "THAT'S A RULER." Violetta: "I noticed." Zayn: "I MEAN—YOUR NOTES! I WAS TRYING TO GIVE YOU YOUR NOTES!" He grabbed the correct book and handed it to her. Violetta laughed softly. Not mockingly. She genuinely found the situation funny. Violetta: "It's okay, Zayn. Happens to everyone." She took the notes and returned to her seat. Zayn sat down and stared at his desk. Zayn: "I am never speaking again." I leaned over.

Yaya: "Bro, you survived." Zayn: "I gave her a ruler." Amir: "A legendary ruler. The ruler of romance." I almost laughed out loud. Zayn: "I HATE BOTH OF YOU." Across the classroom, Violetta glanced back at him. She smiled again before turning toward the board. Zayn noticed. His expression softened. And for a moment, he forgot about the strange messages. He was just a boy with a crush. A boy trying to figure out how to talk to a girl he liked. Honestly? I understood that feeling. Scene 4: The Survivors Investigate

During independent work, Amir and I gathered around Zayn's desk. Lara and Avinia joined us a moment later. Yaya: "Okay. New rule. We investigate the notebook without jumping to conclusions." Amir: "Agreed." Lara: "Could Violetta be the fourth heart?" Zayn nearly dropped his pen. Zayn: "CAN WE NOT MAKE MY CRUSH PART OF A SUPERNATURAL MYSTERY?!" Avinia: "We're not saying she definitely is. We're just considering possibilities." I nodded. Yaya: "Exactly. We don't know what the fourth heart means. It could be symbolic, or it could mean something else entirely." Zayn opened the notebook again. The mysterious messages were still there. I compared them with the handwriting on the

surrounding pages. The letters looked different. The spacing was unusual. And the messages appeared to have been written by someone who knew things we didn't. Amir: "Maybe someone is pranking you." Zayn: "Then how are the messages appearing on blank pages when nobody is touching them?" Amir: "A very committed prankster?" Yaya: "Dolla Dolla." Amir: "I'm brainstorming!" Lara pointed toward the notebook. Lara: "What if the fourth heart is connected to the next memory, but not necessarily to a person?" That made me pause. Yaya: "That's possible." Avinia: "Maybe the heart represents a connection. Friendship, trust, or something from the past."

Zayn considered that. Zayn: "A connection that brings back a memory..." He looked down at the notebook. Zayn: "Why does that sound familiar?" I noticed his expression. Yaya: "Zayn?" He blinked. Zayn: "Nothing. I thought I remembered something, but it disappeared." The five of us exchanged looks. A strange notebook. A memory Zayn couldn't remember. And a dream I'd experienced before meeting him. Whatever was happening, we were missing a piece. And the notebook seemed determined to make sure we knew it. Scene 5: Operation Purple Honey

At lunch, the Survivors' Alliance held an emergency meeting. The official title? OPERATION PURPLE HONEY. The objective? Help Zayn become comfortable talking to Violetta. The rules? No embarrassing schemes, no forcing conversations, and absolutely no treating Violetta like a prize to be won. Yaya: "Rule one:

Zayn talks to her naturally." Amir: "Rule two: I am forbidden from providing romantic commentary." Everyone looked at him. Amir: "... I will attempt to follow rule two." Avinia: "That's the best we're getting." Lara turned to Zayn. Lara: "You don't have to confess anything. Just

get to know her." Zayn: "What if I say something stupid?" Yaya: "Then you say something stupid. It happens." Amir: "I once told Avinia that her hair looked like a golden Wi-Fi signal." Avinia slowly turned toward him. Avinia: "You WHAT?" Amir: "AND SHE STILL LIKES ME! THAT'S THE POWER OF LOVE!" Avinia: "I liked you before you said that!" Amir: "DETAILS!" We all burst out laughing. Zayn finally smiled. Zayn: "Alright. I'll try." Lara: "That's all we're asking." For a few minutes, everything felt normal. Friends joking.

Couples laughing. Zayn looking a little less nervous. Then he opened his notebook to write down the operation's name. His smile vanished. A new message had appeared. "WHEN THE FOURTH HEART AWAKENS, THE NEXT MEMORY WILL RETURN." I stared at the words. They were identical to the earlier message. But now, beneath them, there was a tiny mark. An infinity symbol. I leaned closer. Yaya: "Guys..." Amir stopped laughing. Lara and Avinia looked over. Zayn slowly closed the notebook.

Zayn: "This isn't a joke, is it?" Nobody answered. Because none of us knew. But one thing was certain. The mystery wasn't going away. And somewhere inside Zayn's notebook, a secret was waiting to be remembered. Scene 6: The Mainframe Enters Training Mode

After lunch, Zayn decided he needed to clear his head. His solution? Football training. Zayn: "I'm going to the field." Lara: "Good. We're coming." Avinia: "You need practice if you're going to keep up with us!" Zayn looked between them.

Zayn: "You two are going to train me?" Lara: "That's the plan." Amir: "Bro, you're about to experience the most difficult software update in history." Yaya: "Mainframe version 2.0: now with legs!" Zayn: "I regret joining this alliance." Yaya: "Too late. No refunds." Lara grabbed a football and headed toward the field with Avinia. Zayn followed them. Amir and I watched them leave. Then we exchanged a look. Amir: "You thinking what I'm thinking?" Yaya: "We investigate the notebook." Amir: "BRO. DETECTIVE ARC ACTIVATED! " We turned back toward the classroom. The training arc was theirs.

The mystery was ours. Scene 7: The Mainframe Gets Cooked

At the field, Lara tossed the ball toward Zayn. Lara: "First drill. Keep possession while Avinia pressures you." Zayn: "Easy." He received the ball and dribbled forward. For approximately two seconds, he looked impressive. Then Lara stole it. Lara: "Too slow!" She passed to Avinia, who moved into space and sent the ball around Zayn. Avinia: "Nice try!" Zayn stared at them. Zayn: "HOW ARE YOU BOTH SO FAST?!" Lara: "Practice!" Avinia: "And teamwork!"

Zayn adjusted his glasses. His embarrassment faded, replaced by concentration. Zayn: "Lara changes direction quickly. Avinia looks for open passing lanes. If I anticipate the pass instead of chasing the ball..." Lara passed to Avinia again. This time, Zayn moved early. He intercepted the pass cleanly and dribbled through the cones. Avinia: "WAIT! THAT WAS GOOD!" Lara: "Okay, Mainframe. Let's increase the difficulty." Zayn's confidence disappeared. Zayn: "I would like to withdraw my previous statement about football being easy." They continued training. He missed passes, mistimed his footwork, and nearly tripped over a cone.

But he improved. Slowly, his analytical mind began working with his footwork. He stopped merely reacting and started anticipating. By the end of the session, he could read some of Lara and Avinia's movements before they happened. Zayn: "I think I'm getting the hang of this." Lara: "See? You're learning!" Avinia: "And you haven't been defeated by a cone yet!" Zayn glanced at the cone he'd nearly tripped over. Zayn: "That cone knows what it did." Lara and Avinia burst out laughing. For once, Zayn wasn't thinking about the notebook. He was enjoying himself. And that was progress. Scene 8: Mainframe's First Real Win

Lara placed the ball in the centre of the field. Lara: "One final challenge. Three passes, then a shot." Zayn: "Against both of you?" Avinia: "Against both of us." Zayn took his position. Lara passed. Zayn controlled the ball. Avinia moved to intercept. He noticed her angle and changed direction. Zayn: "Now!" He passed the ball into the space between them, ran forward, received it again, and took his shot. The ball rolled past the cones and into the small goal. For a moment, nobody moved.

Then— Lara: "YES! THAT'S IT!" Avinia: "ZAYN! YOU DID IT!" Zayn stared at the goal as if he'd just solved a mathematical theorem. Zayn: "I... actually did it." Lara: "Of course you did!" Avinia: "You analysed the situation and acted on it. That's your strength." Zayn smiled. Zayn: "Thanks. Both of you." Lara tossed him the ball. Lara: "You're officially improving, Mainframe." Zayn: "I accept this title." Avinia: "You know, if you keep training, you could become a really useful member of the team." Zayn: "I'll work on it." For the first time, Zayn looked like he genuinely

belonged with us. Not because he had a mysterious notebook. Not because he'd appeared in my dream. But because he was our friend. And friends helped each other grow. Even if their training sessions involved getting cooked by two girls with excellent football skills. Scene 9: Violetta Notices

After training, Zayn sat on the grass, catching his breath. Lara and Avinia were packing their things when Violetta walked past the field. She spotted them and approached. Violetta: "Hey! You guys were training?" Lara: "Yep! We're helping Zayn improve." Violetta looked at Zayn. Violetta: "I saw your last shot. That was impressive!"

Zayn immediately sat up straighter. Zayn: "Thank you." A pause. Zayn: "The ball moved... toward the goal." Lara turned away. Avinia pressed her lips together. Both were fighting for their lives trying not to laugh. Violetta giggled. Violetta: "Yes, Zayn. That's generally where you want it to go." Zayn: "Right. Obviously." He looked like his brain had opened seventeen tabs and every single one had stopped responding. But Violetta wasn't laughing at him cruelly. She seemed to enjoy talking to him. Violetta: "Are you going to keep training?"

Zayn: "Yeah. I want to improve." Violetta: "That's cool. Good luck!" She smiled and waved before continuing down the path. Zayn watched her leave. Lara nudged his shoulder. Lara: "You survived another conversation!" Avinia: "And you didn't hand her a ruler!" Zayn: "I'M MAKING PROGRESS!" Lara: "Massive progress, Mainframe." Zayn smiled despite himself. Maybe getting to know Violetta wouldn't be as impossible as he'd imagined. He just needed to take it one conversation at a time. Scene 10: Yaya and Dolla Dolla Investigate

Meanwhile, back in the classroom... Amir and I sat at our desks with Zayn's notebook

between us. I opened my own notebook and wrote: CASE FILE: THE MYSTERIOUS WRITER Known facts: 1. Zayn's notebook contained INFINITE INSTINCT PROJECT before he met me. 2. It mentioned DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM. 3. The mysterious messages appeared in handwriting Zayn didn't recognize. 4. The messages mentioned a fourth heart and a returning memory. 5. We had no evidence identifying the writer. Amir read the list. Amir: "Bro, why does your football move have a classified file?" Yaya: "Because my life has become a supernatural investigation with extra homework." Amir: "Fair." We compared the mysterious handwriting with Zayn's normal notes. His handwriting was neat and tilted slightly to

the right. The messages looked different. Their letters were sharper, and the spacing was unusually precise. Yaya: "It doesn't look like his usual handwriting." Amir: "Maybe he's secretly a genius with terrible memory." Yaya: "Or maybe you're secretly a genius with terrible theories." Amir: "I'M HELPING!" I turned another page. Then another. Nothing. Finally, I noticed a faint symbol near the bottom of the back cover. An infinity sign. But it wasn't my usual symbol. This one had a line cutting through its centre, and four tiny dots beneath it.

One. Two. Three. Four. Amir: "Four dots." Yaya: "Four Survivors?" Amir counted on his fingers. Amir: "Me, you, Zayn..." He stopped. Yaya: "And?" Amir: "That's the problem. We're three." We stared at the symbol.

Amir: "Could it mean the fourth heart?" Yaya: "Maybe. But we're not jumping to conclusions." I copied the symbol into my case file. We weren't going to accuse anyone without

evidence. But we weren't ignoring this either. Scene 11: The Notebook Writes Again?!

Amir and I continued examining the pages. We checked the cover, the binding, and the spaces between the sheets. Nothing. Then I noticed something strange. The latest message had a tiny mark beneath the final word. I was certain it hadn't been there earlier. Yaya: "Amir. Look." He leaned over. Beneath the words THE NEXT MEMORY WILL RETURN was a small question mark. Amir: "Was that there before?" Yaya: "No." Amir: "Yaya..."

I turned the notebook toward him. Yaya: "Neither of us has written in it." Amir: "And nobody else has been here." We stared at the page. Then, right before our eyes, another line appeared beneath the question mark. The ink became visible, letter by letter. "YOU ARE LOOKING IN THE WRONG PLACE." Amir shot out of his chair. Amir: "NOPE. ABSOLUTELY NOT. I'M TRANSFERRING SCHOOLS!" I nearly dropped the notebook. Yaya: "BRO, SIT DOWN!" Amir: "THE NOTEBOOK JUST TEXTED US WITHOUT A PHONE!" Yaya: "I CAN SEE THAT!" Amir: "THEN WHY ARE YOU STILL HOLDING IT?!"

I placed the notebook flat on the desk. My heart was racing, but I forced myself to think. The message didn't tell us to stop investigating. It told us we were looking in the wrong place. Which meant we were missing something. I looked at Amir. Yaya: "We need Zayn." Amir: "Agreed. Immediately. Preferably before the notebook starts charging rent." I closed the cover. The strange symbol on the back seemed almost to stare at me. Four dots. One infinity sign. One line through the middle. And a message that had appeared when nobody touched the page.

Yaya: "Whatever this is, we're finding out." Amir: "Together?" I held out my fist. Yaya: "Together." He bumped it. Amir: "Survivors' Alliance. No backing out." Yaya: "No backing out." Scene 12: The Fourth Heart

When Zayn returned to the classroom, Amir and I were waiting. Yaya: "Mainframe. We have a problem." Zayn: "The notebook wrote again?" I froze. Amir: "WAIT. HOW DID YOU KNOW?!" Zayn looked between us. Zayn: "Because it did something similar before I met you."

Amir slowly sat down. Amir: "I need everyone to stop revealing new supernatural information without scheduling a meeting first." Zayn placed his bag on the desk and opened the notebook. Zayn: "A few days before I transferred here, I found a message inside it. I thought I'd written it myself and forgotten about it." He unfolded a piece of paper. Four words were written across it: "THE FOURTH HEART REMEMBERS." Silence. Yaya: "You've had that message this whole time?" Zayn: "I didn't understand it. I didn't know it mattered." I told him about the new message. YOU ARE LOOKING IN THE WRONG PLACE. Zayn read it twice.

Zayn: "Maybe the notebook isn't telling us to search harder." Amir: "It's telling us to search somewhere else?" Zayn: "Or someone else." I stared at the symbol again. Four dots. Three Survivors. One missing piece. Yaya: "We don't involve Violetta in this unless we have a real reason. We can't drag her into something just because the notebook mentions a fourth heart." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "Agreed. She deserves to be treated like a person, not a clue." Amir: "Finally, some common sense in this classroom." Yaya: "You literally tried to transfer schools because of a notebook." Amir: "A NOTEBOOK THAT WRITES BY ITSELF, YAHYA!"

I laughed. Then the notebook opened by itself. A new message appeared. "THE FOURTH HEART IS CLOSER THAN YOU THINK." Another sentence formed beneath it. "AND ONE OF YOU HAS ALREADY MET IT." My smile vanished. Amir stared at me. Zayn stared at the notebook. And I had a terrible feeling that the notebook wasn't talking about a stranger. It was talking about someone we already knew. Scene 13: The Memory Behind the Mystery

For a few seconds, nobody moved. Amir: "Yaya, please tell me you have a normal explanation." Yaya: "Bro, I struggle to explain my own

homework. What makes you think I can explain a notebook that writes by itself?" Zayn: "It says one of us has already met the fourth heart." Yaya: "That could mean any of us." Amir counted on his fingers. Amir: "I've met Lara, Avinia, every teacher who's given me homework, and the cafeteria lady who knows when I'm trying to get extra food." Yaya: "A truly impressive social network." Amir: "Thank you." Zayn shook his head. Zayn: "We need to think about the wording. It says we've already met the fourth heart. It doesn't say we know who it is." I leaned closer to the notebook. Yaya: "What if it's someone we've known for a while? Someone connected to a memory we've forgotten?" The notebook's pages suddenly flipped.

They stopped at a blank sheet. A new message appeared. "DO NOT SEARCH FOR A NEW FACE." Then another line. "SEARCH FOR THE MEMORY YOU SHARE." Zayn went completely still. Zayn: "A memory we share..." I remembered my dream. The glowing stadium. The floating football. Zayn standing in front of me before we'd ever met. Yaya: "Wait a second. Zayn, in my dream, you told me to remember a name I hadn't learned yet." Zayn's expression changed. Zayn: "I remember what you told me." Amir: "So the fourth heart could be connected to the dream?"

Yaya: "Maybe." Zayn opened his notebook again. Zayn: "There's something I haven't told you." We waited. Zayn: "Before I transferred here, I kept having strange dreams. I couldn't remember most of them when I woke up, but I always remembered one thing." Yaya: "What?" Zayn: "A voice telling me that I was missing someone." Amir stopped joking. Amir: "Someone?" Zayn nodded. Zayn: "I never saw their face. I just heard the voice. Every time I tried to remember who it was, the dream disappeared." I stared at him. A voice.

A missing memory. A mysterious notebook. And a dream that had somehow shown me Zayn before we met. Yaya: "Did the voice ever say anything else?" Zayn closed his eyes. Zayn: "I think it said... 'When the fourth heart awakens, you'll remember us.'" Amir pointed at the notebook. Amir: "BRO. THAT IS BASICALLY THE SAME MESSAGE!" Yaya: "What if the missing memory involves more than one person?" Zayn looked unsettled. Zayn: "Then why do I feel like I'm the only one who has forgotten it?" I had no answer. But I knew we were getting closer. Scene 14: Lara and Avinia Join the

Investigation The classroom door opened. Lara and Avinia walked in, with Lara carrying the football. Lara: "There you are! We finished training, and Zayn actually scored against us!" Avinia: "He's improving really quickly!" Zayn smiled. Zayn: "Thanks. You two are great coaches." Then Lara noticed our faces. Lara: "Okay. What happened?" Amir pointed at the notebook. Amir: "The notebook has officially entered its villain arc." Avinia came closer. Avinia: "Another message?" I nodded. Yaya: "It says the fourth heart is someone one of

us has already met. Then it told us to search for a shared memory." Lara frowned. Lara: "A shared memory?" Yaya: "Zayn told us about his dreams. He keeps hearing a voice saying he's missing someone." Avinia looked at Zayn. Avinia: "Do you remember anything about the person?" Zayn: "No face. No name. Nothing clear." Lara folded her arms. Lara: "Then we shouldn't guess who it is. We need more clues." Yaya: "Exactly." I tried to remember the stadium from my dream. The purple-and-silver sky. The football floating above the centre circle. The three silhouettes standing in the distance.

But whenever I tried to focus on their faces, everything became blurry. Yaya: "I remember Zayn, the stadium, and the football. Everything else is unclear." Zayn looked at me. Zayn: "Maybe that's the memory the notebook wants us to recover." Before I could answer, the notebook's pages began turning again. Everyone stepped back. A final message appeared. "THE FIRST MEMORY BELONGS TO YAYA." My stomach dropped. Amir: "WAIT. WHY IS YOUR NAME IN THE NOTEBOOK?!" Yaya: "I WOULD LOVE TO KNOW!" Lara took my hand. Lara: "Yaya, are you okay?" I nodded, even though my mind was racing.

The notebook had mentioned my move before Zayn met me. It had connected Zayn's dreams to mine. And now it was saying the first missing memory belonged to me. Yaya: "Whatever happened in that dream... I think I need to remember it." Scene 15: The Dream Behind the Dream

That night, I went to sleep with one thought repeating in my head. The first memory belongs to Yaya. I closed my eyes. And suddenly— I was back in the stadium. The sky glowed purple and silver. The football floated above the centre circle. The stands were empty, yet I could hear thousands of voices whispering. I looked around.

Yaya: "Hello? Anyone here?" A figure stood near the halfway line. Not Zayn. Someone else. I couldn't see their face. They wore a school uniform and held their hands tightly at their sides. Yaya: "Who are you?" The figure didn't answer. Instead, they pointed toward the football. A second figure appeared beside them. Then a third. Three silhouettes. Standing together. Watching me. I took a step forward.

Yaya: "Wait. I know you..." The stadium lights flickered. A voice echoed through the arena. Mysterious Voice: "You promised you would remember." My heart began pounding. Yaya: "Remember WHAT?!" The football dropped. It hit the grass. And the entire stadium went silent. Then I heard another voice. A voice I recognised. Zayn's Voice: "Yaya... wake up." The dream shattered. I opened my eyes in my bedroom, breathing quickly. For a moment, I couldn't move.

Then I sat up and grabbed my notebook. Three silhouettes. A purple-and-silver stadium. A promise. You promised you would remember. And one detail I couldn't explain. The first silhouette had been standing slightly apart from the others. As if they had been waiting for me. Yaya: "What did I promise you?" No answer came. But I knew I was close to something important. Scene 16: The Promise I Forgot

I sat up in bed, staring at the notes I'd written. The dream was still fresh in my mind. The purple-and-silver stadium.

The three silhouettes. The mysterious voice. You promised you would remember. I closed my eyes and tried to remember the stadium again. Then it hit me. Not another dream. A real memory. A memory from the day I showcased my signature move in front of everyone. DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM. I remembered the football field packed with students. Everyone had gathered to watch me demonstrate the technique that had become my signature move. I remembered the ball at my feet. The silence before the demonstration. The way everyone reacted when I activated my move.

And then I remembered her. A girl standing near the front of the crowd. I couldn't remember every detail of her face yet, but I remembered her voice clearly. Girl: "Yaya? I'd really like it if you could teach me that move sometime." I froze. Yaya: "WAIT." I jumped out of bed. Yaya: "SHE ASKED ME TO TEACH HER!" My brain replayed the moment again. She hadn't challenged me. She hadn't asked me to prove myself. She had simply looked at me with genuine excitement and asked if I would teach her my signature move. And I remembered what I'd told her. Yaya: "Of course! I'll teach you when we get the chance."

I stared at the wall. I had made a promise. A promise I'd completely forgotten. Yaya: "BROOOOOOOO. " I grabbed my phone, then stopped. It was the middle of the night. I wasn't about to wake up the entire Survivors' Alliance just because my brain had finally decided to load an important memory. But there was one question I couldn't escape. Who was that girl? And why had the notebook connected her to the fourth heart? Scene 17: The Survivors' Emergency Meeting

The next morning, I practically sprinted into school. Amir spotted me from across the classroom. Amir: "WHY ARE YOU RUNNING LIKE YOU JUST SAW YOUR EXAM RESULTS?!"

Yaya: "BRO, I REMEMBERED SOMETHING!" Zayn immediately closed his notebook. Lara turned around. Avinia looked up from her desk. Lara: "What happened?" I dropped my bag onto my chair. Yaya: "I remembered the day I showcased Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom!" Amir stood up so quickly that his chair nearly fell over. Amir: "THE SIGNATURE MOVE INCIDENT?!" Yaya: "YES!" Zayn: "What did you remember?" I took a breath. Yaya: "A girl asked me to teach her the move." Everyone went quiet. Lara tilted her head.

Lara: "A girl?" Yaya: "Yeah. She was watching the demonstration, and afterward, she told me she'd really like me to teach her." Avinia smiled. Avinia: "That's actually sweet. She must have been impressed." Amir: "Of course she was impressed! Yaya activates one impossible football technique and suddenly the whole school wants the tutorial!" Yaya: "Dolla Dolla, focus!" Zayn opened his notebook again. Zayn: "The message said the first memory belongs to you. Now you've remembered a girl connected to your move." He wrote something down. Zayn: "This could be our first real clue." I nodded. Yaya: "But I still can't remember her name."

Lara put a reassuring hand on my shoulder. Lara: "Then we'll figure it out. We don't need to rush." Zayn turned his notebook toward us. A fresh line had appeared beneath the previous message. "THE PROMISE WAS NEVER FORGOTTEN." Amir stared at the page. Amir: "Okay. That's personal." Yaya: "It knows about the promise." Zayn: "Which means this isn't just random writing." I looked toward the school building. Somewhere inside was the girl I'd promised to teach. I just didn't know who she was yet. Scene 18: Replaying the Showcase

During break, we gathered near the football field.

I stood where I'd performed the demonstration. The others waited nearby while I tried to reconstruct the event. Yaya: "Okay. I remember standing here. The students were gathered around the pitch. I showed everyone how the move worked." I closed my eyes. The memory returned in fragments. The crowd cheering. The ball rolling across the grass. The moment I activated DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM. And then— The girl. She had been standing near the front of the crowd, watching with complete attention. I remembered her stepping forward after the demonstration. Girl: "Yaya, that was amazing! Would you teach me

how to do that?" Yaya: "Of course! Come find me, and we'll practise together." The memory stopped there. I opened my eyes. Yaya: "That's all I've got." Amir: "Did she say her name?" Yaya: "I can't remember." Avinia: "Do you remember what she looked like?" I concentrated. Yaya: "Not enough to identify her. I remember her voice and that she seemed genuinely excited about learning the move." Lara nodded thoughtfully. Lara: "Then we shouldn't guess. There might be several girls who watched your showcase." Zayn: "Agreed. We need to find the original event records or ask people who were there." Amir snapped his fingers.

Amir: "NOW THAT IS A PLAN!" Yaya: "Finally, the Dolla Dolla brain cell has clocked in." Amir: "I'M PUTTING YOUR NAME IN MY NEXT COMEBACK." I laughed. For the first time since the mystery began, we had something concrete to investigate. Not a vague dream. Not an unexplained symbol. A real conversation. A real promise. And a girl who might still be waiting for me to keep it. Scene 19: The Promise

Later, Lara walked beside me near the field. Lara: "You seem worried." I glanced at her.

Yaya: "I am. What if I forgot something important to her?" Lara thought about that for a moment. Lara: "Then you can apologise when you find her. You didn't forget on purpose." Yaya: "I know. I just don't like making promises and not keeping them." Lara smiled. Lara: "That's one of the things I like about you, Yaya. You care about keeping your word." I smiled back. Yaya: "Thanks, Lara." She gave my hand a reassuring squeeze. Lara: "We'll help you find her. And when you do, you can teach her the move like you promised." That made me feel better. This wasn't about proving myself or showing off. It was about following through on something I'd said.

Across the field, Zayn was examining his notebook while Amir and Avinia debated possible explanations. Then Zayn suddenly called out. Zayn: "YAYA! COME LOOK AT THIS!" I hurried over. On the page,

beneath the message about the promise, a new sentence had appeared. "SHE HAS BEEN WAITING FOR YOU TO REMEMBER." My smile disappeared. Amir stared at the page. Amir: "Okay. That's personal." Yaya: "It knows about the promise." Zayn: "Which means this isn't just random writing." I looked toward the school building. Somewhere inside was the girl I'd promised to teach.

I just didn't know who she was yet. Yaya: "I'm going to find her." Lara joined my side. Lara: "And we'll help." Amir raised his fist. Amir: "SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE. INVESTIGATION MODE!" Avinia laughed. Avinia: "Just try not to interrogate the entire school." Amir: "I MAKE NO PROMISES." Yaya: "THAT'S LITERALLY THE OPPOSITE OF WHAT WE'RE INVESTIGATING, BRO!" Everyone laughed. But as we walked back toward the classroom, I couldn't stop thinking about those words. She has been waiting for you to remember. I had no idea who the girl was. I didn't know why the notebook was connected to

her. And I didn't understand what the fourth heart had to do with any of this. But I knew what came next. I had to find the girl from the showcase. And this time, I wasn't going to forget my promise. End Of Chapter 11

The Fourth Survivor's Secret.

Chapter 12

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 12: The Chase for the Memory

The 0.1% Chance… and the Name I Never Expected Scene 1: The Impossible Search

I walked into school the next morning with one mission. Find the girl. The girl whose name I had forgotten. The girl who had asked me to teach her Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom. The girl I had promised I would never leave waiting. There was just one problem. I attended a school full of girls. Thousands of possible suspects. No name. No reliable description.

No useful evidence. I stopped in the middle of the hallway. Yaya: "WAIT A SECOND." Amir turned around. Amir: "What now?" Yaya: "BRO. THIS SCHOOL IS LITERALLY ALL GIRLS." Amir: "Congratulations on discovering your school environment." Yaya: "HOW AM I SUPPOSED TO FIND ONE GIRL WHEN EVERY SINGLE PERSON I PASS COULD POTENTIALLY BE HER?!" Amir considered this for a moment. Amir: "Skill issue." Yaya: "I'M GOING TO DELETE YOU FROM THE SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE." Amir: "YOU CAN'T. I'M THE CO-FOUNDER." I took out my phone and opened the calculator. Yaya: "My chances are probably 0.1%."

Amir: "You calculated that?" Yaya: "No." Amir: "THEN THAT ISN'T MATHEMATICS!" Yaya: "IT'S EMOTIONAL MATHEMATICS!" Lara and Avinia joined us, both trying not to laugh. Lara: "Okay, Yaya. Let's start with what you actually remember." I took a deep breath. Yaya: "She watched my Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase. Afterward, she came up to me and asked if I'd teach her the move. I promised I would." Avinia: "Good. That's our first clue." Amir: "And our second clue is that Yaya has the investigative abilities of a confused potato." Yaya: "BRO, I'M TRYING TO SOLVE A SUPERNATURAL MYSTERY!" Lara: "Then let's solve it together." And just like that, Operation: Find the Girl officially began. Scene 2: Operation — Find the Girl

We gathered at our usual table during lunch. Zayn placed his mysterious notebook in the middle. Zayn: "Let's review the evidence." Amir: "Evidence one: Yaya has a terrible memory." Yaya: "OBJECTION!" Avinia: "Overruled." Yaya: "THIS COURT IS CORRUPT!" Lara opened her notes. Lara: "Evidence one: the girl attended the showcase. Evidence two: she spoke to Yaya afterward. Evidence three: Yaya promised to teach her the move." Zayn: "Evidence four: the notebook says the fourth heart is connected to a forgotten memory." I stared at him. Yaya: "Why does your notebook sound like the final boss of a psychological anime?"

Zayn: "I didn't write any of this." Amir: "That's exactly what a suspicious notebook owner would say." Zayn: "AMIR." Amir: "Fine, fine." We agreed on a plan. First, we would ask the teacher who organized the showcase whether there were photographs or participant records. Second, we would check the event's old footage, if any existed. Third, we would avoid accusing random girls of being the mystery person. Avinia: "And we don't pressure anyone." Lara: "Exactly. If we find her, we ask politely." Yaya: "Agreed. I'm not turning the school into a detective interrogation room." Amir slowly lowered his hand. Yaya: "Amir, why is your hand raised?"

Amir: "I was going to suggest interrogation chairs." Yaya: "NO." Zayn opened the notebook. A sentence appeared on the page. THE MEMORY IS NOT LOST. A second sentence followed. IT IS HIDDEN IN PLAIN SIGHT. We all leaned closer. Yaya: "Hidden in plain sight?" Lara: "Maybe you've seen her recently." Zayn: "Maybe she's someone you already know." Amir: "Maybe the real mystery is why we keep trusting this notebook." The page turned by itself. One word appeared. NO.

Amir slowly leaned away from the table. Amir: "I WOULD LIKE TO WITHDRAW MY STATEMENT." Scene 3: Where the Promise Began

After lunch, I went to the football field. This was where the showcase had taken place. I stood near the centre circle, remembering the cheers, the bright stadium lights, and the football spinning through the air. I could almost hear the crowd again. Yaya: "I remember the move. I remember the showcase. I remember someone approaching me afterward." I closed my eyes. A vague image appeared in my mind. A girl standing a short distance away. A voice asking me something. But the face remained unclear. Mysterious Girl: "Yaya? I'd really like it if you

could teach me that move sometime." Dream Yaya: "Of course! I'll teach you when we get the chance." I opened my eyes. Yaya: "I remember the conversation perfectly. How can I forget the person?" Zayn stood beside me. Zayn: "Maybe the memory is incomplete for a reason." Yaya: "That is a deeply unhelpful possibility." Zayn: "I'm trying." Yaya: "I KNOW, BRO." Amir kicked a football gently toward me. Amir: "Then let's focus on what we can do. We ask the teacher tomorrow." I stopped the ball beneath my foot. Yaya: "Yeah. We start there." I glanced at the goal.

For one second, I imagined the mystery girl standing beside it, waiting for the lesson I'd promised. Then the image vanished. And the empty field seemed much bigger than before. Scene 4: Lara's Question

Later, Lara found me sitting beside the field. She sat next to me. Lara: "You've been thinking about this all day." Yaya: "Yeah." Lara: "Can I ask you something?" Yaya: "Anything." She looked at me. Lara: "If you find her, are you really going to teach her the move?" I turned toward her. Yaya: "Of course. I promised her."

Lara nodded thoughtfully. Lara: "Even if it takes a while?" Yaya: "Even if it takes a while." I paused. Yaya: "Lara, I'm not searching for another girlfriend. I'm trying to keep my word to someone. You know you're my girlfriend." She smiled. Lara: "I know. I just wanted to hear you say it." Yaya: "You could've asked me without making my heart do a backflip." Lara: "But then I wouldn't get to watch you panic." Yaya: "YOU'RE EVIL." Lara: "A little." We laughed. Then she took my hand. Lara: "We'll find her, Yaya. Together."

Yaya: "Together." For the first time that day, the mission didn't feel impossible. It felt like something we could actually solve. Scene 5: The Notebook Knows Something

That evening, I sat at my desk and wrote down everything we knew. CASE FILE: THE FORGOTTEN PROMISE - The mystery girl attended my Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase. - She approached me after the event. - She asked me to teach her the move. - I promised that I would. - I forgot who she was. - The notebook says the fourth heart is connected to the memory. I stared at the page. Yaya: "Still no name. Excellent work, detective." My phone buzzed. It was Zayn. Zayn: "Check the notebook again."

I opened it. A new message had appeared. THE FIRST CLUE IS WHERE THE PROMISE BEGAN. I immediately messaged the group. Yaya: "TOMORROW WE ASK THE TEACHER WHO ORGANIZED THE SHOWCASE." Amir: "Finally, an actual plan." Avinia: "We might find the photographs!" Lara: "We're getting closer." Zayn: "I hope so." I looked at the notebook one last time. Yaya: "Whoever you are, I haven't forgotten the promise on purpose. If you still want me to teach you, I will." The page remained still. No glowing letters. No creepy messages.

For once, the notebook seemed satisfied. I closed it and went to bed, ready to investigate the next day. I had no idea that the answer was about to turn our entire investigation upside down. Scene 6: The Question Nobody Expected

Before sleeping, I suddenly had another idea. What if I didn't ask the notebook to reveal the girl's full identity? What if I asked for just one small clue? Yaya: "The letters of her name." I sat up. Yaya: "That's it. No face. No address. No dramatic supernatural biography. Just the letters." I opened the notebook to a blank page. Then I wrote: What are the letters of the girl's name? Nothing happened.

I waited. Yaya: "Come on, notebook. One job." The page began glowing purple. My smile disappeared. A single letter appeared. V. Then another. I. Then another. O. I leaned forward. L. E. T. T. A.

I stared at the letters. I read them again. And again. Yaya: "V… I… O… L… E… T… T… A." My entire brain stopped functioning. Yaya: "NO WAY." The notebook continued writing. THE NAME IS VIOLETTA. I jumped to my feet. Yaya: "VIOLETTA?!" Then the final line appeared. VIOLETTA AMETHYST. I stared at the page in complete disbelief. Purple hair. Honey-coloured eyes. The girl Zayn liked.

The girl who had recently complimented his football shot. The girl who had been standing right in front of us all this time. Yaya: "BROOOOOOOOOOOOOO!" I grabbed my phone. Yaya: "SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE EMERGENCY MEETING. RIGHT NOW." Scene 7: The Group Chat Apocalypse

Yaya: "GUYS. THE NOTEBOOK GAVE ME A NAME." Amir: "FINALLY." Avinia: "WHO?!" Lara: "YAYA, TELL US!" I sent the photograph. Three seconds passed. Then the group chat exploded. Amir: "VIOLETTA???????????????"

Avinia: "VIOLETTA AMETHYST?!" Lara: "WAIT. ZAYN'S VIOLETTA?!" Zayn: "…" Zayn: "WHAT." Amir: "BROOOOOOOOOO " Zayn: "YAYA, ARE YOU SURE?" Yaya: "I ASKED THE NOTEBOOK FOR THE LETTERS. IT SPELLED HER NAME." Zayn: "But why would Violetta be connected to your memory?" Yaya: "THAT IS LITERALLY WHAT I'M TRYING TO FIGURE OUT!" Another message appeared on the notebook. SHE REMEMBERS THE PROMISE. I sent the picture to the group. Nobody joked this time. Lara: "She remembers?" Avinia: "Then she knows about the showcase."

Zayn: "We need to speak to her." Yaya: "Agreed. But we do it calmly. We don't pressure her, and we don't assume we understand everything." Amir: "For once, the chaotic person is making sense." Yaya: "I'M SCREENSHOTTING THAT." Amir: "DELETE IT." I looked at Violetta's name on the page. For days, I'd been searching for a mystery girl. And the answer had been right there. Yaya: "Tomorrow, we talk to Violetta." Scene 8: The Truth About the Promise

The next morning, we found Violetta near the courtyard windows. She was reading a book when she noticed us approaching. Violetta: "Morning, everyone!"

Yaya: "Morning, Violetta. Can we ask you something?" Violetta: "Sure. What's up?" I took a breath. Yaya: "Do you remember my Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase?" Her expression changed slightly. Violetta: "Of course I do." My heart started pounding. Yaya: "After the showcase, did you come up to me and ask if I'd teach you the move?" Violetta lowered her book. Then she looked directly at me. Violetta: "You remember that?" I froze. Yaya: "I remember the promise. I just couldn't remember who I'd made it to." She was quiet for a moment.

Then she smiled. Violetta: "I thought you'd forgotten." Those words hit me harder than I expected. Yaya: "I'm sorry, Violetta. I didn't mean to forget." Violetta: "It's okay. It was a while ago." Yaya: "But I promised you I'd teach you. And I intend to keep that promise." Her face brightened. Violetta: "Really?" Yaya: "Really. If you still want to learn, we can arrange a practice session." Violetta: "I'd love that!" Zayn stood beside me, unusually quiet. I turned toward him. Yaya: "Zayn, there's something I want you to understand." Zayn: "What?"

Yaya: "Violetta being the girl from my memory doesn't change anything about your friendship with her. If you like her, get to know her naturally. Don't feel like you have to compete with me." Zayn looked surprised. Zayn: "I wasn't thinking of it like that." Yaya: "Good. Because you're my bro, and I'm not about to let a mysterious notebook turn our friendship into some ridiculous rivalry." Amir: "Although that would make a pretty dramatic anime episode." Avinia: "Amir." Amir: "I'm quiet." Violetta looked between us. Violetta: "Wait. Why is everyone acting like my name is part of some huge mystery?" We all froze. Amir opened his mouth. I immediately stepped in.

Yaya: "Because… I remembered something important, and we were trying to work it out." Violetta: "Oh?" Yaya: "You don't have to explain anything you're not comfortable discussing. I just wanted to make sure I kept my promise." Violetta smiled. Violetta: "Then I'll see you at practice, Yaya." Yaya: "Deal." She returned to her book, looking pleased. Zayn watched her for a moment, then turned toward us. Zayn: "I still don't understand how the notebook knew." Yaya: "Neither do I." And that was the truth. Finding Violetta had solved one mystery. But it had opened an even bigger one. Scene 9: The Fourth Heart

Afterward, we gathered at the football field. Zayn placed the notebook on the bench. Zayn: "Let's see what it says now." The pages fluttered. Then the notebook opened by itself. THE FIRST MEMORY HAS RETURNED. A second line appeared. THE FOURTH HEART HAS BEEN FOUND. We all stared at it. Amir: "Okay. What does that even mean?" Avinia: "Maybe it refers to Violetta." Lara: "Maybe. But we shouldn't assume the whole mystery is solved." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "Agreed." Then another sentence appeared.

BUT THE NEXT MEMORY BELONGS TO ZAYN. Zayn's expression changed. Zayn: "Me?" The notebook glowed purple and silver. An infinity symbol appeared, with four tiny dots beneath it. Then came one final message. WHEN YOU REMEMBER WHO YOU WERE, YOU WILL UNDERSTAND WHY YOU DREAMED OF YAYA. Silence. I looked at Zayn. Yaya: "Hold on." Amir: "Here we go." Yaya: "We found Violetta, who remembered my promise. But now the notebook says Zayn has a memory connected to me?" Lara: "That's what it says." Yaya: "AND HE DREAMED ABOUT ME BEFORE WE EVEN MET?!"

Amir: "Correct." Yaya: "WHY IS MY LIFE TURNING INTO A SUPERNATURAL FOOTBALL ANIME?!" Amir: "Because you have main-character syndrome." Yaya: "I AM THE MAIN CHARACTER!" Avinia: "At least he's self-aware." Zayn closed the notebook carefully. Zayn: "Whatever happened in the past, we'll figure it out together." I looked around at my friends. Lara smiled at me. Avinia stood beside Amir. And Zayn—the newest member of the Survivors' Alliance —was holding the notebook that had somehow connected all of us. I grinned. Yaya: "All right, Survivors' Alliance. New mission." Amir: "Please don't say we're saving the universe."

Yaya: "We're finding out what happened to Zayn's memories." Amir: "Somehow, that sounds worse." I looked at the notebook one last time. For a split second, I noticed a phrase written beneath its cover. INFINITE INSTINCT PROJECT — SUBJECT ZERO. I blinked. It was gone. Yaya: "…Guys?" Lara: "What is it?" I looked down at the notebook. Nothing. Maybe I'd imagined it. Or maybe the notebook had just revealed another piece of a story none of us understood yet. I smiled nervously. Yaya: "Never mind. We've got work to do."

And just like that, our next mission began. End Of Chapter 12 — The Chase For The Memory

Chapter 13

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 13: The First Clue

One Forgotten Past. Two Connected Dreams. A Secret Buried Inside the Infinite Instinct Project. Scene 1: The Morning After the Reveal

I woke up and stared at my ceiling. For once, I wasn't thinking about football. I wasn't thinking about school. I wasn't even thinking about how Amir somehow managed to turn every serious investigation into a comedy show. I was thinking about three words. SUBJECT ZERO. That mysterious phrase I'd seen beneath Zayn's notebook. Yaya: "Okay. Let's review my life." I sat up in bed.

Yaya: "I go to an all-girls school. I have a supernatural notebook investigating my memories. My best bro's friend has dreams about me before meeting me. And now there's something called the Infinite Instinct Project." I paused. Yaya: "Normal Thursday." My phone buzzed. Amir: "BRO WAKE UP." Yaya: "I AM AWAKE." Amir: "GOOD. EMERGENCY." Yaya: "WHAT HAPPENED?!" Amir: "I FORGOT MY HOMEWORK." I stared at the message. Yaya: "I'M BLOCKING YOU." Another message appeared. Zayn: "It's about the notebook. We need to meet before class." My expression changed immediately.

Yaya: "Where?" Zayn: "The football field." I jumped out of bed. The mystery wasn't going to solve itself. And something told me we were about to discover a part of my past I didn't even know existed. Scene 2: The Notebook's First Clue

At school, Zayn was already waiting beside the football field. Amir stood next to him, eating a sandwich like we were meeting for a casual picnic instead of investigating supernatural evidence. Yaya: "Zayn. What happened?" Zayn held up the notebook. Zayn: "It started writing before I opened it." Amir: "I told him not to touch it." Yaya: "You touched it, didn't you?" Amir: "That is irrelevant to the investigation."

Yaya: "AMIR." Amir: "Yes." Zayn opened the notebook. A fresh message covered the page. THE FIRST CLUE IS WHERE THE PROMISE BEGAN. I nodded. Yaya: "The showcase." Zayn: "Exactly. We need to find the original records." Amir: "So we're looking for photographs, videos, participant lists, and possibly evidence that Yaya's football skills were once documented by the government." Yaya: "WHY WOULD THE GOVERNMENT DOCUMENT MY FOOTBALL SKILLS?!" Amir: "National security." I took the notebook and examined the message. Beneath the sentence, a small symbol had appeared: an infinity sign with four dots beneath

it. The same symbol we'd seen before. Yaya: "This symbol keeps appearing whenever the notebook talks about the memories." Zayn: "I think it's connected to the Infinite Instinct Project." Yaya: "Then we find out what that project is." I looked toward the school building. Yaya: "First, we talk to the teacher who organized the showcase." Amir: "Finally. A plan that doesn't involve guessing." Yaya: "Don't get comfortable. I'm still guessing that you're going to steal my sandwich." Amir immediately hid his sandwich behind his back. Yaya: "CASE SOLVED." Scene 3: The Showcase Records

We found the teacher who had organized my original football showcase.

She was sorting papers in the staff area when we approached. Yaya: "Excuse me, miss? Could we ask you something about the Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase?" Teacher: "Of course, Yahya. What would you like to know?" Yaya: "Do you still have any photographs, recordings, or participant lists from the event?" The teacher thought for a moment. Teacher: "I believe some photographs were saved in the school's event archive. Why are you looking for them?" I exchanged a glance with Zayn. Yaya: "I made a promise to someone after the

showcase, but I've only recently remembered the conversation. I'm trying to find the person so I can keep that promise." The teacher smiled. Teacher: "That's thoughtful of you. I'll see what I can find."

She searched through a folder on her computer. Then she opened an old collection of event photographs. There I was. Standing on the football field. Holding the ball. Surrounded by students. Amir: "BRO, LOOK AT THAT POSE." Yaya: "That's called confidence." Amir: "That's called trying to look mysterious while holding a football." Zayn: "Focus." We scrolled through the photographs. One showed me demonstrating the move. Another showed the audience. Then we found a photograph taken shortly after the showcase ended. I was standing near the sideline, talking to

someone whose face was partially obscured by another student. I leaned closer to the screen. Yaya: "Wait." Zayn: "What is it?" Yaya: "I think that's the moment she approached me." The photograph wasn't clear enough to confirm much. But it was a start. The teacher saved a copy of the photograph for us. Teacher: "I hope this helps you find the person you're looking for." Yaya: "Thank you, miss." As we left, Zayn looked thoughtful. Zayn: "The first clue led us to the photograph." Yaya: "Which means the notebook wasn't just giving us random messages."

Amir: "Unless it secretly has access to the school archive." We both turned toward him. Amir: "WHAT? I'm considering all possibilities!" Scene 4: Violetta's Memory

During lunch, we found Violetta sitting near the courtyard windows. Zayn hesitated before approaching her. I noticed. Yaya: "You okay, Mainframe?" Zayn: "Yeah. I just don't want to overwhelm her with all this." Yaya: "Then don't. Talk to her normally." Amir: "You know, like a human being." Zayn: "I KNOW HOW TO BE A HUMAN BEING." Amir: "Yesterday, you handed her a ruler instead of her notes." Zayn: "THAT WAS ONE TIME."

I laughed. Zayn took a breath and approached Violetta. Zayn: "Hey, Violetta. Can I ask you something?" Violetta: "Sure!" Zayn: "Do you remember anything else about the showcase? Anything unusual that happened after Yaya's demonstration?" Violetta thought for a moment. Violetta: "I remember asking Yaya to teach me the move. But there was something else." I stepped closer. Yaya: "What was it?" Violetta: "I remember seeing a symbol on a page somewhere. It looked like an infinity sign, with little dots underneath it." My eyes widened. Yaya: "FOUR DOTS?" Violetta nodded slowly. Violetta: "I think so. I don't remember where I

saw it, though." Zayn pulled out the notebook and showed her the symbol. Violetta stared at it. Violetta: "That looks familiar." Zayn: "Do you remember anything else?" She shook her head. Violetta: "Not yet. I'm sorry." Yaya: "Don't apologize. Even remembering that much helps." Zayn smiled at her. Zayn: "Thanks, Violetta." Violetta: "Anytime." As she returned to her book, Amir leaned toward me. Amir: "BRO. THE SYMBOL WAS AT THE SHOWCASE." Yaya: "We don't know that for certain." Amir: "BUT IT'S A CLUE!"

Yaya: "A POSSIBLE CLUE." Amir: "LET ME HAVE THIS." I looked at the photograph on my phone. Then at the symbol. Something connected these things. We just hadn't found the missing piece yet. Scene 5: Zayn's Dream

That evening, Zayn called me. His voice sounded different. Quieter. Yaya: "What's up?" Zayn: "I remembered something." I sat up straight. Yaya: "Something about the notebook?" Zayn: "About the dreams." I waited.

Zayn: "Last night, I dreamed about a stadium. It was purple and silver, like the one you described." Yaya: "The stadium from my dream?" Zayn: "Yes. But this time, I wasn't watching from the sidelines. I was standing in the middle of the field." I listened carefully. Zayn: "There were three silhouettes around me. I couldn't see their faces. One of them held a football." My heart began pounding. Yaya: "What happened next?" Zayn: "A voice said, 'You were there from the beginning.'" I went silent. Yaya: "From the beginning of what?" Zayn: "I don't know." He paused.

Zayn: "Then I heard your voice." Yaya: "Mine?" Zayn: "You said, 'We promised we'd remember.'" I looked toward the notebook on my desk. Yaya: "Zayn…" Zayn: "I know. It sounds impossible." Yaya: "Bro, at this point, impossible is just another word for Tuesday." He laughed quietly. Then his voice became serious again. Zayn: "I think I knew you before we met at school." I stared into the darkness outside my window. Yaya: "Then we need to find out how." Scene 6: The Notebook Opens a Door

The next morning, the Survivors' Alliance gathered around the notebook. Lara and Avinia joined us, and I showed them the

photograph from the showcase. Lara: "So we have a photograph, a symbol, and Zayn's dream." Avinia: "And Violetta remembers seeing the symbol somewhere." Amir: "We're getting somewhere!" Yaya: "For once, I agree with you." Zayn opened the notebook. A new message appeared. THE FIRST CLUE HAS BEEN FOUND. Below it: THE SECOND MEMORY IS LOCKED. Then another sentence appeared. SUBJECT ZERO MUST REMEMBER. I felt a chill run down my back. Yaya: "Subject Zero…" Zayn stared at the words.

Zayn: "Do you think that means you?" Amir: "The notebook appeared to say 'Infinite Instinct Project — Subject Zero' yesterday." Lara: "But we don't know what the project actually is." I looked at the photograph again. The partially obscured figure. The football showcase. The symbol. The strange dreams. Yaya: "Maybe Subject Zero is connected to the original demonstration. Maybe the showcase was more important than I realized." Avinia: "Then we need to investigate the project itself." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "I'll check whether the notebook has anything else written inside the cover." He carefully examined the binding.

A tiny folded piece of paper slipped out. Everyone froze. Amir: "THE NOTEBOOK HAS A SECRET POCKET?!" Yaya: "WHY DOES IT HAVE MORE LORE THAN MY ENTIRE LIFE?!" Zayn unfolded the paper. There was a single line written on it. IF YOU WANT THE SECOND MEMORY, FIND THE PLACE WHERE THE FIRST DREAM BEGAN. We stared at it. Lara: "The place where the first dream began…" Yaya: "My dream?" Zayn: "Or mine." The notebook closed by itself. And for the first time, I began to wonder whether our dreams weren't predicting the future. Maybe they were showing us something that had already happened.

Something we'd forgotten. Something we had promised to remember. Scene 7: The Dream Returns

That night, I dreamed of the purple-and-silver stadium again. The field stretched endlessly beneath a dark sky. A football floated in the air. Three silhouettes stood at the centre. This time, I could see a little more. One silhouette looked like me. One looked like Zayn. The third remained hidden behind a bright light. I walked toward them. Yaya: "Who are you?" No answer. I stepped closer. Yaya: "What happened here?"

The football began spinning. The infinity symbol appeared beneath it, glowing with four tiny dots. Then a voice echoed through the stadium. Mysterious Voice: "You found the first clue." I turned toward the stands. Yaya: "WHO'S THERE?!" Mysterious Voice: "But the first memory is only the beginning." The stadium lights flickered. The third silhouette raised its head. For one split second, I thought I recognized the face. Then the entire stadium turned white. I woke up. My heart was racing. My room was silent.

The notebook lay on my desk. I got out of bed and opened it. A single message waited on the page. THE SECOND MEMORY BELONGS TO THE ONE WHO STANDS BESIDE YOU. I stared at the words. Then I picked up my phone and messaged Zayn. Yaya: "Bro. Did you dream about the stadium again?" His reply arrived almost immediately. Zayn: "Yes." Another message appeared. Zayn: "And I think I remembered something." I sat down. Yaya: "WHAT?" The typing indicator appeared. Disappeared.

Appeared again. Then Zayn finally sent his message. Zayn: "I think the third silhouette was holding a notebook." I looked at the notebook in my hands. A cold shiver ran through me. Because that meant the

mystery wasn't just about our memories. It was about something—or someone—that had been connected to us from the very beginning. And we were finally getting close. Scene 8: The Survivors' Alliance Makes a

Decision The following morning, I met Amir, Zayn, Lara, and Avinia at our usual spot. I explained the latest dream and showed them the notebook's message. Amir: "So the second memory belongs to the person standing beside you." Yaya: "That's what it says."

Lara: "Could it mean Zayn?" Avinia: "Or someone else from the original showcase." Zayn looked down at the notebook. Zayn: "I keep dreaming about the stadium. But I can't remember ever visiting a place like that." Yaya: "Maybe it isn't a real stadium." Amir: "Or maybe it's a place you visited when you were younger." Zayn: "I don't know." I put my hand on his shoulder. Yaya: "Listen, bro. We don't have to solve everything in one day. We have the photograph, the symbol, and the clue about the first dream. That's enough to keep moving." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "You're right." Lara: "We'll investigate the original showcase records first. Then we can look for anything connected to the symbol."

Avinia: "And if Violetta remembers anything else, we'll listen. But we won't pressure her." Amir: "And we eat lunch before another notebook emergency happens." Everyone stared at him. Amir: "WHAT? INVESTIGATORS NEED FOOD." I laughed. Yaya: "Fine. Food first. Mystery second." The notebook suddenly opened on the bench. All five of us turned toward it. A final sentence appeared. THE FIRST CLUE HAS BEEN FOUND. Beneath it, a new message slowly formed. THE THIRD MEMORY WILL REVEAL THE THIRD NAME. My smile faded. Yaya: "The third name?" Zayn stared at the page.

Zayn: "How many memories are there?" The notebook offered no answer. Only the infinity symbol remained. And beneath it, four tiny dots. I closed the notebook carefully. Yaya: "Whatever this is, we're seeing it through together." Amir: "Survivors' Alliance?" Yaya: "Survivors' Alliance." Lara: "Together." Avinia: "Together." Zayn looked at us and smiled. Zayn: "Together." For the first time since this whole mystery began, I felt like we were ready for whatever came next. Even if it involved haunted notebooks.

Forgotten memories. And a project that apparently knew more about my life than I did. Yaya: "All right, team. Let's find out who Subject Zero really is." The bell rang. We headed toward class. And somewhere inside the notebook, beneath pages none of us had opened yet, another message waited to be discovered. End Of Chapter 13 — The First Clue

Chapter 14

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 14: The Third Silhouette

Three Figures. Three Memories. One Promise Nobody Can Remember. Scene 1: The Face I Almost Recognized

I woke up with one image stuck inside my head. Three silhouettes. A purple-and-silver stadium. A floating football. And the third person—the one whose face I'd almost seen. I sat up and rubbed my eyes. Yaya: "Come on, brain. Just give me ONE pixel of information." Nothing. Yaya: "Not even a blurry screenshot? Seriously?" I grabbed my phone and opened the Survivors' Alliance group chat.

Yaya: "EMERGENCY MEETING. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE IS HAUNTING MY BRAIN." Amir: "Good morning to you too, mentally stable person." Yaya: "I'M GOING TO DELETE YOUR CONTACT." Amir: "You can't. I'm the co-founder." Lara: "What did you remember, Yaya?" Yaya: "The face. I almost recognized it in the dream, but I woke up before I could see it." Zayn: "Same thing happened to me." I stopped typing. Yaya: "WAIT. YOU SAW THE THIRD SILHOUETTE TOO?" Zayn: "Yes. But I couldn't see their face either." Avinia: "Then the dreams are definitely connected somehow." Amir: "Or you two share one extremely dramatic imagination." Yaya: "AMIR."

Amir: "Fine. I'll be serious." Three seconds passed. Amir: "For approximately five seconds." I got dressed, grabbed my schoolbag, and headed out. Today, we weren't just investigating a mysterious notebook. We were investigating someone who seemed to exist in both our memories. And I had a feeling that person knew something about us that we didn't know ourselves. Scene 2: The Notebook Gives Us a Warning

At school, Zayn was waiting beside the football field with the notebook open. Lara and Avinia arrived a few minutes later. Amir showed up carrying a bag of snacks. Yaya: "Bro, why do you bring food to every supernatural investigation?" Amir: "Because if the notebook reveals the end of

the universe, I refuse to experience it hungry." Avinia: "Honestly, fair." Zayn pointed at the page. A new message had appeared overnight. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE IS NOT A STRANGER. Everyone went quiet. I read it again. Yaya: "Not a stranger…" Lara: "Someone you already know?" Zayn: "Or someone we knew before we forgot." Amir: "That's somehow even more confusing." Another line appeared. YOU HAVE ALREADY SPOKEN TO THEM. My stomach dropped. Yaya: "We've already spoken to them?" I looked around the courtyard.

Students walked past us, laughing and talking. Could the third silhouette be someone from school? Someone from the showcase? Someone we'd seen so many times that we'd never thought to question it? Avinia: "We shouldn't start guessing names." Lara: "Agreed. We need evidence." I nodded. Yaya: "First, we investigate the showcase. Then we compare what we find with our memories." Amir raised his hand. Yaya: "Yes?" Amir: "Can we investigate after lunch?" Yaya: "BRO." Amir: "I NEED FUEL FOR MY BRAIN." Zayn turned the page. A tiny infinity symbol appeared beside the

message. Four dots glowed underneath it. Then, slowly, a final sentence formed. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE REMEMBERS ALL THREE OF YOU. We froze. Yaya: "All three of us?" Zayn looked at me. Then at Amir. Amir: "Hold on. Why am I involved now?" Nobody answered. For the first time, Amir looked genuinely nervous. And honestly? So was I. Scene 3: Returning to the Showcase

We returned to the football field after class. I stood in the same spot where I'd performed

Infinite Instinct Phantom. The sunlight stretched across the grass. The goal stood at the far end. Everything looked ordinary. Too ordinary. Yaya: "This is where it started." Zayn: "Or where we first noticed it." I took a football from the equipment rack and placed it at my feet. Amir: "Are you about to recreate the entire showcase?" Yaya: "Maybe." Amir: "I knew bringing snacks was a good idea." Lara crossed her arms. Lara: "Yaya, don't overdo it. We're trying to remember something, not win a tournament." Yaya: "Relax. One demonstration." I took a few steps backward.

The ball rolled forward. I moved into position, controlling it with a series of quick touches before sending it toward the goal. The shot curved through the air and hit the net. Amir: "OOOOOOOOH!" Avinia: "Nice shot!" Lara: "Still showing off, I see." Yaya: "It's called maintaining the brand." Everyone laughed. But then something strange happened. As the ball rolled back toward me, I remembered a voice. Not Violetta's. Not Lara's. A different voice. Unknown Voice: "You're going to need all three of us."

I stopped moving. Zayn: "Yaya?" I stared at the ball. Yaya: "I heard something." Amir: "What?" Yaya: "A voice. I think it came from the day of the showcase." Lara: "What did it say?" I tried to recall the words. Yaya: "Something about needing all three of us." Zayn's face changed. Zayn: "I heard that phrase in my dream." Silence fell over the field. Zayn: "The voice said, 'You'll need all three of you when the memory returns.'" I looked at him. Yaya: "Then maybe the third silhouette isn't just

connected to us. Maybe they were part of something we did together." Avinia: "But who?" I had no answer. The ball rested at my feet. And suddenly, the football field felt less like a place where I'd played a game… …and more like a place where something important had been forgotten. Scene 4: The Photograph Reveals Something

New That evening, I opened the photograph from the original showcase. I'd looked at it so many times that I could practically memorize every blade of grass. But this time, I zoomed in on the background. The crowd. The sideline. The people standing behind me.

And then I noticed something. A small notebook. Someone in the background was holding it. I leaned closer to the screen. Yaya: "NO WAY." I opened the group chat and sent the image. Yaya: "GUYS. LOOK AT THE BACKGROUND." Amir: "Is that a notebook?" Avinia: "It looks like one." Lara: "Can you make the image clearer?" I enlarged the photograph as much as I could. The person holding the notebook was partly hidden behind two students. Their face was impossible to identify. But on the cover of the notebook was a faint symbol. An infinity sign.

Four dots beneath it. My heart started racing. Yaya: "THE SAME SYMBOL." Zayn: "Then the notebook was there during the showcase." Amir: "Unless someone drew the symbol on a random notebook." Yaya: "Possible. But why would it match the symbol in our notebook?" Amir: "I admit that is suspicious." Zayn sent another message. Zayn: "Look at the person's hand." I zoomed in again. There was something on the person's wrist. A thin band with a small silver emblem. I couldn't make out the exact design. But I recognized the colour. Purple and silver.

The same colours as the stadium in our dreams. Yaya: "Guys… I think we've found the first physical connection between the photograph and the dreams." Lara: "That's a real clue." Avinia: "But we still don't know who the person is." Zayn: "Not yet." I saved the photograph. For the first time, we had something beyond mysterious messages and dreams. We had evidence that someone carrying the symbol had been present at the original showcase. And that someone might be our third silhouette. Scene 5: Zayn's Memory Glitches

The following day, Zayn was unusually quiet. Even Amir noticed. Amir: "Mainframe, you good?"

Zayn: "I keep remembering small things." Yaya: "Like what?" Zayn sat down on the bench and opened his notebook. Zayn: "A silver wristband. A football. Someone laughing. And a voice telling me to write something

down." Avinia: "What were you supposed to write?" Zayn shook his head. Zayn: "I can't remember." He looked at the notebook in his hands. Zayn: "But I think this notebook existed before I found it." I frowned. Yaya: "What do you mean?" Zayn: "The handwriting inside it doesn't always look like mine. Some pages are written in a style I recognize, but I can't explain why." He opened a page near the back.

There were several faint lines of writing. Most were unreadable. But one phrase stood out. THREE SURVIVORS. ONE PROMISE. Amir stopped eating. That alone was enough to make the situation serious. Amir: "Wait. Three survivors?" Yaya: "That's us." Zayn: "Maybe." Lara: "Or maybe the phrase was written before we formed the alliance." I stared at the words. Three survivors. One promise. I thought of myself, Amir, and Zayn. But the notebook had already mentioned a fourth heart.

Violetta had been part of the first recovered memory. And the third silhouette remembered all three of us. Yaya: "Maybe we weren't the first people to call ourselves the Survivors' Alliance." Nobody spoke. Because for the first time, I had a theory that made the mystery feel even bigger. What if we hadn't created the alliance? What if we'd recreated something we'd once been part of? Scene 6: The Dream of Three Names

That night, I returned to the purple-and-silver stadium in my dreams. But this time, the stadium wasn't empty. Three figures stood in the centre of the field. The first was me. The second was Zayn.

The third stood between us, holding a notebook. The football floated above the grass. Yaya: "Who are you?" The third silhouette didn't answer. Instead, they opened the notebook. Three names appeared on the page. YAHYA. ZAYN. The third name was hidden beneath a bright silver light. I stepped forward. Yaya: "SHOW ME THE THIRD NAME!" The stadium shook. A voice echoed through the stands. Mysterious Voice: "You already know." Yaya: "THEN WHY CAN'T I REMEMBER?!"

The silhouette raised its head. For one second, I could see the outline of a face. Then the football dropped to the ground. A flash of purple light swept across the field. And I heard three words. Mysterious Voice: "Remember the promise." I woke up. My room was dark. I checked the time. 3:14 a.m. I sat on the edge of my bed and tried to remember the third name. Nothing. Then I noticed the notebook on my desk. It was open. I hadn't opened it before going to sleep.

A message was written across the page. THE THIRD NAME IS CLOSER THAN THE FIRST TWO. I stared at it. Yaya: "What does that even mean?" The notebook remained silent. And somewhere in the back of my mind, I felt like I was standing at the edge of a memory that was almost within reach. Scene 7: Amir's Unexpected Connection

The next morning, I told the others about the dream. Amir listened carefully. For once, he didn't interrupt with a joke. When I finished, he looked down at the table. Amir: "Yaya…" Yaya: "What?" Amir: "I think I've seen that symbol before." Everyone turned toward him.

Zayn: "Where?" Amir frowned, trying to remember. Amir: "I don't know. Maybe in an old photograph. Maybe somewhere at school. It's familiar, but I can't place it." I stared at him. Yaya: "BRO. WHY DID YOU WAIT UNTIL NOW TO TELL US?!" Amir: "BECAUSE I DIDN'T REMEMBER UNTIL YOU DESCRIBED THE WRISTBAND!" Lara leaned forward. Lara: "Could it be connected to the showcase?" Amir: "Possibly. I remember seeing a silver emblem when we were younger. I can't remember who wore it." Zayn opened the notebook. A new message appeared. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE REMEMBERS AMIR. Amir slowly leaned back.

Amir: "Nope." Yaya: "Amir—" Amir: "NOPE. I'M NOT DOING THIS." Avinia: "You're already involved." Amir: "I WAS HAPPY BEING THE GUY WITH SNACKS!" Yaya: "Congratulations. You're now the guy with snacks AND mysterious memories." Amir covered his face. Amir: "I hate this storyline." But I noticed something else. The notebook hadn't said that the third silhouette remembered only Yaya and Zayn. It

remembered Amir, too. Which meant our friend might be connected to the mystery in a way none of us had expected. Scene 8: The Third Silhouette Speaks

After school, we returned to the football field.

Zayn placed the notebook on the bench. Zayn: "If the third silhouette remembers all three of us, maybe we should ask the notebook what happened." I nodded. Yaya: "Let's try." I wrote on the page: Who is the third silhouette? The notebook stayed blank. We waited. Nothing. Amir: "Maybe it doesn't know." Yaya: "It literally knows things we don't remember." Amir: "Maybe it's being dramatic." Suddenly, the pages began turning. One after another. Until the notebook stopped at a page filled with

faint writing. The letters slowly darkened. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE IS NOT READY TO BE NAMED. I sighed. Yaya: "OF COURSE." A second sentence appeared. FIRST, YOU MUST REMEMBER WHY YOU BECAME THREE. Zayn stared at the page. Zayn: "Why we became three…" Lara: "The Survivors' Alliance?" Avinia: "Or something that happened before it." I looked at Amir. He looked back at me. For once, neither of us had a joke. We had become friends because we trusted each other. We had formed the Survivors' Alliance because we

wanted to face things together. But the notebook seemed to suggest that there had been another beginning. An earlier promise. An earlier connection. Something that had happened before any of us remembered. I closed the notebook. Yaya: "Then that's our next mission." Zayn: "Find out why we became three." Amir: "And hopefully find out without another mysterious dream." The notebook opened by itself. One final sentence appeared. THE NEXT MEMORY WILL BEGIN WITH AMIR. Amir froze. His sandwich slipped from his hand. It landed on the bench.

Nobody looked at the sandwich. Because for the first time in this entire mystery, the notebook had singled out Amir by name. Amir: "…Guys?" I looked at him. Yaya: "Yeah, bro?" He swallowed. Amir: "I think I just remembered something." The bell rang in the distance. Amir looked toward the school building. Then back at us. Amir: "I think I've seen the third silhouette before." My eyes widened. Yaya: "WHEN?!" Amir shook his head.

Amir: "I don't know. But I remember one thing." He looked directly at me. Amir: "They called us by a different name." The notebook's pages began glowing purple and silver. And beneath the infinity symbol, four tiny dots appeared. One by one. Then the page went completely blank. End Of Chapter 14 — The Third Silhouette

Chapter 15

A Boy in a Girl Parade Army Chapter 15: The Name Before the Alliance

Previously…

The notebook revealed that the next memory belonged to Amir. He remembered seeing a silver emblem, hearing a mysterious voice, and being part of a trio that had a different name before the Survivors' Alliance existed. But when Amir finally remembered that name, the notebook delivered a warning: THE NEXT MEMORY WILL BEGIN WITH AMIR. And just like that, our little football squad became a supernatural investigation team. Again. Because apparently, having a normal school life was too much to ask. Scene 1 — My Brain Has Officially Resigned

I woke up staring at my bedroom ceiling. For approximately seven seconds, my life was

peaceful. No mysterious notebook. No glowing symbols. No dreams about purple-and-silver stadiums. No mysterious voices telling me to remember promises from a past I couldn't even access. Just me, my bed, and the beautiful knowledge that I had absolutely nothing supernatural to deal with. Then I remembered Chapter Fourteen. Me: "OH, COME ON!" I sat up so quickly that my pillow fell off the bed. Me: "WHY CAN'T I JUST PLAY FOOTBALL?!" I grabbed my phone and opened the Survivors' Alliance group chat. SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE Me: `Good morning to everyone except that notebook.`

Amir: `Good morning to everyone except my brain.` Zayn: `I had another dream.` I stared at the screen. Me: `BRO IT IS 6:42 AM.` Zayn: `I know.` Me: `LET THE SUN LOAD FIRST.` Amir: `What did you dream about?` Zayn took a moment to respond. Zayn: `The stadium. The three silhouettes. And Amir.` I sat completely still. Me: `EXCUSE ME????` Zayn: `I heard a voice say, "The name must return before the memory can open."` Amir: `I DON'T EVEN KNOW WHAT NAME I'M SUPPOSED TO REMEMBER.` Me: `BRO YOUR BRAIN IS LITERALLY HOLDING THE ENTIRE SERVER HOSTAGE.`

Amir: `I WILL THROW YOUR SERVER INTO THE SUN.` I laughed so hard that my mother called from outside my room to ask what was going on. Me: "NOTHING!" Mum: "Then why are you shouting?" Me: "EDUCATIONAL CONTENT!" Silence. Me (narrating): I was going to fail my next science test. Not because I didn't understand science. Because science had officially abandoned me. I got dressed, packed my schoolbag, and checked my phone one more time. Zayn had sent another message. Zayn: `I think this memory is important.` For once, I didn't make a joke. Me: `We'll figure it out together, bro.` And I meant it. Scene 2 — Welcome to the World's Most Cursed

School By the time I arrived at school, I had developed a plan. Step one: Find Amir. Step two: Make him remember the name. Step three: Ask the notebook what happened. Step four: Return to being a normal student. The plan was beautiful. The plan was logical. The plan lasted approximately eleven seconds. I entered the classroom and found Amir sitting at his desk, staring at absolutely nothing. Zayn sat beside him with the notebook closed in front of him. Lara was standing near my desk, and Avinia was looking through some notes. Me: "Gentlemen." Amir slowly looked up.

Amir: "No." Me: "I haven't even said anything!" Amir: "You entered with the expression of someone about to make my day significantly worse." Me: "That's called leadership." Lara walked over and smiled. Lara: "Good morning, Yaya." Me: "Good morning, Lara." Lara: "Did you sleep well?" I glanced at Zayn's notebook. Me: "Define well." Lara: "You had another dream, didn't you?" Me: "How do you always know?" She raised an eyebrow. Lara: "Because whenever you have a mysterious dream, you arrive at school looking like you've been fighting the final boss." Amir: "He's been fighting the final boss since

Chapter Ten." Me: "AND I'M STILL UNDEFEATED!" Zayn: "You lost a football match to Lara last week." Me: "THAT WAS A FRIENDLY MATCH." Lara: "You demanded a rematch three times." Me: "THE FRIENDLY MATCH WAS HOSTILE." Avinia laughed. For a moment, everything felt normal again. Then Zayn placed his notebook on the desk. Zayn: "We need to investigate the memory today." The room became quiet. Amir: "I know." He rubbed his forehead. Amir: "I keep remembering little pieces. A silver circle. Three footballs. A voice. Someone telling us we had to find each other again." Me: "Do you remember where it happened?"

Amir: "No. But I remember the ground beneath my feet." Zayn: "What did it feel like?" Amir closed his eyes briefly. Amir: "Artificial grass." I pointed at him. Me: "THE FOOTBALL FIELD!" Amir: "Yaya, half the school has artificial grass." Me: "LET ME HAVE MY DETECTIVE MOMENT!" Zayn opened the notebook. The pages were completely blank. Then, slowly, black letters appeared. RETURN TO THE PLACE WHERE THE THREE BECAME ONE. I stared at it. Me: "Okay. That's definitely the football field." Amir: "Or somewhere else."

Me: "Why do you always have to be reasonable when I'm being dramatic?" Amir: "It's my gift." Scene 3 — The Girls Join the Investigation

We met Lara, Avinia, and Violetta near the courtyard during break. Lara had brought a notebook of her own. A normal notebook. A notebook that didn't predict the future or expose forgotten memories. Honestly, I wanted to hug it. Me: "Lara, I love your notebook." She looked at me. Lara: "You haven't even opened it." Me: "IT HASN'T THREATENED ME YET." Avinia leaned against the nearby wall. Avinia: "So, what's the plan?"

Zayn explained the messages and Amir's memories. Violetta listened carefully, her purple hair falling over one shoulder. When Zayn mentioned the silver circle, she suddenly looked thoughtful. Violetta: "Wait." We all turned toward her. Violetta: "The symbol with the infinity sign and four dots… I've seen something similar before." Zayn immediately straightened. Zayn: "Where?" Violetta: "I don't know. That's the problem. I remember the shape, but not the place." Me: "WELCOME TO THE CLUB. OUR ENTIRE PERSONALITY IS FORGETTING THINGS." Amir: "Speak for yourself." Me: "BRO, YOU FORGOT AN ENTIRE FRIENDSHIP." Amir: "TEMPORARILY."

Me: "THAT'S WHAT PEOPLE SAY ABOUT THEIR HOMEWORK." Violetta smiled. Violetta: "Maybe we should look at old school photographs." Zayn blinked. Zayn: "Photographs?" Violetta: "If the symbol appeared somewhere at school, we might find it in the background of an old picture." I snapped my fingers. Me: "THAT'S ACTUALLY SMART." Lara: "She's been smart the entire time, Yaya." Me: "I'M ACKNOWLEDGING THE SMARTNESS!" Zayn wrote the idea down in his own notebook. Zayn: "Old photographs. Previous school events. Football showcases." Amir stared at the list. Amir: "What if we find nothing?"

I put a hand on his shoulder. Me: "Then we search somewhere else." Amir: "And if we still find nothing?" Me: "Then we search again." Amir: "And if the notebook eats us?" I paused. Me: "THEN I'M BLAMING YOU FOR TOUCHING IT FIRST." Lara shook her head. Lara: "You two are impossible." But she was smiling. And that was enough. Scene 4 — The Place Where We Became Three

At lunch, we headed to the football field. The afternoon sun illuminated the artificial grass, and the sound of students talking echoed across the school grounds. I stood near the centre circle.

For a second, I imagined the stadium from my dreams. Purple lights. Silver markings. Three silhouettes standing together. A football floating above the ground. I shook my head. Me (narrating): I knew what I remembered. I just didn't know why I remembered it. Zayn placed his notebook on a bench. Amir stood beside

me. Lara, Avinia, and Violetta watched from a few steps away. Zayn: "Amir, try to remember the field." Amir closed his eyes. I picked up a football and gently rolled it across the grass. The ball moved toward Amir.

He stopped it with his foot. And suddenly— Amir: "I remember the silver circle." We froze. Me: "What?" Amir: "It was painted on the ground. We stood inside it." Zayn: "All three of us?" Amir nodded slowly. Amir: "Three footballs. Three wristbands. Three people standing together." He looked at me. Amir: "You were holding a football." My stomach tightened. Me: "What was I doing?" Amir: "You were laughing." I blinked.

Me: "Me?" Amir: "Yeah. You said something about how the three of us were going to become legends." I grinned despite myself. Me: "THAT SOUNDS LIKE ME." Amir: "You also said that if we ever got famous, I wasn't allowed to call myself the richest footballer alive." Me: "THAT ALSO SOUNDS LIKE ME." Avinia folded her arms. Avinia: "At least your personality survived the memory loss." Me: "MY PERSONALITY IS IMMORTAL." Zayn wasn't laughing. He was staring at the notebook. Zayn: "There's something written here." He turned it toward us. THE FIRST OATH.

Below it, new words appeared. WE WILL FIND EACH OTHER AGAIN. Amir inhaled sharply. Amir: "That's it." Me: "That's the sentence you remembered?" Amir: "Yes." He looked at us, and his expression softened. Amir: "We promised we'd find each other again, even if we forgot everything." For a moment, none of us spoke. Then the notebook flashed. A new message appeared. THE NAME HAS RETURNED. THE INFINITY THREE. Three small dots glowed beneath the infinity symbol. I stared at the page.

Me: "So that was our original name." Zayn: "It seems so." Me: "And the Survivors' Alliance is the new name?" Amir nodded. Amir: "Maybe we rebuilt something we once had without realizing it." I looked at both of them. My best friend. The boy who had once been a stranger. The two people who somehow felt familiar even when my memories couldn't explain why. Me: "Then I guess we kept our promise." Zayn gave a small smile. Zayn: "We found each other again." Amir held out his fist. I bumped it.

Zayn joined us. Three fists. One alliance. For about five seconds, it was genuinely wholesome. Then I ruined it. Me: "SO DOES THIS MEAN WE GET MATCHING JACKETS?" Amir: "I KNEW YOU'D RUIN IT." Me: "MATCHING JACKETS ARE IMPORTANT FOR TEAM MORALE!" Lara: "You haven't even designed them." Me: "I HAVE A VISION." Avinia: "Your vision is probably purple flames and a football." Me: "…AND A FOOTBALL." Everyone laughed. But the notebook remained open. And the next message wasn't funny.

THE FIRST OATH HAS BEEN REMEMBERED. THE SECOND OATH REMAINS BROKEN. Scene 5 — The Photograph

Later that afternoon, we visited the school staff member who had helped organise my Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase. We explained that we were looking for old photographs from the event. I deliberately left out the part about a notebook predicting memories. I wasn't trying to get Zayn's notebook confiscated. Staff member: "I believe we kept some photographs from that day. Give me a moment." She searched through an archive of school event records. Amir tapped his fingers against the desk. Zayn stood beside me, looking unusually nervous. Me: "You good, bro?"

Zayn: "I don't know." Me: "That's fair. None of us know anything anymore." He gave a short laugh. Then the staff member returned with a folder. Inside were several photographs of the showcase. There I was, standing on the field with a football. There I was again, performing a trick. And there I was, surrounded by students after the demonstration. I turned the pages. Me: "Wait." I stopped at one photograph. The picture showed me near the edge of the field, talking to someone whose face was partly obscured by another student. The person appeared to be holding a small notebook.

A silver emblem was visible on their wrist. Zayn leaned closer. Zayn: "That symbol…" Amir went completely still. Amir: "I've seen that before." I examined the photograph. The emblem wasn't clear enough to identify exactly, but its shape reminded me of the infinity symbol in Zayn's notebook. Me: "Can we get a copy of this photograph?" The staff member agreed to help us obtain one. We thanked her and stepped outside. For once, none of us made a joke. We had evidence. Not a dream. Not a strange feeling. An actual photograph.

Me: "Someone connected to this mystery was at my showcase." Zayn: "And they had the symbol." Amir: "Which means the memory isn't just in our heads." I looked back at the photograph. Whoever that person was, they had been there. Possibly when I made the promise to Violetta. Possibly when the Infinity Three first existed. Possibly before everything we thought we knew. But the photograph couldn't tell us their name. Not yet. Scene 6 — The Second Oath

We returned to the football field just before the end of the school day. The girls joined us again. Zayn placed the notebook on the bench and opened it to the page containing the first oath.

Zayn: "If the first oath was about finding each other again, the second oath must be about something else." Avinia: "Something important enough for the notebook to keep it hidden." Lara: "Can we ask it directly?" I leaned over the page. Me: "Dear creepy notebook, what is the second oath?" Nothing happened. I waited. Me: "Please?" Still nothing. Me: "I'll even stop insulting you for an entire hour." A sentence appeared. NO. I stared at it. Me: "YOU ABSOLUTE—"

Lara covered her mouth to hide a laugh. Lara: "Yaya!" Me: "IT'S PERSONAL NOW." Zayn turned the page. New words appeared. ONE WOULD LEAD. ONE WOULD REMEMBER. ONE WOULD RETURN. Amir read the message twice. Amir: "One would lead. One would remember. One would return." Zayn: "Those aren't random roles. They sound like parts of a promise." I considered the words. Me: "Could 'one would lead' mean me?" Amir: "Possibly." Me: "Because I'm the captain?"

Amir: "You appointed yourself captain." Me: "BECAUSE I'M THE MAIN CHARACTER!" Zayn: "Could 'one would remember' refer to Amir?" Amir frowned. Amir: "I remembered the name, but most of the past is still missing." Avinia: "Maybe remembering is something you haven't finished doing yet." Violetta looked at the final line. Violetta: "'One would return.' Return from where?" Nobody answered. The notebook's pages fluttered. A new sentence appeared beneath the three roles. THE ONE WHO RETURNS WILL UNLOCK THE SECOND OATH. Then, in smaller letters: THE SECOND MEMORY BELONGS TO ZAYN.

Zayn stared at it. Zayn: "Me?" Me: "Apparently, bro. Congratulations. You've won the supernatural mystery lottery." Zayn: "I don't want it." Me: "Can I have it?" Zayn: "No." Me: "RIGGED." But Zayn's expression had changed. He was looking at the words as though he had been waiting for them without knowing it. Zayn: "I think I've been dreaming about something connected to this for a long time." Lara: "What do you mean?" He hesitated. Zayn: "The stadium. The silhouettes. The voice. Sometimes, I hear someone telling me to remember. Other times, I hear someone telling me to come back."

Amir: "Come back where?" Zayn shook his head. Zayn: "I don't know." The notebook flickered one last time. SUBJECT ZERO MUST REMEMBER. A cold silence settled over us. I had seen that title before. In my dreams. In Zayn's notebook. And now, in a message connected to his memories. Me: "Zayn… what is Subject Zero?" He slowly closed the notebook. Zayn: "I was hoping you'd know." Scene 7 — The Boy Who Never Forgot

That night, I sat on my bed with my phone in my hand. The Survivors' Alliance group chat was active

again. Me: `Today's findings: we used to be the Infinity Three.` Amir: `Correct.` Me: `We made a promise to find each other again.` Amir: `Correct.` Me: `There's a mysterious person with a silver emblem in the showcase photograph.` Zayn: `Correct.` Me: `And Subject Zero is somehow connected to Zayn.` Zayn: `Probably.` Me:

`Great. So we've solved approximately 3% of the mystery.` Amir: `That's generous.` Me: `I AM AN OPTIMIST.` I put my phone down and switched off the light. For a while, I stared into the darkness.

Then I closed my eyes. And the stadium returned. Purple lights illuminated the enormous arena. Silver lines stretched across the floor. A football floated in the centre. Three silhouettes stood beneath the lights. The first was me. The second was Amir. The third was Zayn. But something was different this time. The third silhouette wasn't standing beside us. It was standing a little farther away, holding a notebook. A fourth shape appeared behind it. I tried to move closer. I couldn't. A voice echoed through the stadium.

Mysterious voice: "The first oath has been restored." I looked toward the silhouettes. Me: "Who are you?" Mysterious voice: "You already know." Me: "THAT IS NOT A HELPFUL ANSWER!" The voice fell silent. Then I heard Zayn. Zayn's voice: "We promised we'd remember." Another voice answered him. It was unfamiliar, but it sounded sad. Unknown voice: "You promised you'd come back." The silver lines on the floor began glowing. The football dropped gently onto the ground. Then the stadium lights went out. For one second, everything was completely dark.

A final sentence appeared in silver letters. THE SECOND MEMORY WILL BEGIN WHEN ZAYN MEETS THE PERSON WHO NEVER FORGOT. I woke up. My heart was racing. I grabbed my phone and opened the group chat. It was 2:17 AM. I typed a message. Me: `Zayn. Are you awake?` The reply arrived almost immediately. Zayn: `Yes.` I sat up. Me: `Did you dream about the stadium?` Zayn: `Yes.` Me: `Did you hear a voice saying you promised to come back?` Three dots appeared.

Disappeared. Appeared again. Then Zayn sent a message that made my stomach drop. Zayn: `Yaya, I think I know what the voice meant.` I typed as quickly as I could. Me: `WHAT DID IT MEAN?` His response arrived. Zayn: `I think someone has been waiting for me.` I stared at the screen. Then another message appeared. Zayn: `Someone who remembers the Infinity Three.` Before I could respond, a final message arrived. Zayn: `And I think I've seen that person before.` I looked toward the window. The world outside was quiet.

But my mind was racing. We had recovered our original name. We had found a photograph. We had discovered two oaths. And now Zayn believed someone from our forgotten past was waiting for him. I typed one final message. Me: `We'll find them together, bro.` Zayn replied with a single symbol.

I put my phone down and looked at the ceiling. Me (narrating): We had called ourselves the Infinity Three before we forgot who we were. We had promised to find each other again, and somehow, against all odds, we had kept that promise. But the notebook had warned us that one of us would lead, one would remember, and one would return. Amir had remembered the name.

I was beginning to understand what it meant to lead. And Zayn… Zayn was the one who had to return. I closed my eyes. Somewhere in the darkness of my room, I thought I saw a tiny silver infinity symbol. I blinked. It was gone. Then, in the silence, I heard a voice. Not from my dream. Not from my phone. From somewhere I couldn't explain. Unknown voice: "Welcome back, Subject Zero." My eyes snapped open. Me: "WHAT?!" Silence.

I grabbed my pillow. Me: "NAH. ABSOLUTELY NOT. I'M SLEEPING WITH THE LIGHTS ON." And that, ladies and gentlemen, was how I ended another perfectly normal day at school. By being personally attacked by the supernatural universe. Again. End of Chapter 15

Chapter 16: The Stadium That Never Existed

Previously…

Amir remembered our original name: the Infinity Three. We discovered that we had once promised to find each other again, even if we forgot everything. We also found an old photograph from my Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase showing someone wearing a mysterious silver emblem. Then the notebook revealed three strange roles: ONE WOULD LEAD. ONE WOULD REMEMBER. ONE WOULD RETURN. Amir had begun remembering. I was apparently the one who would lead. And Zayn? Zayn had to return. That night, I heard a voice call him Subject Zero. And honestly, my brain was officially requesting a refund.

Scene 1 — The Group Chat Is Going to Kill Me

I woke up the next morning with exactly one thought. Me: "I AM NOT SLEEPING TONIGHT." My alarm hadn't even rung. The sun wasn't fully up. And I was already arguing with the universe. I grabbed my phone and opened the Survivors'

Alliance group chat. SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE Me: EMERGENCY MEETING. Amir: Is someone dying? Me: NO. Amir: Then it's not an emergency. Me: I HEARD A VOICE CALL ZAYN SUBJECT ZERO. Three dots appeared. Zayn: I heard something too. I sat upright. Me: WHAT DID YOU HEAR? Zayn: Someone said, "Welcome back, Subject Zero." Me: BROOOOOOOOO. Amir: Okay. That's actually concerning. Me: ACTUALLY CONCERNING??? BRO, MY BEDROOM HAS BECOME A SUPERNATURAL CUSTOMER SERVICE CENTRE. Zayn: I think we need to investigate the stadium. Me: WHICH STADIUM? THE ONE THAT DOESN'T EXIST? Zayn: Exactly. I stared at the screen. This was my life now. Other students woke up thinking about homework, breakfast, and whether their favourite football team would win. I woke up receiving messages from a boy who was apparently connected to a stadium that didn't exist and a mysterious identity called Subject Zero. Me (narrating): If I ever wrote an autobiography, nobody would believe it. I'd have to classify it as fantasy. I typed one last message.

Me: Meet at school. Bring the notebook. Bring snacks. If we're investigating a nonexistent stadium, we're doing it with food. Amir: Finally, a sensible decision.

Scene 2 — Zayn's Notebook Has No Respect for

Privacy When I arrived at school, Amir was already waiting near our usual meeting spot. He looked exhausted. Me: "Bro, did you sleep?" Amir: "Yes." Me: "How much?" Amir: "Enough." Me: "That means two hours." Amir: "Three." Me: "BRO, YOU'RE RUNNING ON A DEMO VERSION OF SLEEP." Zayn arrived a few moments later, carrying the notebook. He looked even more tired than Amir. Me: "You too?" Zayn: "I kept thinking about the voice." Me: "Fair." Lara approached us with Avinia and Violetta. Lara: "You three look terrible." Me: "Good morning to you too, my love." She smiled. Lara: "Good morning, Yaya." Then she looked at Zayn. Lara: "Did you dream about the stadium again?" Zayn nodded.

Violetta: "What stadium?" Zayn opened the notebook and showed her the messages. She read them carefully. Violetta: "The stadium that never existed?" Amir: "That's what we're calling it." Me: "Our marketing department is working on the name." Avinia: "You don't have a marketing department." Me: "I AM THE MARKETING DEPARTMENT." Lara laughed and took a step closer to me. Lara: "All right, Director of Nonsense. What's the plan?" I pointed toward the notebook. Me: "First, we figure out whether this stadium was ever real. Second, we find out why Zayn is connected to Subject Zero. Third, we discover who's been waiting for him." Amir: "And fourth?" Me: "We go home and sleep for twelve hours." Zayn: "Agreed." The notebook suddenly opened. Every page turned at once. Then the pages stopped. A message appeared in dark silver

letters. THE STADIUM EXISTS. We froze. Another sentence appeared beneath it. BUT NOT WHERE YOU REMEMBER. I stared at the notebook. Me: "WHAT DOES THAT EVEN MEAN?!" The notebook added one final line.

FIND THE FIRST DREAM. Then it went blank. I slowly looked at Zayn. Me: "Bro." Zayn: "Yes?" Me: "Your notebook needs therapy." Zayn: "It's a notebook." Me: "IT HAS MORE PERSONALITY THAN HALF THE SCHOOL."

Scene 3 — Searching for a Stadium That Doesn't

Exist We started with the obvious idea. If the stadium was real, there might be a photograph, a school record, or some evidence that it had once existed. The six of us met during lunch in a quiet corner of the school. I spread out our notes. Amir had written down everything he remembered. Zayn had drawn the stadium from his dreams. Lara had organised the evidence into categories. Avinia was checking dates on the old school-event records we'd been allowed to examine. Violetta was comparing the silver emblem from our photograph with the infinity symbol in the notebook. Basically, everyone was doing useful work. And then there was me. Me: "I've decided our investigation needs a logo." Lara: "Yaya."

Me: "What? Every serious organisation needs branding." Amir: "We're investigating memory loss." Me: "WITH TERRIBLE BRANDING, APPARENTLY." Lara took my hand beneath the table. Lara: "Focus." Me: "Yes, ma'am." She smiled. I returned to the notes. Zayn's drawing showed an enormous circular stadium surrounded by tall silver pillars. Purple lights stretched around the upper stands. At the centre of the field was an infinity symbol with four dots beneath it. There was something strangely familiar about the design. Not because I'd seen it in a dream. Because I'd seen something similar in real life. Me: "Wait." Everyone looked at me. Amir: "What now?" I pointed at the drawing. Me: "The shape of the stadium. Doesn't it look like the arena where the school held that interschool football exhibition last year?" Avinia examined the drawing. Avinia: "The outer structure is similar, but the stadium in the drawing is much bigger." Lara: "And the silver pillars aren't in the exhibition photographs." Zayn: "Maybe the dream changed the appearance." Me: "Or maybe we're looking at two different

places." Zayn considered that. Zayn: "The notebook said the stadium exists, but not where we remember." Violetta tapped the edge of the paper. Violetta: "What if the stadium isn't a real location? What if it's a memory of a place that looked different to us?" Amir: "A memory of somewhere we all visited?" Violetta: "Possibly." I leaned back. Me: "Okay. That's a theory. Not a confirmed fact." Lara: "Look at you, being responsible." Me: "I CAN BE RESPONSIBLE." Amir: "Name three examples." Me: "I once completed my homework." Amir: "When?" Me: "I'M STILL SEARCHING MY MEMORY." Everyone burst out laughing. Even Zayn smiled. For a few seconds, the mystery felt manageable. Then the notebook moved. Not dramatically. Not with glowing lights or a loud noise. It simply slid across the table by itself. The page opened. THE FIRST DREAM DID NOT BEGIN IN THE STADIUM. I stopped laughing. Another line appeared. THE STADIUM BEGAN IN THE FIRST DREAM. Zayn went pale.

Zayn: "That's impossible." Me: "Bro, we crossed impossible off the list in Chapter Ten."

Scene 4 — The First Dream

We needed to reconstruct our earliest memories of the stadium. Zayn remembered seeing it before he met me. I remembered dreaming of it before Zayn arrived at school. Amir remembered the silver circle and the three footballs. But none of us could explain how those memories connected. We decided to start with Zayn. He sat in the middle of the group and closed his eyes. Zayn: "I'll describe everything I remember." The rest of us stayed quiet. Zayn: "I'm standing in a stadium. It's empty. There are purple lights, but the sky is completely dark." He paused. Zayn: "There's a football on the ground. I walk toward it, but someone tells me not to touch it." Me: "Who?" Zayn: "I can't see them." Lara: "What happens next?" Zayn: "I hear footsteps. Then I see three silhouettes at the other end of the field." He opened his eyes. Zayn: "One of them looks like Yaya. One looks

like Amir. The third is holding a notebook." I glanced at the photograph we'd found. The partly obscured person in the background had been holding something similar. Me: "What did the voice say?" Zayn thought for a moment. Zayn: "It said, 'You're early.'" Amir: "Early for what?" Zayn: "I don't know." He closed his eyes again. Zayn: "Then the person holding the notebook says something else." Me: "What?" Zayn's voice became quieter. Zayn: "'You have to remember the rules.'" Nobody spoke. Avinia: "What rules?" Zayn: "I don't know. I never got that far in the dream." The notebook opened on the table. THE RULES WERE NEVER WRITTEN FOR THE WORLD. THEY WERE WRITTEN FOR YOU. I stared at the message. Me: "What rules?!" Nothing happened. Me: "HELLO? CREEPY NOTEBOOK? I WOULD LIKE TO SPEAK TO YOUR MANAGER." The page remained blank. Amir sighed. Amir: "It only answers when it feels like it." Me: "THEN IT NEEDS TO LEARN ABOUT CUSTOMER SATISFACTION."

Lara squeezed my hand. Lara: "Maybe we should let Zayn finish." I nodded. Zayn took a breath. Zayn: "The last thing I remember is the voice saying, 'You will return when the others remember.'" He opened his eyes. Zayn: "Then I woke up." I looked at him. Me: "And you think the voice was talking about us?" Zayn: "I think it knew we'd meet again." Me: "But why?" Zayn didn't answer. Because the truth was, none of us knew.

Scene 5 — The Silver Wristband ■We returned to the photograph.

Violetta placed it beside Zayn's drawing. The mysterious person in the photograph wore a silver wristband bearing a small emblem. The details were blurry, but the emblem seemed to match the symbol from Zayn's notebook. Violetta: "Look at the dots." We leaned closer. Violetta: "There are three visible dots around the symbol. The fourth might be hidden by the person's sleeve." Zayn examined the image. Zayn: "The notebook's symbol has four dots beneath the infinity sign."

Amir: "Could the wristband be a clue to the four dots?" Me: "Or the four dots are a clue to the wristband." Amir: "Those are the same thing." Me: "LET ME SOUND INTELLIGENT." Lara laughed. Lara: "You're doing great, detective." Me: "Thank you. I accept payment in snacks." Avinia pointed at another detail. Avinia: "Look at the person's hand." The person was holding a small notebook with a dark cover and a silver marking near the centre. Zayn pulled his own notebook closer. The covers weren't identical, but the markings were remarkably similar. Zayn: "I've never seen this photograph before." Me: "But you've had that notebook since before we met, right?" Zayn nodded. Zayn: "I don't remember where I got it." Silence. I looked at him. Me: "You don't remember where your own notebook came from?" Zayn: "No." Amir: "That's… not ideal." Me: "BRO, THAT IS A MASSIVE PROBLEM." Zayn opened the notebook to the first page. There it was. INFINITE INSTINCT PROJECT. Below it:

DOMAIN EXPANSION: INFINITE INSTINCT PHANTOM. And beneath that: SUBJECT ZERO. I stared at the words. My signature move. My forgotten memories. Zayn's notebook. The stadium. The mysterious person. Somehow, these pieces belonged to the same puzzle. Me: "Zayn, why does your notebook have the name of my move?" Zayn: "I don't know." Me: "And why does it call you Subject Zero?" Zayn: "I don't know." Me: "And

why do I feel like we're missing the biggest piece of the entire story?" Zayn looked at me. Zayn: "Because we are." For once, I had no joke.

Scene 6 — Lara's Theory

After lunch, Lara and I walked a little way from the others. She noticed I'd gone quiet. Lara: "What's going on in that head of yours?" Me: "Too much." Lara: "More than usual?" Me: "A historic amount." She smiled, then looked toward the football field.

Lara: "You're worried about Zayn." I nodded. Me: "He keeps having these dreams, and now his notebook is connecting him to something none of us remember. What if he discovers something that changes everything?" Lara: "It might." I looked at her. Lara: "But that doesn't mean it has to change who you are to each other." She gently held my hand. Lara: "Whatever happened before, the friendship you have now is real. You don't need every memory to prove that." I smiled a little. Me: "When did you become the wise anime character?" Lara: "I've always been the wise anime character." Me: "Fair." She looked at me with her green eyes. Lara: "And you don't have to solve every mystery today, Yaya." I nodded. Me: "I know." Then I grinned. Me: "But if the notebook starts writing my exam answers, I'm absolutely keeping it." Lara: "YAYA!" Me: "WHAT? IMAGINE GETTING FULL MARKS BECAUSE A SUPERNATURAL NOTEBOOK LIKES YOU." She laughed and rested her head briefly against

my shoulder. For that moment, the mystery could wait. I had Lara. I had my friends. And I had a football field to return to. Honestly, that was enough to keep me going.

Scene 7 — The Stadium Returns

That evening, I decided to practise football. Not because I was trying to unlock a new transformation. Not because I wanted to impress anyone. And definitely not because I thought kicking a ball hard enough would solve a supernatural mystery. Okay, maybe a little. I stood on the field and placed the ball at my feet. The sky was turning orange. The school was quieter than usual. I took a few steps backward. Me: "All right. Infinite Instinct Phantom." I began my familiar footwork. A quick touch. A change of direction. A feint. Then a sudden burst of speed. For a moment, everything felt perfectly natural. The ball moved exactly where I wanted it to go. And then— The field changed. Not physically.

Not in a way anyone else could see. But the world around me seemed to fade. The orange sky darkened. The lines on the grass glowed silver. Purple lights appeared along the edges of the field. I stopped moving. Me: "No." The stadium from my dreams stretched out before me. Towering stands. Silver pillars. Purple lights. The infinity symbol beneath my feet. I was standing in the impossible stadium. Again. A football rested at the centre of the field. Three silhouettes stood on the opposite side. I recognised two of them immediately. Amir. Zayn. The third figure stood slightly behind them, holding a notebook. Me: "Who are you?!" The silhouettes didn't move. Then a voice echoed through the stadium. Mysterious voice: "You have returned to the beginning." I took a step forward. Me: "I HAVE NEVER BEEN HERE!" The voice answered. Mysterious voice: "You have forgotten being

here." My heart started racing. Me: "Why do we keep forgetting?!" The stadium lights flickered. For one brief moment, the third silhouette became clearer. I could see the outline of their face. But before I could recognise it, the figure turned away. Me: "WAIT!" I ran toward them. The ground beneath my feet lit up with silver lines. The infinity symbol expanded. Four dots appeared beneath it. Then I heard another voice. Zayn's voice. Zayn: "Yaya! Don't touch the ball!" I froze. The football was directly in front of me. A second voice echoed from the stands. Unknown voice: "The rules were written for you." I stepped backward. The stadium shook. And then, for the first time, I heard all three voices at once. Voice One: "One would lead." Voice Two: "One would

remember." Voice Three: "One would return." I covered my ears. Me: "STOP SPEAKING IN PUZZLES!" The lights went out.

The football rolled toward me. It stopped at my feet. A silver message appeared on the ground. THE STADIUM NEVER DISAPPEARED. YOU DID. I stared at the words. Then everything vanished. I was back on the ordinary school football field. The orange sky had returned. The grass was normal. The football rested at my feet. I stood completely still, trying to catch my breath. Me (narrating): That wasn't just a dream. I had been awake. I had been standing on the field. And for a few seconds, I had seen the stadium as clearly as I could see the football in front of me. I grabbed my phone and called Amir. He answered almost immediately. Amir: "Yaya?" Me: "I saw it." Amir: "Saw what?" Me: "The stadium." Silence. Then Amir spoke. Amir: "Where are you?" Me: "The football field." Amir: "Stay there. We're coming."

Scene 8 — Three Survivors, One Reality

Within minutes, Amir and Zayn arrived. Lara, Avinia, and Violetta came with them. I explained everything. The lights. The stadium. The silhouettes. The voices. The message on the ground. Zayn listened without interrupting. When I finished, he slowly opened his notebook. Zayn: "I think I understand something." Me: "Please tell me it's something useful." Zayn: "The stadium might not be a physical place we can visit." Amir: "Then what is it?" Zayn: "A shared memory." Violetta considered that. Violetta: "A memory that all three of you are connected to?" Zayn: "Possibly. But I don't think we've remembered the same parts of it." Avinia: "Which could explain why the dreams are different." Lara looked at me. Lara: "And why you saw it while you were awake." I nodded. Me: "Whatever that place is, it feels like something I've forgotten." Amir looked down at the football. Amir: "I remember standing inside a silver circle. I remember the three footballs. I remember our promise."

He looked up. Amir: "But I don't remember what happened after we made it." Zayn opened the notebook to a blank page. A new message appeared. THE FIRST MEMORY HAS RETURNED. THE SECOND MEMORY HAS AWAKENED. THE THIRD MEMORY REMAINS HIDDEN. We stared at the page. Me: "So my experience counts as the second memory?" The notebook wrote another sentence. THE SECOND MEMORY BELONGS TO ZAYN. Zayn swallowed. Zayn: "Then what I saw must be connected to what Yaya just experienced." Amir: "But we still don't know who the third silhouette is." The notebook flickered. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE REMEMBERS ALL THREE OF YOU. I looked at the photograph again. The person holding the notebook. The silver wristband. The infinity symbol. Me: "And whoever that person is, they were at my showcase." Zayn: "Which means we have a real clue." For the first time all day, I felt hopeful. We weren't just chasing dreams anymore. We had a photograph. A symbol. A recovered name.

And a memory that had appeared while I was awake. We were getting closer. Then the notebook wrote one more message. SUBJECT ZERO MUST RETURN TO THE PLACE WHERE THE FIRST PROMISE WAS MADE. Zayn stared at the page. Zayn: "The place where the first promise was made…" Amir looked toward the centre of the football field. Amir: "Was it here?" I looked at the grass. At the goalposts. At the place where I'd performed Infinite Instinct Phantom. I didn't know. But something inside me whispered that the answer was close. Very close.

Scene 9 — The Person Who Never Forgot

That night, Zayn sent a message to the group chat. Zayn: I remembered another detail. Me: BRO PLEASE SAY IT BEFORE I AGE 40 YEARS. Zayn: In the stadium, the third silhouette wasn't looking at Yaya or Amir. Amir: Who were they looking at? There was a long pause. Then Zayn replied. Zayn: Me. I stared at the screen.

Me: WHAT? Zayn: I think the third silhouette was waiting for me. Amir: Why? Zayn: I don't know. But when I woke up, I remembered a voice saying, "You were supposed to return first." My stomach tightened. Me: Return from where? Zayn: That's what I can't remember. I sat back in my chair. The pieces were beginning to connect. The original name. The first oath. The second oath. The stadium. Subject Zero. The mysterious figure in the photograph. And someone who had apparently never forgotten us. I typed slowly. Me: Zayn, do you think you've met this person in real life? His reply arrived almost immediately. Zayn: I think I have. Me: Do you know who they are? Zayn: No. Then another message appeared. Zayn: But I remember one thing about them. I leaned closer to the screen. Me: WHAT? Zayn: They told me that when the time came, I

would recognise them. I stared at the message. Then my phone buzzed again. It was a photograph from Zayn. He had taken a picture of the notebook. The page contained a new sentence. THE SECOND MEMORY WILL BEGIN WHEN ZAYN MEETS THE PERSON WHO NEVER FORGOT. Below it was a second line. THE PERSON IS ALREADY CLOSE. I immediately called him. Zayn: "Yaya?" Me: "Bro, what does 'already close' mean?" Zayn: "I don't know." Me: "Could it be someone at school?" Zayn: "Maybe." Me: "Someone we've already met?" Zayn: "Maybe." Me: "Someone from the photograph?" Zayn: "Maybe." I sighed. Me: "You are absolutely useless at answering questions." Zayn: "I'M TRYING!" I laughed. Then I became serious again. Me: "We'll figure it out." Zayn: "Together?" I smiled. Me: "Always, bro." We ended the call. I looked at the ceiling.

For the first time, I understood why the notebook kept repeating the same message. The mystery wasn't asking us to find a random person. It was asking us to remember someone who had already been part of our lives. Someone who knew the Infinity Three. Someone who knew about the stadium. Someone who had never forgotten the promise. And someone who was waiting for Zayn to remember. Me (narrating): We had spent so long searching for the place where our story began that we had forgotten to ask the most important question. Who had been there with us? I closed my eyes. In the darkness, I imagined the stadium one more time. Three silhouettes. A floating football. A silver notebook. And a fourth presence standing just beyond the lights. I couldn't see their face. But I could hear their voice. Unknown voice: "You found the stadium." A pause. Unknown voice: "Now find me." I opened my eyes. Me: "NAHHHHH. THIS PERSON IS DOING SIDE QUESTS IN REAL LIFE." And just like that, my peaceful night was ruined again.

End of Chapter 16 — The Stadium That Never

Existed

Chapter 17

A Boy in a Girl Parade Army Chapter 17: The Third Name

Previously…

We discovered that the mysterious stadium might be a shared memory rather than an ordinary place. I saw it while practising football, and Zayn remembered that a mysterious silhouette had been waiting for him. The notebook delivered one final message: THE PERSON IS ALREADY CLOSE. Now we had a photograph, a silver emblem, and a name that none of us understood. SUBJECT ZERO. And I had a feeling that our next discovery would change everything. Scene 1 — The Morning I Became a Detective

Against My Will I woke up, looked at my ceiling, and immediately regretted being conscious. Me: "Today's going to be normal."

I waited. Nothing happened. Me: "See? Character development." My phone buzzed. Zayn: `Yaya. Emergency. Come to school early.` I stared at the message. Me: "I TAKE IT BACK." I opened the group chat. SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE Me: `Define emergency.` Zayn: `The notebook has a new message.` Amir: `Of course it does.` Me: `DOES THIS NOTEBOOK HAVE A SCHEDULE?` Amir: `Apparently it works overtime.` Me: `AND IT DOESN'T EVEN PAY TAXES.` Zayn sent a photograph.

The notebook lay open on his desk. A fresh message covered the page. THE THIRD NAME WILL BE REMEMBERED WHEN THE FIRST THREE STAND TOGETHER. I read it twice. Me: `First three? That's us.` Zayn: `I think so.` Amir: `Then why does it say the third name?` I stopped typing. That was the problem. If we were the first three, whose name was missing? I sent one final message. Me: `Meet at the field. And someone bring breakfast because I'm not solving supernatural mysteries on an empty stomach.` Amir: `You think food is the solution to everything.` Me: `IT HAS A BETTER SUCCESS RATE THAN YOUR

NOTEBOOK.` Scene 2 — The Photograph Has a Secret

By the time I reached school, Amir and Zayn were waiting beside the football field. Lara, Avinia, and Violetta arrived a few minutes later. Zayn had brought the old showcase photograph. We gathered around it. Lara: "Let's start with what we actually know." I nodded. Me: "Excellent. Facts. Evidence. Logic. Normal detective stuff." Amir: "You put a football sticker on your investigation notebook." Me: "THE FOOTBALL IS EVIDENCE OF MY EXPERTISE." Lara gently took the photograph from me. Lara: "Focus, detective." I gave her a salute.

Me: "Yes, boss." She smiled and returned to the photograph. The mysterious person was still partly hidden behind another student. Their face was impossible to make out, but the silver wristband was visible. Violetta leaned closer. Violetta: "There's something underneath the wristband." Zayn: "Where?" She pointed to a tiny mark near the person's sleeve. It looked like a small number. A zero. My stomach tightened. Me: "Guys… is that a zero?" Amir squinted. Amir: "It might be. The photograph is blurry." Zayn carefully compared it with the notebook.

Zayn: "Subject Zero." Nobody spoke. Me: "So the person in the photograph could be connected to Subject Zero?" Lara: "Could be. We can't say for certain from this image alone." Me: "Right. No jumping to conclusions." I paused. Me: "But I'm jumping internally." Avinia laughed. Then Zayn turned the photograph over. On the back was a handwritten note. We hadn't noticed it before because the paper had been folded over at the corner. The writing was faint, but three words were still readable: THREE. ONE. RETURN. Amir stepped backward.

Amir: "That's the phrase from our memories." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "And it was written on the photograph before we started investigating it." I stared at the paper. Someone had left us a clue. Someone who knew about the Infinity Three. Someone who might have known that we'd eventually come looking. Me: "Okay." I took a deep breath. Me: "This is officially bigger than a forgotten football match." Amir: "You think?" Me: "I WAS TRYING TO BUILD DRAMATIC TENSION." Scene 3 — Amir's Second Memory

We sat on the benches beside the field.

Amir had been unusually quiet since we discovered the note. Me: "Bro, what's going on?" He looked at the photograph. Amir: "I remember the silver wristband." Zayn: "From the stadium?" Amir: "Yes. But there's something else." He closed his eyes. Amir: "I remember three people standing in a circle. Someone was explaining the rules. Then I remember you, Yaya, asking a question." Me: "What question?" Amir concentrated. Amir: "You asked, 'What happens if one of us doesn't come back?'" The field suddenly seemed quieter. Lara: "What did the other person say?" Amir shook his head.

Amir: "I can't remember the answer." Zayn opened the notebook. A new message appeared. THE SECOND OATH IS NOT ABOUT FINDING EACH OTHER. Another line appeared beneath it. IT IS ABOUT WHAT YOU WILL DO WHEN YOU DO. I frowned. Me: "That is the least helpful helpful message I've ever read." Avinia: "Maybe it means the second oath is about what happens after we reunite." Zayn: "A promise we made for the future." Amir opened his eyes. Amir: "I think someone asked us to protect something." Me: "What?" Amir: "I don't know." The notebook flickered.

THE MEMORY IS INCOMPLETE. Then it went blank. Amir rubbed his forehead. Amir: "Every time I remember something, I feel like there's another piece just out of reach." I sat beside him. Me: "Then we'll find it. No pressure to remember everything at once." Amir looked at me. Amir: "Since when did you become so wise?" Me: "Since I realised my genius was being wasted on football." Amir: "You're still an idiot." Me: "AND YOU'RE STILL MY BRO." We bumped fists. Zayn joined us. For a moment, the three of us sat together without saying anything.

The Infinity Three. A name from a past we couldn't fully remember. A promise we'd somehow kept. And a second oath we hadn't yet understood. Scene 4 — The Person Who Knows Zayn

During break, Violetta asked Zayn if she could speak with him. Naturally, Amir and I immediately became professional investigators. Me, whispering: "Operation Purple Honey is active." Amir: "Don't embarrass him." Me: "I WOULD NEVER." Lara appeared behind us. Lara: "What are you two doing?" Amir: "Nothing." Me: "We are observing social development."

Lara: "You're spying." Me: "SCIENTIFICALLY OBSERVING." She gave me a look. I immediately stood up straight. Me: "We're going to get snacks." Amir: "Coward." Me: "I CHOOSE LIFE." We left them some space. From a distance, I could see Zayn talking with Violetta near the courtyard. He looked nervous, but he wasn't panicking. Violetta was smiling. Then something happened. She reached into her schoolbag and pulled out a small silver keychain. Zayn froze. Even from where I stood, I could tell something was wrong.

Violetta noticed his reaction. Violetta: "Zayn? Are you okay?" He stared at the keychain. Zayn: "Where did you get that?" Violetta looked down at it. Violetta: "I've had it for ages. Why?" The keychain had an infinity symbol with four tiny dots beneath it. The exact symbol from the notebook. Zayn looked as though the ground had disappeared beneath his feet. Zayn: "I've seen that before." Violetta: "Where?" Zayn: "In my dreams." Violetta's smile faded slightly. Violetta: "That's strange." Zayn nodded.

Zayn: "Can I ask you something?" Violetta: "Of course." He hesitated. Zayn: "Do you remember meeting me before this school year?" Violetta thought carefully. Violetta: "I don't think so. Not that I remember." Zayn looked disappointed for a moment, but he didn't push her. Zayn: "Okay. Sorry. It's just… complicated."

Violetta put the keychain away. Violetta: "You don't have to explain everything right now." She smiled again. Violetta: "But if you need help figuring it out, I'll listen." Zayn's expression softened.

Zayn: "Thank you." And that was it. No dramatic confession. No forcing answers. Just two people choosing to trust each other. Honestly, better character development than half the anime I've watched. When Zayn returned, Amir and I were waiting. Me: "BRO." Zayn: "Don't." Me: "THE KEYCHAIN." Zayn showed us the symbol he'd drawn from memory. It matched the one on Violetta's keychain. Amir: "Could she be the person the notebook is talking about?" Zayn shook his head. Zayn: "I don't know. She doesn't remember meeting me before."

Me: "Then we don't assume anything." I glanced at the notebook. Me: "We investigate the symbol, not pressure Violetta." Zayn nodded gratefully. But I couldn't shake the feeling that we'd just uncovered something important. Scene 5 — The Third Silhouette Remembers

After school, the Survivors' Alliance gathered in our usual spot. Zayn placed his notebook on the bench. Amir placed the photograph beside it. Violetta's symbol had been carefully drawn on a separate sheet. Three clues. One mystery. And approximately zero instructions. Me: "All right, notebook. We have questions."

The notebook remained closed. Me: "First question: who is the third silhouette?" Nothing. Me: "Second question: what is Subject Zero?" Nothing. Me: "Third question: why do you communicate like a broken fortune cookie?" Lara covered her mouth. Lara: "Yaya!" Me: "IT'S A FAIR QUESTION." Zayn opened the notebook. The pages turned by themselves. A message appeared. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE REMEMBERS ALL THREE OF YOU. Beneath it: THE THIRD NAME IS NOT LOST.

IT IS WAITING. Amir leaned forward. Amir: "Waiting for what?" The notebook answered. FOR THE SECOND OATH TO BE REMEMBERED. Zayn looked at Amir. Zayn: "Your memory." Amir nodded slowly. Amir: "The second oath. The person who asked us to protect something. The question about what happens if one of us doesn't come back." He paused. Amir: "I think they're connected." I looked at the photograph again. The person wearing the silver wristband might have been the one who explained the rules. But the image wasn't clear enough to prove it.

Me: "What if the third silhouette is the person who made us promise?" Lara: "That's possible." Avinia: "But we shouldn't assume the silhouette and the person in the photograph are definitely the same person." Me: "Right. Evidence first. Dramatic accusations later." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "The notebook is telling us to remember the second oath before we can learn the third name." Amir looked frustrated. Amir: "I hate that I can't remember." I put my hand on his shoulder. Me: "You remembered our name today. That's progress." Amir: "What if I can't remember the rest?" Me: "Then we'll find another clue." I smiled at him.

Me: "We're the Infinity Three, remember? Apparently, forgetting everything is our specialty." Amir laughed quietly. Then he looked at the notebook. Amir: "I remember something else." We all turned toward him. Amir: "The person who explained the rules wasn't standing outside the circle." He swallowed. Amir: "They were standing inside it. With us." Silence. The notebook began glowing. A new message appeared. THE THIRD SILHOUETTE WAS NEVER AN OUTSIDER. I stared at the words. Me: "They were one of us?" Zayn looked at the three dots beneath the

infinity symbol. Zayn: "Maybe the Infinity Three weren't always just three." The notebook flashed. For a moment, a fourth dot appeared. Then it vanished. Scene 6 — The Name Beneath the Page

We thought we'd reached the end of the day's discoveries. We were wrong. Zayn turned to the last page of the notebook. There was a small folded paper tucked into the binding. He carefully pulled it out. It was old, creased, and covered in handwriting that none of us recognised. At the top were three words: INFINITY PROJECT —

The rest of the heading had been smudged. Below it was a list. - Subject Zero - Memory One - Memory Two - The Return - The Fourth Heart I stared at the list. Me: "The Fourth Heart?" Amir looked at Zayn. Amir: "That's the same phrase from before." Zayn nodded. Zayn: "The notebook told us the fourth heart had been found when we discovered Violetta's promise." Violetta, who had stayed with us, looked at the paper. Violetta: "Does that mean I'm connected to the project?" Me: "Possibly. But we don't know how yet."

She nodded. Violetta: "Then we'll figure it out when we have more information." Zayn turned the paper over. There was one final sentence written on the back. THE ONE WHO RETURNS MUST REMEMBER THE NAME THEY WERE GIVEN. He read it aloud. Nobody spoke. Then he whispered: Zayn: "The name I was given…" I looked at him. Me: "Your name is Zayn." Zayn: "I know." Me: "And before you met us, you were still Zayn, right?" He hesitated. Zayn: "I think so."

Amir's expression changed. Amir: "What do you mean, you think so?" Zayn looked down at the paper. Zayn: "I've always remembered my name. But in some dreams, I hear someone calling me something else." My stomach tightened. Me: "What do they call you?" Zayn closed his eyes. Zayn: "I can't remember." The notebook shook in his hands. The pages turned rapidly. Then the paper slipped from his fingers. It landed on the bench. A new line appeared beneath the list. SUBJECT ZERO IS NOT A TITLE. IT IS A BEGINNING.

Zayn stared at the words. Zayn: "A beginning of what?" The notebook did not answer. Instead, the last page slowly filled with silver letters. WHEN ZAYN REMEMBERS HIS FIRST NAME, THE THIRD NAME WILL RETURN. I felt a chill run down my back. Me: "First name?" Amir: "But Zayn is his name." Lara: "Maybe the notebook means a name from before." Zayn looked as though he was trying to reach for something deep inside his memory. Zayn: "I can almost hear it." Me: "Take your time, bro." He closed his eyes. For a few seconds, nobody moved.

Then Zayn whispered something. A single sound. A name that he couldn't quite finish. His eyes snapped open. Zayn: "I heard it." Amir: "What was it?" Zayn shook his head. Zayn: "I don't know. It disappeared." The notebook went completely blank. Not one message. Not one symbol. Nothing. For the first time since we'd discovered it, the notebook looked like an ordinary notebook. Zayn closed it carefully. Zayn: "I think the next memory is mine."

I nodded. Me: "Then we'll help you find it." He looked at me and Amir. Zayn: "Even if it changes everything?" Amir held out his fist. Amir: "Especially then." I bumped it. Me: "Infinity Three." Zayn joined us. Zayn: "Infinity Three." Four words. Three friends. One promise. And a past that was finally beginning to open. Scene 7 — The Dream That Called Him Back

That night, Zayn dreamed again.

He was standing in the purple-and-silver stadium. But this time, he wasn't alone. The stands were filled with shadows. The silver circle glowed beneath his feet. A notebook lay in the centre of the field. He approached it. On its cover was the infinity symbol with four dots. He opened it. The first page contained a single sentence. WELCOME BACK. Zayn looked up. At the far end of the stadium stood a person wearing a silver wristband. The same wristband from the photograph. The same emblem. The same mysterious figure who had appeared in our memories.

Zayn: "Who are you?" The person didn't answer. Zayn: "Why do you keep appearing in my dreams?" Silence. Then the person spoke. Unknown person: "Because you promised you'd return." Zayn took a step forward. Zayn: "Return from where?" The person raised a hand and pointed toward the stadium entrance. There, beneath a silver light, stood two silhouettes. Yaya. Amir. Zayn turned back toward the mysterious person. Zayn: "What happened to us?"

The person finally moved closer. Unknown person: "You forgot." Zayn: "Why?" The figure paused. Unknown person: "Because you were afraid of what you would remember." Zayn shook his head. Zayn: "I don't understand." The figure held out a small silver wristband. On it was a name. But before Zayn could read it, the stadium lights flashed. The name disappeared. The figure stepped backward into the shadows. Zayn: "WAIT! I NEED TO KNOW WHO YOU ARE!" The voice echoed through the stadium. Unknown person: "You already know me."

Then came the words that made Zayn's entire dream freeze. Unknown person: "You were there when we made the promise." The stadium disappeared. Zayn woke up, breathing quickly. His notebook lay beside his bed. It was open. A new message covered the page. THE SECOND MEMORY HAS BEGUN. Below it: THE THIRD NAME IS CLOSER THAN EVER. And at the very bottom, written in tiny silver letters, was a name. Zayn stared at it. His lips parted. He recognised the name. He knew he'd heard it before.

But before he could say it aloud, the silver letters faded. The page became blank. Zayn sat completely still. For the first time, he wasn't just frightened. He was certain. Someone from his forgotten past was waiting for him. And the next time he saw that person, he would have to remember. Scene 8 — The Message at 3:03 AM

At 3:03 AM, my phone buzzed. I opened one eye. Me: "If this is another emergency, I'm transferring schools." The message was from Zayn. Zayn: `Yaya. I dreamed about the person again.` I sat upright.

Me: `WHAT HAPPENED?` Zayn: `They said I was there when the promise was made.` Me: `Do you remember them?` Zayn: `Not yet.` A few seconds passed. Then he sent another message. Zayn: `But I think the third silhouette was standing beside us because they were part of the Infinity Three from the beginning.` I stared at the screen. Me: `You mean there were FOUR of us?` Zayn: `Maybe.` Me: `THE INFINITY FOUR?!` Zayn: `Yaya.` Me: `WHAT? IT HAS A NICE RING TO IT.` Zayn: `Please take this seriously.`

I stopped joking. Me: `I am, bro. I'm here.` His reply came quickly. Zayn: `Thank you.` I put my phone down and stared at the ceiling. Three dots. Four dots. The Infinity Three. The Fourth Heart. Subject Zero. The third silhouette. Maybe we'd misunderstood the entire mystery from the beginning. Maybe the story wasn't about three boys recovering their memories. Maybe it was about remembering someone who had been there all along. Someone whose name had been hidden because we

weren't ready to remember it. And maybe the person who never forgot wasn't waiting for Zayn alone. Maybe they were waiting for all of us. Me (narrating): We had found our old name. We had remembered our first promise. And we were finally beginning to understand that our forgotten past was more complicated than any of us had imagined. But the third name remained hidden. And until we remembered it, the Infinity Three would never truly understand why they had been brought together. I closed my eyes. For once, I didn't hear a voice. I didn't see the stadium. I simply fell asleep, hoping that tomorrow would bring us closer to the truth. And somewhere in the darkness, a final message appeared inside Zayn's notebook. THREE SURVIVORS.

ONE FORGOTTEN NAME. FOUR HEARTS. ONE PROMISE THAT MUST BE KEPT. TO BE CONTINUED… End of Chapter 17 — The Third Name

Chapter 18

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 18: The Promise That Connected Us

“Three survivors. One forgotten name. Four hearts. One promise that must be kept.” Scene 1 — 3:03 AM: THE MOST UNWELCOME

NOTIFICATION EVER I was sleeping peacefully. No school. No homework. No girls chasing me down the hallway. No football training. No supernatural notebooks exposing my entire life. For once, my brain had decided to stop producing anime episodes without my permission. Then— BZZZT. BZZZT. BZZZT. My phone vibrated so hard that I thought it was trying to escape my bedroom. I opened one eye. Zayn the Mainframe — 3:03 AM

Zayn: YAYA. Me: Bro, if you're being chased by a demon, tell it to wait until morning. Zayn: THE NOTEBOOK IS WRITING AGAIN. Me: Put it in a drawer. Zayn: IT'S INSIDE THE DRAWER. Me: Put the drawer outside. Zayn: YAYA, I'M SERIOUS. I sat up. Yeah. Okay. This was officially above the pay grade of my sleeping brain. Me: What does it say? A photograph appeared. The notebook's page was covered in silver writing. > THE PROMISE THAT CONNECTED YOU WAS MADE BEFORE YOU REMEMBERED. Below it, another sentence appeared.

> THE SECOND OATH CANNOT BE REMEMBERED BY ONE ALONE. Then the page went blank. Three seconds later, new words appeared. > RETURN TO THE PLACE WHERE FOUR SHADOWS BECAME THREE. I stared at the screen. Four shadows. Three. One forgotten name. And a notebook that apparently had more plot twists than a 500-episode anime. Me: Zayn. Zayn: Yeah? Me: We need to investigate this tomorrow. Zayn: Obviously. Me: At a reasonable hour. Zayn: Obviously.

Me: Like after breakfast. Zayn: Yaya. Me: WHAT? Zayn: I haven't slept. I looked at the time again. 3:03 AM. Me: Skill issue. I threw my phone onto the pillow and lay back down. Then another message arrived. Zayn: Yaya? Me: BRO. Zayn: What if I don't want to remember who I used to be? I stopped joking. For once, I didn't immediately have a ridiculous answer.

Me: Then we won't force you. Zayn: Even if the notebook says I have to? Me: Especially then. A creepy book doesn't get to decide everything about your life. There was a pause. Zayn: Thanks, bro. Me: Now sleep. Zayn: You sleep. Me: I'M TRYING. I put my phone down. And just as I began drifting off, I heard a voice. Not from my phone. Not from the hallway. From somewhere inside my dream. "You promised to protect us." I opened my eyes.

My bedroom was silent. But for a split second, I could see four tiny silver dots floating above my desk. Then they disappeared. Scene 2 — THE SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE EMERGENCY

MEETING The next morning, I arrived at school with two brain cells remaining. One was thinking about breakfast. The other had resigned. Amir spotted me near the entrance. Amir: YAYA! Me: Don't shout. My soul is buffering. Amir: Zayn sent the group chat the notebook message. Me: I know. Amir: FOUR SHADOWS BECAME THREE. Me: I CAN READ, AMIR.

Amir: What if there were actually four members of the Infinity Three? I slowly turned toward him. Me: That's literally why it's called the Infinity Three. Three. Amir: Unless— Me: No. Amir: Unless the fourth member was so powerful that they counted as three people. Me: That is not how mathematics works. Amir: You don't know their power level. Me: I am begging you to attend one mathematics lesson. Zayn approached us, holding his notebook. He looked exhausted. The notebook looked perfectly healthy, which was honestly offensive. Zayn: I think the message is talking about our original group.

Me: The Infinity Three? Zayn: Yeah. But I remember something strange from my dream. He opened the notebook to a blank page. Zayn: There were four people standing around the silver circle. Then one of them stepped away. Amir: Why? Zayn: I don't know. But after they stepped away, I could only see three shadows. I frowned. Me: So the fourth person left? Zayn: Maybe. Amir: Or maybe they were hiding. Me: Why would someone hide from their own friends? Amir shrugged. Amir: Maybe they owed money. Me: BRO. THIS IS A SUPERNATURAL MYSTERY, NOT A DEBT COLLECTION AGENCY.

Zayn almost smiled. Almost. Then the notebook's pages began turning by themselves. FLIP. FLIP. FLIP. They stopped on a page covered in silver symbols. Words appeared slowly. > THE FIRST OATH WAS TO FIND EACH OTHER AGAIN. We already knew that. Then— > THE SECOND OATH WAS TO PROTECT WHAT REMAINED. Amir stepped closer. Amir: Protect what remained? Another line appeared. > WHEN ONE FORGOT, TWO WOULD REMEMBER. My stomach tightened.

A third sentence appeared. > WHEN TWO FORGOT, ONE WOULD RETURN. Nobody spoke. For once, Amir had nothing funny to say. Then a final line appeared. > WHEN ALL THREE FORGET, THE FOURTH MUST CHOOSE. Zayn slowly closed the notebook. Zayn: The fourth person wasn't just part of our group. Me: They had a responsibility. Amir: A responsibility connected to us. I looked at the three of us. Yaya. Amir. Zayn. The Survivors' Alliance. The Infinity Three.

Three boys who'd become friends at school without knowing that, somehow, we'd apparently already been connected before we met. And somewhere in that missing history, there was a fourth person. Someone who remembered everything. Someone who might have been waiting for us for years. Me: Okay. I clapped my hands once. Me: New mission. We find out what we promised to protect. Amir: And the fourth person? Me: We find them too. Zayn: And if remembering everything changes how we see each other? I looked at him. Me: Then we deal with it together. Amir raised his fist.

Amir: SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE! Me: Don't shout that in the middle of the hallway. Amir: SURVIVORS' ALLIANCE! Me: I AM GOING TO UN-ALLIANCE YOU. Scene 3 — OPERATION: ASK THE GIRLS BEFORE THE

NOTEBOOK DOES SOMETHING WEIRD At lunch, we gathered our investigation team. Lara sat beside me, her pink braids falling over her shoulders. Her green eyes immediately narrowed when she noticed my exhausted expression. Lara: You didn't sleep properly, did you? Me: I slept. Lara: For how long? Me: That's a very complicated mathematical question. Amir: Three hours. Me: AMIR, YOU HAVE BETRAYED THE BROTHERHOOD.

Lara crossed her arms. Lara: Yaya. Me: Four hours? Lara: Yaya. Me: Time is a social construct. She gave me the look. I sighed. Me: Fine. Not enough. She gently nudged my shoulder. Lara: You can't solve every mystery by exhausting yourself. Me: I'm not exhausting myself. The mystery is exhausting me. Avinia: That's somehow worse. Amir sat beside Avinia, immediately becoming about 70% less chaotic. Zayn sat opposite Violetta, attempting to appear normal.

He was failing. Violetta opened her notebook. Violetta: So, the fourth person might have been protecting something? Zayn: That's what the message says. Violetta: And the message says the fourth person must choose when all three of you forget. Me: Exactly. Violetta thought for a moment. Violetta: What if the fourth person was protecting your memories? We all looked at her. Amir: Wait. Me: Keep talking. Violetta: Think about it. The notebook keeps talking about memories, promises, returning, and forgetting. Maybe the fourth person wasn't protecting an object. Maybe they were protecting the truth about what happened.

Silence. Then Amir slowly raised a finger. Amir: I would like to officially nominate Violetta as our Head of Brain Operations. Violetta: I haven't accepted the position. Amir: The paperwork is already in my imagination.

Zayn smiled at her. Zayn: That's actually a really good theory. Violetta glanced at him. Violetta: Thanks. He looked away a little too quickly. I leaned toward Amir. Me: Bro's processor just overheated. Amir: His GPU is running at 100%. Zayn: I CAN HEAR YOU. Me: GOOD. THEN HEAR THIS: DRINK WATER. Lara laughed.

For a moment, everything felt normal. Friends eating lunch. Amir being ridiculous. Zayn trying to survive a conversation with Violetta. Lara sitting beside me. Then Zayn's notebook slid off the table. It hit the floor. THUMP. The cover opened. A folded sheet of paper slipped out. It hadn't been there before. I picked it up. At the top were four symbols arranged in a circle. Three were familiar. The infinity symbol.

The silver circle. The four dots. The fourth symbol was different. A small shield with a line running through its centre. Beneath it were five words. > THE FOURTH DID NOT ABANDON YOU. Lara's smile disappeared. Lara: Then why did they leave? The paper changed. New words appeared beneath the first sentence. > THE FOURTH LEFT TO KEEP THE PROMISE. Zayn stared at the page. Zayn: They left to protect us? Me: Maybe they thought they had to do it alone. Avinia: That's a terrible plan.

Amir: Objectively terrible. Zero stars. No teamwork. Would not recommend. Violetta studied the shield symbol. Violetta: What if they weren't trying to leave you forever? What if they were waiting for the right moment to return? I looked at the paper. At the symbols. At the message. Then the ink shifted again. > THE RETURN HAS ALREADY BEGUN. I felt a chill run through me. Because the notebook had said something similar about Zayn. The Return. The one who returns must remember the name they were given. Was Zayn the person returning? Or was he the one who would bring the fourth

person back? I didn't know. And I was beginning to suspect that the notebook enjoyed watching us suffer. Scene 4 — THE FOOTBALL FIELD REMEMBERS

After classes, we went to the football field. The same field where I'd first shown off Domain Expansion: Infinite Instinct Phantom. The same field connected to the photograph. The same field where my forgotten promise to Violetta had begun. Apparently, my school had become the headquarters of a supernatural investigation agency. Nobody had given me a salary. Unacceptable. I stood at the centre circle with a football beneath my foot. Amir inspected the ground. Amir: So what are we doing?

Me: Recreating the memory. Amir: Which memory? Me: The one where we stood around the silver circle. Amir: We don't know what the circle looked like. Me: Then we'll start with a football circle. Amir: That's a centre circle, Yaya. Me: I KNOW WHAT A CENTRE CIRCLE IS. Zayn walked onto the field and stood beside us. Lara, Avinia, and Violetta watched from the sidelines. I placed the ball in the middle. Me: Let's try something. I looked at Amir. Me: Imagine you're the one who remembers. Then Zayn. Me: You're the one who returns.

Finally, I pointed to myself. Me: Apparently, I'm the one who leads. Amir: And the fourth? I looked at the empty space opposite us. Me: The one who protects. We formed a triangle around the ball. For a few seconds, nothing happened. Then the wind picked up. The grass bent beneath our shoes. And the world seemed to grow quieter. I heard a distant sound. A football bouncing. BOOM. A second bounce. BOOM. Then a voice.

A voice that sounded like it was coming from a memory buried deep inside me. "Three of you will remember." I froze. Me: Did you hear that? Zayn: Yeah. Amir: I heard it too. The voice continued. "One of you will return." The ball rolled by itself. It stopped directly in front of Zayn. He stepped back. Zayn: Why is it always me? Me: Because you're the main character of the mystery arc. Zayn: YOU'RE THE MAIN CHARACTER. Me: I AM THE MAIN CHARACTER OF MY OWN LIFE. YOU

HAVE YOUR OWN SPIN-OFF. Amir pointed at the ball. Amir: Guys. The football began glowing silver. Not bright enough to hurt our eyes. Just enough to illuminate the centre circle. A fourth shadow appeared on the

grass. I stared at it. Three of us were standing in the circle. But there were four shadows. The fourth stood between Amir and Zayn. No body. No person. Just a shadow. Lara called from the sidelines. Lara: Yaya?!

I couldn't answer. The shadow lifted its arm. And pointed at Zayn. The notebook in Zayn's bag burst open. Pages fluttered in the wind. Then one sentence appeared in enormous silver letters. > SUBJECT ZERO MUST REMEMBER WHO HE WAS BEFORE HE BECAME ZAYN. Zayn stumbled backwards. Zayn: No. Me: Zayn? He held his head, breathing quickly. Zayn: I know that sentence. Amir: From your dreams? Zayn shook his head. Zayn: No. From somewhere else.

He looked at the shadow. His expression changed. For a fraction of a second, he didn't look confused. He looked heartbroken. Zayn: You promised you would come back. The shadow disappeared. The silver light vanished. The football dropped to the grass. And Zayn fell to his knees. I rushed over. Me: ZAYN! Amir was beside him immediately. Amir: Bro, look at me. You're here. You're at school. You're with us. Zayn took a shaky breath. Zayn: I remembered a voice.

Me: Whose voice? He looked at me. Zayn: Mine. Nobody moved. Zayn: I was younger. I was standing in a room with silver walls. Someone was asking me to choose a name. Amir: A name? Zayn nodded. Zayn: They asked me if I wanted to keep the name they gave me or choose a new one. I crouched beside him. Me: What did you choose? Zayn closed his eyes. Zayn: I don't know. I can't remember. His notebook flipped to a fresh page. Three words appeared. > THE NAME BEFORE.

Then, beneath them: > ONE STEP CLOSER. Zayn stared at the page. Zayn: I think I was trying to forget something. I put a hand on his shoulder. Me: Then we'll figure out what happened. But you don't have to remember everything today. He looked at me. Zayn: You really believe that? Me: Bro, I can't even remember where I put my maths book half the time. We're going one memory at a time. Amir nodded solemnly. Amir: Inspirational. Academically concerning, but inspirational. Zayn laughed quietly. And just like that, the moment became a little easier to breathe through. Scene 5 — LARA'S QUESTION

Later, while Amir and Zayn were packing up, Lara asked me to walk with her. We stopped beside the school garden. The afternoon sun turned the windows gold. For a moment, neither of us spoke. Then Lara looked at me. Lara: Can I ask you something? Me: Of course. Lara: Are you scared of what you'll remember? I thought about it. The dreams. The stadium. The three silhouettes. The fourth shadow. The mysterious promise. Me: Yeah.

She nodded. Lara: Me too. I looked at her in surprise. Me: Why? You weren't even part of the original Infinity Three. At least, we don't think you were. Lara: Because I can see how much this is affecting you. And I don't know what happens if you remember something that changes everything. She paused. Lara: What if you discover that your old life was completely different from the one you have now? I leaned against the garden wall. Me: Then I guess I'll have to understand both. Lara: Both? Me: The person I was, and the person I've become. I looked at her. Me: Whatever happened before, I know who I am now. I'm your boyfriend. I'm Amir's best friend.

I'm part of the Survivors' Alliance. I love football. I hate maths homework. And I am absolutely not letting a notebook ruin my entire school year. Lara smiled. Lara: That last part might be difficult. Me: Don't destroy my dreams. She laughed and gently took my hand. Lara: Just promise me you'll tell me if things get too much. Me: I promise. She squeezed my hand. Lara: Good. Because I'm not letting you handle everything alone. I smiled. Me: You know, for someone who isn't part of the original supernatural football trio, you're doing a lot of carrying. Lara: Someone has to stop you three from making terrible decisions.

Me: Amir makes terrible decisions. I make legendary decisions. Lara: Yesterday, you tried to calculate the probability of finding one mystery girl using a number you invented. Me: LEGENDARY mathematics. She

laughed again. Then she looked at me with those green eyes. Lara: Whatever you remember, Yaya, you don't have to become that person again. You get to decide who you are. That stayed with me. More than any message in the notebook. More than any strange dream. Because Lara was right. Memories could explain who I had been. They didn't get to decide who I had to be. Scene 6 — THE MESSAGE THAT WASN'T FOR US

That evening, the Survivors' Alliance met online.

Amir: Today's official results: 1. We found a fourth shadow. 2. Zayn remembered that he chose a name. 3. The football became a lamp. 4. Nobody got paid. Me: This investigation is a financial disaster. Zayn: Guys, I found something. He sent a photograph. It showed the inside cover of his notebook. We'd seen it before, but never examined the faint writing near the bottom. Now the writing was clear. INFINITY PROJECT — ORIGINAL RECORD SUBJECT ZERO: ZAYN SUBJECT ONE: YAYA SUBJECT TWO: AMIR I sat upright. Me: WAIT.

Amir: EXCUSE ME?! Zayn: That's what it says. Me: WHY AM I SUBJECT ONE?! Amir: WHY AM I SUBJECT TWO?! Me: WHY IS ZAYN SUBJECT ZERO?! Amir: BRO, YOU'RE ASKING QUESTIONS IN THE WRONG ORDER. I stared at the screen. The labels were arranged exactly like that. Zayn: Subject Zero. Me: Subject One. Amir: Subject Two. Below them, a fourth line was covered by a silver strip. Only one word was visible. SUBJECT: The rest was hidden.

Zayn: I tried to lift the strip, but it won't move. Amir: Maybe we need to solve a puzzle. Me: Maybe we need to stop touching supernatural objects. Amir: That's never stopped us before. Me: AND LOOK WHERE WE ARE. A new notification appeared in the group chat. It wasn't from Zayn. It wasn't from Amir. It wasn't from any of us. The notebook had somehow sent a message directly into our conversation. > THE ORIGINAL RECORD HAS BEEN RESTORED. Then another. > THREE SUBJECTS IDENTIFIED. Then—

> FOURTH SUBJECT: ACCESS DENIED. I stared at the screen. Amir: Access denied? Me: That's not creepy at all. Zayn: There's another message. The typing indicator appeared. One letter at a time, a new sentence formed. > THE FOURTH SUBJECT IS NOT MISSING. My heart began pounding. The sentence continued. > THE FOURTH SUBJECT IS WATCHING. Nobody typed. Nobody joked. Nobody even sent a meme. Then the final message appeared. > AND THEY KNOW YOU HAVE STARTED REMEMBERING.

The screen went black. For three seconds, I could see my own reflection. Then four silver dots appeared. One. Two. Three. Four. A voice whispered through my headphones. "You found the others." I stopped breathing for a moment. The voice continued. "Now find me." The screen returned to normal. The group chat exploded. Amir: YAYA TELL ME YOU HEARD THAT. Me: I HEARD IT.

Zayn: I KNOW THAT VOICE. My fingers froze over the keyboard. Me: From your dreams? A long pause. Then Zayn replied. Zayn: No. Another pause. Zayn: From when I was a child. I stared at his message. Then he sent one final line. Zayn: I think I know who the fourth subject is. I leaned toward the screen. Me: WHO? The typing indicator appeared. Disappeared. Appeared again.

Finally, Zayn sent his reply. Zayn: I can't remember their name. Then the notebook sent one last message. > CHAPTER TWO OF THE MEMORY PROJECT BEGINS NOW. I stared at those words. And for the first time since this whole mystery began, I wasn't just curious. I was worried. Because the fourth person wasn't simply waiting for us to remember them. They had been watching us remember. And somewhere out there, someone knew exactly who we used to be. To be continued…

Chapter 19

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 19: The Voice Behind Subject Zero

“You found the others. Now find me.” Scene 1 — THE GROUP CHAT HAS OFFICIALLY LOST

ITS MIND I woke up to seventeen notifications. Seventeen. At this point, my phone wasn't a communication device. It was a supernatural alarm system with terrible battery management. I opened the Survivors' Alliance group chat. Amir: EVERYONE ONLINE. NOW. Me: Good morning to you too, sunshine. Amir: YAYA, THIS IS NOT A JOKE. Me: Bro, you used seventeen capital letters before breakfast. Everything is a joke until proven otherwise. Zayn: I remembered something else.

I sat up immediately. Me: What? Zayn: The voice from last night. I remember hearing it when I was younger. Amir: WHERE? Zayn: I don't know exactly. I remember a silver room, a circular table, and someone standing behind a glass door. Me: Could you see their face? Zayn: No. But I remember what they said. Another message appeared. Zayn: "If you ever forget us, follow the infinity." I stared at the screen. The infinity symbol. The four dots. The silver circle. The notebook.

Everything kept connecting to that same symbol. Me: Zayn, did you remember anything about the fourth person? Zayn: Just one thing. Amir: SAY IT, BRO. MY CURIOSITY IS DOING PARKOUR. Zayn: They called me by another name. I waited. Me: What name? Zayn: I still can't remember it. I fell backward onto my pillow. Me: OUR MYSTERY HAS A MYSTERY INSIDE THE MYSTERY. Amir: IT'S A MYSTERY LASAGNA. Me: That's the stupidest thing you've ever said. Amir: Thank you. Then Zayn sent another message. Zayn: There's something written on the notebook's last page.

A photograph arrived. The page was completely black except for a silver sentence. > THE VOICE BELONGS TO SOMEONE WHO KNEW YOU BEFORE THE PROMISE. I stopped smiling. Someone who knew us before the promise? Before the Infinity Three? Before our memories disappeared? Who could that possibly be? Then the page changed. > THE SECOND MEMORY WILL RETURN AT SCHOOL. Amir: FINALLY. A LOCATION. Me: It literally says school. That's not exactly a treasure map. Amir: I'M TAKING THE WIN. I put on my school uniform.

Something told me this was going to be a very long day. And I hadn't even done my homework. Scene 2 — THREE BOYS, SIX THEORIES, ZERO

BRAIN CELLS When I arrived at school, Amir was already waiting near the entrance. He had a notebook of his own. A normal notebook. At least, I hoped it was normal. Me: Why are you carrying that? Amir: Investigation notes. Me: You made investigation notes? Amir: Of course. He opened it proudly. The first page read: THE FOURTH PERSON: SUSPECT LIST 1. A mysterious former friend.

2. A secret football coach. 3. Someone who owes us money. 4. An interdimensional football referee. 5. A person who stole Yaya's missing maths book. I stared at him. Me: Number five is actually a serious crime. Amir: I KNEW IT. Zayn approached us, carrying his own notebook carefully. He looked better than yesterday, but there was still a worried expression on his face. Me: How are you feeling? Zayn: Better. Still confused. Me: Same. I've been confused since Year 7. Amir: I've been confused since birth. Me: Finally, something we can agree on. We headed toward the classroom. Lara, Avinia, and Violetta were waiting for us. Lara immediately noticed the notebook in my hand.

Lara: Please tell me that's not another supernatural notebook. Me: No. This one belongs to Amir. Lara: Somehow, that's more concerning. Amir: HEY! Violetta turned to Zayn. Violetta: Did you remember anything else? Zayn shook his head. Zayn: Not the name. But I remember that the voice sounded worried. Violetta:

Worried about you? Zayn: Maybe. Or worried about all of us. Lara crossed her arms thoughtfully. Lara: What if the fourth person wasn't trying to hide from you? What if they were trying to keep something away from you? Me: Like what? Lara: Something they thought you weren't ready to

know. Amir slowly closed his notebook. Amir: That would explain why the fourth subject is locked. Me: Or the notebook has terrible security. Avinia: Yaya. Me: What? It's a valid possibility. Zayn looked down at his notebook. Zayn: I don't think the fourth person wanted us to forget them. Me: Why? He opened the cover and pointed to the original record. Zayn: Because someone deliberately preserved this. The messages. The symbols. The memories. Someone wanted us to find our way back. I looked at the page. He might have been right. Maybe this wasn't a mystery designed to confuse

us. Maybe it was a trail someone had left behind. A trail that would lead us back to a promise we'd made long ago. The classroom bell rang. Amir: Operation Find the Fourth Person begins after lessons. Me: What happened to Operation Find the Girl? Amir: Different season, bro. Me: OUR LIVES HAVE SEASONS NOW?! Lara: Apparently, and you're still the main character. I gave her a confident grin. Me: Finally, some respect. Lara: Don't get used to it. Fair enough. Scene 3 — THE SECOND MEMORY AWAKENS

During our first lesson, Zayn's notebook began

vibrating inside his bag. He tried to ignore it. The notebook vibrated again. Then again. Finally, he quietly pulled it out beneath his desk. A silver line had appeared across the cover. He opened it. His expression changed immediately. He slid the notebook toward me. Written on the page were six words. > THE SECOND MEMORY BEGINS WITH A QUESTION. I leaned closer. Me: What question? The ink moved. > WHO WAS THE FIRST TO RETURN? I frowned.

Me: Return from where? Zayn shook his head. Zayn: I don't know. The notebook turned to another page. A memory appeared in words. > THREE CHILDREN STOOD BESIDE A SILVER CIRCLE. > ONE WAS AFRAID. > ONE WAS CRYING. > ONE PROMISED TO COME BACK. I stared at the page. Me: Zayn, do you remember any of this? He looked pale. Zayn: The silver circle. Me: What about the children? Zayn: I remember standing beside someone. They were holding my hand.

His fingers tightened around the edge of the desk. Zayn: I think I was the one who was afraid. The notebook continued. > THE FIRST TO RETURN WAS NOT THE FIRST TO LEAVE. Me: That's not confusing at all. Zayn: Wait. He looked at the page more closely. Zayn: It says the first to return. Not the first to come back. Me: Is there a difference? Zayn: Maybe returning meant something specific to us. Before I could answer, the writing vanished. The notebook closed by itself. Our teacher turned toward us. Teacher: Yahya. Zayn. Is there something you'd like to share with the class?

I immediately sat upright. Me: Yes, miss. The importance of paying attention. Teacher: Excellent. Then perhaps you can explain what we just covered. My brain went completely blank. The notebook had just given me a supernatural riddle, and somehow that was still easier than answering a school question. Me: The importance of... attention? Amir covered his mouth. Lara stared at her desk. Zayn looked like he wanted to disappear. Our teacher sighed. Teacher: Please pay attention, Yahya. Me: Yes, miss. I sat down. Amir, whispering: Legendary academic performance.

Me, whispering: I will remember this betrayal. Scene 4 — THE ARCHIVE ROOM

After lessons, we asked the teacher who had organised the old football showcase whether we could inspect more of the event records. She led us to a small archive room near the sports office. It smelled like paper, cardboard, and forgotten school projects. Basically, a museum of homework. Teacher: The showcase was several years ago. Some photographs are in these boxes. I can't promise you'll find anything useful. Me: That's okay, miss. We're looking for something specific. Amir: A mysterious person connected to an unexplained

symbol and possibly a supernatural memory project. Everyone looked at him. Amir: Or, you know, a photograph. I elbowed him.

Me: A photograph, miss. She handed us a box of printed pictures and left us to search, reminding us to put everything back properly. We spread the photographs across a table. There were pictures of football matches, award ceremonies, school performances, and students holding certificates. Then I found it. The photograph from my Infinite Instinct Phantom showcase. I recognised myself immediately. There I was, standing on the field with a football at my feet, looking like I was about to announce the final episode of an anime. Amir leaned over my shoulder. Amir: Bro, why are you posing like you own the stadium? Me: Confidence. Amir: Delusion.

Me: Same thing in football. Zayn took the photograph carefully. He examined the background. The partly obscured person was still there. Silver wristband. Notebook. The infinity symbol with four dots. But this time, we noticed something else. A second person stood behind them. Almost completely hidden by the edge of the photograph. Only one hand was visible. And around that hand was a thin silver band with a tiny mark. A zero. Zayn went completely still. Me: Zayn?

He pointed at the mark. Zayn: That's the same symbol I saw in my dream. Amir: The zero? Zayn nodded. Zayn: I saw it on someone's wrist. I couldn't read anything else. I studied the photograph. Me: Wait. If the person holding the notebook had the infinity symbol, and the person behind them had the zero... Amir: Then we might be looking at two different people. Violetta, who had been examining the photograph from the other side, nodded. Violetta: And one of them could be connected to Subject Zero. Avinia: Or the zero could mean something else. We shouldn't assume we know what it means yet. She was right.

We had a photograph, a symbol, and a pile of theories. Not exactly enough evidence to arrest anyone. Although Amir's suspect list might have been enough to arrest his imagination. Then Lara noticed the back of the photograph. Lara: Yaya, look. Three words were written in faded silver ink. THREE. ONE. RETURN. We'd seen them before. But beneath them, almost invisible, was another line. A line we'd missed in the earlier chapters of this mystery. I tilted the photograph toward the light. The words became clearer. THE FIRST TO RETURN WAS THE ONE WHO NEVER LEFT. My heart skipped.

I looked at Zayn. He was staring at the photograph as if it had just called him by a name he couldn't remember. Zayn: I think that's about me. Me: Why? Zayn: Because I don't remember leaving anyone. He swallowed. Zayn: But the notebook keeps saying I returned. Scene 5 — ZAYN'S MEMORY

We sat in the quiet courtyard while Zayn tried to explain what he remembered. Lara and Violetta sat nearby. Amir was unusually quiet, listening instead of making jokes. Zayn: I remember a room. Me: The silver room? Zayn: Yes. But I remember more now. He looked down at his hands.

Zayn: There was a circular table. Four chairs. And a symbol on the wall. Violetta: The infinity symbol with four dots? Zayn: I think so. He closed his eyes. Zayn: Someone was sitting across from me. I couldn't see their face, but I remember their voice. He paused. Zayn: They asked me, "Are you ready to return?" Nobody interrupted. Zayn: I said no. My stomach tightened. Me: Why? Zayn: I don't know. I was scared. He took a breath. Zayn: Then the person said, "You don't have to be ready today. But one day, they'll need you."

Amir finally spoke. Amir: Who? Zayn shook his head. Zayn: I can't remember. The notebook opened on his lap. Silver letters appeared. > THE FIRST TO RETURN WAS ZAYN. We stared at the message. Then another sentence appeared. > BUT HE DID NOT RETURN ALONE. Me: What does that mean? The ink shifted. > HE BROUGHT THE MEMORY BACK WITH HIM. Zayn looked up. Zayn: Maybe that's why I keep dreaming about the stadium.

Me: Because you're remembering it? Zayn: Maybe. He turned another page. A new message appeared. > THE FIRST RETURN IS COMPLETE. For one moment, we thought that was it. Then the notebook wrote

something else. > THE SECOND RETURN WILL BEGIN WHEN THE FORGOTTEN NAME IS SPOKEN. I looked at Zayn. Me: Your original name? He nodded slowly. Zayn: I think so. Amir: So we need to figure out your old name. Zayn: Yeah. Amir: Excellent. Easy. Me: You literally have a list of five suspects,

including a person who stole my maths book. Amir: I work best under pressure. Me: YOU WORK BEST UNDER SUPERVISION. Zayn laughed softly. But his smile faded as he looked at the notebook again. Zayn: What if I don't like the person I used to be? I leaned forward. Me: Then we'll get to know that person, too. He looked at me. Me: But you're still Zayn. You're still our bro. Whatever name you had before, it doesn't erase who you are now. Amir nodded. Amir: Facts. You're stuck with us. Zayn: That sounds like a threat. Amir: Friendship is legally binding.

Me: No, it isn't. Amir: IT IS IN MY NOTEBOOK. We all laughed. And for a moment, Zayn looked less afraid. Scene 6 — THE FOURTH HEART

Before we left school, Violetta approached Zayn. She was holding the silver infinity keychain she'd shown us earlier. Four tiny dots glimmered beneath the symbol. Violetta: Zayn, can I show you something? Zayn: Sure. She placed the keychain on the table. Violetta: I've had this for as long as I can remember. I don't know where I got it. Zayn stared at it. Zayn: The same symbol... Violetta: Yeah. But there's something else.

She turned it over. On the back was a tiny inscription. FOUR HEARTS. ONE PROMISE. Nobody spoke. I slowly turned toward Amir. He looked at me. Amir: Don't. Me: I didn't say anything. Amir: Your face said everything. Lara studied the inscription. Lara: The notebook keeps talking about the fourth heart. Maybe this is connected. Avinia: It could be. But having the same symbol doesn't automatically mean Violetta is the fourth person. Violetta: I agree. I don't remember being part of your group. She looked at Zayn.

Violetta: But I want to help you figure it out, if that's okay. Zayn smiled. Zayn: I'd like that. His voice was quiet, but this time he didn't look away. Violetta smiled back. Violetta: Then we'll investigate together. Amir, whispering to me: OPERATION PURPLE HONEY HAS ENTERED THE MYSTERY ARC. Me, whispering: BRO, STOP TURNING EVERYTHING INTO AN OPERATION. Amir: I have a gift. Me: You have a problem. Zayn heard us. Zayn: I CAN STILL HEAR YOU. Me: EXCELLENT HEARING, BRO. Then Violetta's keychain began to glow.

Not brightly. Just a faint silver shimmer. The notebook opened in Zayn's hands. A new message appeared. > THE FOURTH HEART HAS BEEN REMEMBERED. Violetta stepped back in surprise. Violetta: What does that mean? Before anyone could answer, the words disappeared. A new message appeared in their place. > THE FOURTH HEART IS NOT THE FOURTH SUBJECT. I blinked. Me: Hold on. Amir leaned closer. Amir: So the fourth heart and the fourth person might be different? Another sentence appeared.

> ONE REMEMBERS THE PROMISE. ONE REMEMBERS THE PERSON. Zayn stared at the page. Zayn: Which one is Violetta? The notebook didn't answer. Instead, it wrote: > DO NOT CONFUSE THE HEART THAT REMEMBERS WITH THE PERSON WHO RETURNS. Then the page went blank. Violetta looked at the keychain in her palm. Violetta: I think this belonged to someone important. Zayn nodded. Zayn: I think so too. Neither of them claimed to know what it meant. And somehow, that made the mystery even bigger. Scene 7 — THE NAME IN THE DREAM

That night, I sat at my desk with my football

resting beside my chair. I was supposed to be studying. My maths book was open. My pencil was ready. My brain was absolutely not cooperating. Instead, I kept thinking about the photograph. The silver room. The fourth person. Zayn's forgotten name. And the message: The first to return was the one who never left. Eventually, I went to sleep. And the stadium returned. Purple lights. Silver grass. A football floating above the centre circle.

Three silhouettes standing together. And a fourth figure at the edge of the field. This time, I could see the figure's wrist. A silver band. A tiny zero. The figure stepped forward. Mysterious Voice: You're remembering. Me: Who are you? Mysterious Voice: Someone who made a promise. Me: With us? The figure nodded. Mysterious Voice: With all of you. Me: Then why can't we remember you? The stadium lights flickered. Mysterious Voice: Because remembering me means remembering what you promised to protect. I stepped forward.

Me: WHAT DID WE PROMISE TO PROTECT? The figure looked toward the three silhouettes. Mysterious Voice: Each other. I froze. Me: We promised to protect each other? Mysterious Voice: Not just your memories. Not just your friendship. You promised that if one of you became lost, the others would bring them home. The floating football dropped to the grass. The figure extended a hand. Mysterious Voice: You promised that no one would have to return alone. I felt something shift inside my memory. A flash. A silver room. Four chairs. A younger version of me standing beside Amir and

Zayn. A fourth person laughing. Then a voice. My voice. "Even if we forget everything, we'll find each other again." Another voice replied. "And if one of us gets lost?" A third voice answered. "The others will bring them home." Then the memory vanished. I looked at the fourth figure. Me: I remember the promise. The figure nodded. Mysterious Voice: Then you're ready for the next question. Me: Which is?

The figure stepped closer. For the first time, I could almost see their face. Almost. Mysterious Voice: What happens when the person you've been searching for is the one who has been searching for you? The stadium shook. The lights went out. And I woke up. Scene 8 — THE MESSAGE THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING

I grabbed my phone. The time was 6:11 AM. There was a new message from Zayn. Zayn: Yaya. Wake up. I typed immediately. Me: I'M AWAKE. WHAT HAPPENED?

Zayn: I remembered something. Me: YOUR NAME? Zayn: Not yet. Another message arrived. Zayn: But I remember the second oath. I sat completely upright. Me: WHAT IS IT? A photograph appeared. The notebook page was covered in silver writing. > THE FIRST OATH: WE WILL FIND EACH OTHER AGAIN. Then: > THE SECOND OATH: NO ONE WILL RETURN ALONE. I read the words twice. No one will return alone. The promise from my dream. The promise we'd made in the silver room.

The promise that connected us before we even remembered one another. Then Zayn sent another message. Zayn: There's more. The notebook had written a final sentence. > THE SECOND OATH HAS BEEN REMEMBERED. Beneath it, a new line appeared. > THE THIRD MEMORY BELONGS TO THE FOURTH SUBJECT. I stared at the screen. Me: So the fourth subject has to remember something next? Zayn: I think so. Then a final message appeared on the page. Not in silver. In dark blue ink. Different handwriting. Different from every other message we'd seen.

> YAHYA MOHAMED SAMER. My full name. I stopped breathing for a second. The notebook continued. > YOU HAVE KEPT YOUR PROMISE. Then— > NOW KEEP YOUR DISTANCE. I stared at the message. Me: Zayn... what does that mean? No response. I called him. He answered immediately. Zayn: Yaya? Me: Did you write that? Zayn: No. Me: Do you know who did?

Silence. Then he whispered something that made my stomach drop. Zayn: I think I know where I've heard that handwriting before. Me: WHERE? Zayn: In my first dream. I gripped the phone. Zayn: The person behind the glass door was writing something on a wall. Me: What did they write? Zayn's voice trembled slightly. Zayn: I couldn't read the whole sentence. He paused. Zayn: But I remember the last two words. Me: What were they? He took a breath. Zayn: "Stay away."

I looked back at the notebook. The page had changed again. One final sentence appeared. > THE FOURTH SUBJECT HAS RETURNED TO SCHOOL. I stared at those words. School. Our school. The same place

where Zayn had appeared in my dream before I met him. The same place where we'd formed the Survivors' Alliance. The same place where someone had apparently been waiting for us. I opened the group chat and typed one message. Me: Survivors' Alliance. Emergency meeting. Today. Amir replied almost instantly. Amir: BRO IT IS 6 AM.

Me: THE FOURTH SUBJECT IS AT SCHOOL. Three dots appeared. Then— Amir: I'M GETTING DRESSED. Zayn sent one last message. Zayn: Yaya? Me: Yeah? Zayn: What if the fourth subject has been standing beside us this whole time? I looked toward my bedroom window. The sun was rising. Somewhere beyond it, the school day was about to begin. And for the first time, I had a terrifying thought. What if the fourth subject wasn't hiding in the shadows? What if we'd already spoken to them?

What if they knew our names, our faces, and our promise? And what if they were about to walk into school like it was just another ordinary day? I grabbed my bag. Because today, we weren't just searching for the fourth subject. Today, we were going to find out why someone had warned me to stay away. TO BE CONTINUED…

Chapter 20

A BOY IN A GIRL PARADE ARMY Chapter 20: The Confession, the Kiss, and the

30-Minute WORLD RECORD?!

“One mystery is getting darker. One friendship is getting stronger. And one socially awkward gamer is about to pull the greatest rizz of his entire existence.” Scene 1 — EMERGENCY MEETING: THE FOURTH

SUBJECT IS AMONG US I arrived at school ready for battle. Football? Ready. Backpack? Ready. Survivors' Alliance? Ready. Brain cells? Approximately two. Amir was waiting at the entrance with a juice box. Me: Bro. We're investigating a potentially dangerous mystery, and you brought juice? Amir: Hydration is essential to detective work.

Me: Fair enough. Zayn arrived a few seconds later, carrying his mysterious notebook. He looked nervous. Not his usual I have no idea how to talk to Violetta nervous. This was different. Me: Bro, what's wrong? Zayn: Nothing. Amir: That is the universal language for SOMETHING IS DEFINITELY WRONG. Zayn: I'm fine. Me: Zayn, you're holding your notebook upside down. He looked down. It was, in fact, upside down. Zayn:... I knew that. Amir: SURE, SUBJECT ZERO.

Zayn corrected the notebook and sighed. Zayn: I was thinking about Violetta. Amir and I exchanged a look. Oh. OH. Me: BRO. Amir: BROOOOOOO. Zayn: Don't start. Me: YOU'RE GOING TO CONFESS?! Zayn: I didn't say that! Amir: YOUR NOTEBOOK IS UPSIDE DOWN, YOUR HAIR IS IN SURVIVAL MODE, AND YOU JUST SAID HER NAME LIKE IT'S THE TITLE OF YOUR FAVOURITE ANIME. Me: HE'S COOKED. Zayn: I'M LEAVING. I grabbed his shoulder. Me: Wait. Seriously, bro. Do you want to tell her how you feel?

Zayn looked down at his shoes. Zayn: Yeah. I think I do. For once, Amir and I stopped joking. Zayn had spent ages trying to find the right words. He'd been scared of embarrassing himself, scared of changing their friendship, and scared that his feelings were somehow connected to the supernatural mystery. But Violetta had been kind to him. She listened. She laughed at his jokes—even the terrible ones. And she'd chosen to help him because she wanted to, not because some creepy notebook told her to. Me: Then tell her because it's what you want. Not because of the notebook. Amir: And don't make her feel like she has to say yes. Zayn: I know. Me: Whatever she says, we'll have your back.

Zayn smiled. Zayn: Thanks, guys. Amir raised his juice box. Amir: TO LOVE, FRIENDSHIP, AND EXTREMELY QUESTIONABLE NOTEBOOKS! Me: BRO, IT'S 7:30 IN THE MORNING. Amir: ROMANCE HAS NO OFFICE HOURS. Unfortunately, he had a point. Scene 2 — OPERATION PURPLE HONEY: FINAL

MISSION At lunch, Lara, Avinia, and Violetta joined us in the courtyard. Lara sat beside me. Lara: Why do you look like you're hiding a secret? Me: Because Amir has been acting like a wedding planner since breakfast. Amir: I HAVE A GIFT. Avinia: You made a spreadsheet, didn't you?

Amir slowly put his phone away. Avinia: Amir. Amir: It was colour-coded. Me: THERE WERE SPREADSHEETS?! Violetta looked confused. Violetta: What are you all talking about? Zayn nearly dropped his water bottle. Zayn: Nothing! Violetta raised an eyebrow. Violetta: Okay...? Lara leaned toward me. Lara, whispering: He's going to confess, isn't he? Me, whispering: I think so. Lara: That's actually sweet. Me: I know. Our little Mainframe is becoming a functioning human.

Zayn: I CAN HEAR YOU, YAYA. Me: EXCELLENT. YOUR HEARING IS EVOLVING TOO. Violetta laughed. Zayn looked at her. Then, instead of immediately looking away, he held her gaze for a moment. Small progress. Massive achievement. Somewhere, an imaginary anime narrator announced: ZAYN THE MAINFRAME HAS UNLOCKED: EYE CONTACT LEVEL 2. Amir: Bro, at this rate, you'll unlock conversation by 2034. Zayn: Amir, I will delete your save file. Me: THAT'S MY BOY. But then Zayn took a breath. Zayn: Violetta? Could I talk to you privately for a minute? Somewhere quiet?

She studied his expression. Violetta: Sure. Is everything okay? Zayn: Yeah. I just want to tell you something. Violetta: Okay. They walked toward a quieter part of the courtyard, where a few benches sat beneath a tree. Amir watched them leave. Then he slowly turned toward me. Amir: It's happening. Me: It's happening. Amir: OUR BOY IS ABOUT TO ENTER THE ROMANCE ARC. Me: BRO, KEEP YOUR VOICE DOWN. Lara shook her head, smiling. Lara: You two are worse than the actual couple. Me: We're providing emotional support. Avinia: You're providing a live commentary

service nobody requested. Amir: FIVE STARS. VERY PROFESSIONAL. Scene 3 — ZAYN'S CONFESSION

Meanwhile, beneath the tree... Zayn stood in front of Violetta, trying to organise his thoughts. He had rehearsed this conversation approximately forty-seven times. In the shower. In his bedroom. In his dreams. Once while brushing his teeth. Every rehearsal had gone perfectly. Now his brain had left the building. Violetta: You look nervous. Zayn: I am. Violetta: Is it about the notebook?

Zayn: No. Well, partly. But mostly... it's about you. Violetta blinked. Violetta: Me? Zayn nodded. Zayn: Yeah. He took a breath. Zayn: When I first arrived at school, everything felt strange. I didn't understand why I was having those dreams, why the notebook knew things I didn't remember, or why Yaya and Amir somehow felt familiar. Violetta: I remember. You looked like you were about to run away from the entire school. Zayn: I seriously considered it. She laughed softly. Zayn: But then I started talking to you. He looked down for a moment, then back at her. Zayn: You're clever, you're funny, and you listen to me even when I don't make much sense. You make

things feel a little less confusing. Violetta's expression softened. Zayn: I don't know what the notebook means by the fourth heart. I don't know who I was before I became Zayn. And I don't know what I'll remember tomorrow. He paused. Zayn: But I know how I feel about you right now. Violetta remained quiet, giving him time. Zayn: I like you, Violetta. Not because of some mysterious prophecy. Not because a notebook told me to. I like you because you're you. He let out a nervous laugh. Zayn: And I wanted you to know. You don't have to feel the same way. I just didn't want to keep pretending I was completely normal every time you talked to me. Violetta smiled. Violetta: Zayn... He prepared himself for absolutely anything.

A rejection. A friendship speech. A lecture about supernatural notebooks. Possibly a meteor. Instead, she stepped a little closer. Violetta: I like you too. Zayn froze. Zayn: Wait. Violetta: I like you too. Zayn: Sorry. I need to confirm something. Violetta: What? Zayn: You said... you like me? Violetta laughed. Violetta: YES, ZAYN. Zayn: Oh. He stared at the ground.

Then at the tree. Then at the sky. Zayn: OH. Violetta: Are you okay? Zayn: I THINK MY ENTIRE OPERATING SYSTEM JUST RESTARTED. She burst out laughing. Violetta: You're so ridiculous. Zayn: I have been told. Then his expression became softer. Zayn: Can I ask you something? Violetta: Sure. Zayn: Would it be okay if I kissed you? Violetta smiled warmly. Violetta: Yes. They leaned closer and shared a gentle, ageappropriate kiss.

And just like that, Zayn the Mainframe had achieved something his notebook couldn't predict. A real moment. A real choice. A feeling that belonged entirely to them. Neither of them noticed the tiny silver infinity symbol appearing on the notebook inside Zayn's bag. Not yet. Scene 4 — BRO. WHERE ARE THEY?!

Back at our table, Amir was pacing. Amir: It's been three minutes. Me: Bro, you have the patience of a microwave. Amir: I AM INVESTED. Lara: Let them have some privacy. Amir: I AM PRIVATELY INVESTED. Avinia: That's not better. I checked the time.

Me: Zayn's probably just talking to her. Amir: Talking? He looked genuinely offended. Amir: BRO CONFESSED HIS FEELINGS. THIS IS A HISTORICAL EVENT. Me: Should we give them space? Lara gave me a look. Lara: Yes. Me: Right. Obviously. Privacy. Boundaries. Respect. Absolutely. Amir nodded. Amir: Agreed. We all sat down. For about twelve seconds. Then Amir stood up again. Amir: I WONDER IF— Avinia: SIT.

He sat. I looked at Lara. Me: This is the hardest mission we've ever completed. Lara: You're not even doing anything. Me: EXACTLY. THAT'S WHY IT'S HARD. We waited. And waited. And— Amir: THEY'VE BEEN GONE FOR TEN MINUTES. Me: AMIR, WE ARE NOT TIMING THEM. Amir: I'M NOT TIMING THEM. I'M TRACKING THE PROGRESSION OF A HISTORIC ROMANTIC EVENT. Avinia: You're timing them. Amir: I plead the fifth. Me: We're Egyptian, bro. What fifth? Nobody answered.

Even Amir knew that joke had failed. Then we saw them walking back toward us. Zayn looked dazed. Violetta looked happy. They were holding hands. I slowly stood up. Amir slowly stood up. Lara closed her eyes like she already knew what was coming. Me: BRO. Amir: BROOOOOOOOO. Zayn: Don't. Me: YOU DID IT?! Zayn: Yes. Amir: YOU CONFESSED?! Zayn: YES.

Me: AND SHE SAID YES?! Zayn: YES, YAYA! I grabbed Amir by the shoulders. Me: OUR BOY HAS EVOLVED! Amir: MAINFRAME ROMANCE UPDATE INSTALLED! Zayn covered his face. Zayn: I regret telling you anything. Violetta: I think they're happy for you. Zayn: They're going to be unbearable. Me: CORRECT. Lara took my hand and smiled at Zayn. Lara: Congratulations, you two. Seriously. Avinia smiled too. Avinia: We're happy for you. Violetta squeezed Zayn's hand. Violetta: Thanks.

For once, the notebook didn't interrupt. No ominous message. No mysterious voice. No supernatural plot twist. Just two people who liked each other. Honestly? That was a pretty good plot twist. Scene 5 — THE THIRTY-MINUTE WORLD RECORD?!

■ Now, before I continue, we need to discuss something extremely important. A historical event. A legendary achievement. A statistic that would make every sports commentator in Egypt drop their microphone. Amir: Wait. He looked at Zayn and Violetta. Then at me.

Then back at them. Amir: How long were you two actually gone? Zayn frowned. Zayn: I don't know. Why? Amir checked his phone. His eyes widened. Amir: NO WAY. Me: What? Amir: BRO. He turned the screen toward us. Amir: THIRTY MINUTES. I nearly fell off the bench. Me: THIRTY?! Amir: THIRTY WHOLE MINUTES! Zayn: Wait, what?! Violetta: Seriously?

Amir began pacing in circles. Amir: I'M SORRY. I'M NOT TRYING TO INTRUDE. I'M JUST SAYING— Me: WE HAD A RECORD! Amir: OUR RECORD! Lara covered her face. Lara: Oh no. Avinia: Here we go. I stood up as dramatically as possible. Me: Ladies and gentlemen, students and teachers, football fans and people who accidentally opened this conversation— Lara: Yaya, please don't make an announcement. Me: —I regret to inform you that the record

previously held by me and Amir has been BROKEN.

Amir: BY OUR OWN TEAMMATE. Me: ZAYN THE MAINFRAME. Amir: THE ROMANCE UPDATE HAS DESTROYED OUR LEAD.

Zayn: YOU TWO ARE MAKING THIS SO WEIRD! Violetta was laughing so hard she had to hold Zayn's arm. Violetta: What record are they even talking about? Zayn looked like he was seriously considering transferring schools. Zayn: I don't know anymore. Me: THIRTY MINUTES, BRO. THIRTY. Amir: We have been dethroned. Me: Our legacy is finished. Amir: Our dynasty is over. Me: Our football careers are in ruins. Lara: You are both being ridiculous. Me: We are grieving. Avinia: You're celebrating. Amir: GRIEVING JOYFULLY.

I shook Zayn's hand with exaggerated seriousness. Me: Congratulations, bro. You have officially broken the Yaya-and-Amir record. Zayn: Can I please just enjoy being happy? I stopped joking for a moment. Then I grinned. Me: Of course, bro. I pulled him into a quick, friendly hug. Amir joined in. Amir: I'M PROUD OF YOU, MY MAINFRAME. Zayn: I CAN'T BREATHE— Me: THAT'S BECAUSE AMIR HUGS LIKE A SECURITY GUARD. Amir: IT'S CALLED BROTHERHOOD. We finally let him go. Violetta took his hand again. And I noticed something.

Zayn wasn't looking at the notebook. He wasn't worrying about the fourth subject. He wasn't trying to remember who he'd been. For those few minutes, he was simply Zayn. A boy who'd confessed to the girl he liked. And a boy who'd received the answer he'd hoped for. That was worth celebrating. Even if he had absolutely destroyed our imaginary world record. Scene 6 — LARA VS. THE RECORD HOLDERS

Later, Lara pulled me aside. Lara: So. Me: So. Lara: You and Amir had a record? I immediately realised I'd made a terrible mistake. Me: Technically—

Lara: Yaya. Me: It was a joke. Lara: What kind of record? I scratched the back of my head. Me: The kind of record that should never have been mentioned in public. She stared at me. Then she burst out laughing. Lara: YOU TWO ARE IMPOSSIBLE. Me: Finally, someone recognises our talent. She nudged my shoulder. Lara: I'm happy for Zayn. He was so nervous about telling her. Me: Yeah. I'm proud of him. Lara: You helped him. I shrugged. Me: I just told him to be honest and respect her

answer. Lara: That's important. She took my hand. Lara: And you know you can talk to me honestly too, right? Me: Of course. She smiled. Lara: Good. We walked together toward the football field. Me: You know, I'm starting to think the notebook is going to get jealous. Lara: Of what? Me: Zayn's romance arc. It finally has a happy ending, and the notebook hasn't even interrupted once. Lara laughed. Lara: Don't jinx it. I stopped walking.

Me: Lara. Lara: What? Me: You should never say that in a supernatural mystery. A strange breeze crossed the field. We looked at each other. Then we both looked toward the school building. Me:... You jinxed it. Lara: I DIDN'T DO ANYTHING! For the record, she absolutely jinxed it. Scene 7 — THE NOTEBOOK'S WEDDING GIFT

That afternoon, Zayn sat with Violetta on a bench near the field. They were talking about ordinary things. Favourite games. Music. School.

Whether Amir was always like this. Violetta: So, does he always announce everything like a football commentator? Zayn: Worse. Violetta: Worse? Zayn: You haven't seen him discover a new meme. Violetta laughed. Zayn smiled. Then he remembered something. Zayn: There's something I want to tell you. Violetta: What is it? Zayn: I still don't understand the notebook. I might remember things I don't expect. And I don't

know how much of my past is connected to this. He paused. Zayn: I don't want you to feel like you have to be involved just because we like each other. Violetta looked at him thoughtfully.

Violetta: I appreciate that. She held up her silver infinity keychain. Violetta: I want to help because I want to. But we can take things slowly. We don't have to solve every mystery today. Zayn smiled. Zayn: I'd like that. They shared another gentle kiss. Then Zayn's bag began vibrating. They both stared at it. Violetta: Please tell me that's your phone. Zayn: I wish. He opened his bag and pulled out the notebook. The pages were turning by themselves. FLIP. FLIP. FLIP. They stopped at a fresh page. Silver letters appeared.

> THE FOURTH HEART HAS CHOSEN TO REMEMBER. Zayn frowned. Zayn: Violetta, did you do anything? Violetta: I was sitting here! Another line appeared. > THE MEMORY IS NOT A LOVE STORY. I arrived just in time to read it. Me: EXCUSE ME?! Amir appeared behind me. Amir: THE NOTEBOOK HAS OPINIONS ABOUT ROMANCE?! Lara and Avinia followed us. The notebook continued writing. > THE LOVE IS REAL. THE MEMORY IS OLDER. Violetta looked at Zayn. Violetta: What does that mean? Zayn shook his head.

Zayn: I don't know. Then the page changed again. > THE FOURTH HEART HAS REMEMBERED THE FIRST SONG. Me: First song? Amir: What song? The notebook didn't answer. Instead, a series of musical notes appeared beneath the message. Violetta stared at them. Her expression changed. Zayn: Violetta? She looked confused. Violetta: I know that melody. We all turned toward her. Me: You do? She nodded slowly. Violetta: I don't know where I've heard it. But I

remember humming it when I was younger. Zayn looked down at the page. Zayn: Can you hum it? Violetta hesitated. Then she quietly hummed the melody. The second she finished, the notebook flashed silver. A hidden page opened. On it was an old drawing of four children standing around a circle. Three held footballs. The fourth held a small music box. Beneath the drawing were four names. YAHYA. AMIR. ZAYN. And the fourth name—

Was still covered by a black strip. But this time, the notebook added a new message. > THE FOURTH SUBJECT DID NOT FORGET THE SONG. Then: > THE SONG WILL LEAD YOU TO THE ORIGINAL PROMISE. Zayn stared at the drawing. Zayn: Four children... Amir leaned closer. Amir: Three footballs. One music box. I looked at the fourth figure. Me: Maybe the music box is what we promised to protect. Lara nodded. Lara: That would explain why the notebook keeps talking about protecting something. Violetta looked at the drawing again. Violetta: And maybe the song is connected to the fourth subject.

Then, beneath the drawing, one final sentence appeared. > THE FOURTH SUBJECT WILL BE REVEALED WHEN THE SONG IS PLAYED AGAIN. I grinned. Me: FINALLY. A CLUE WE CAN ACTUALLY USE. Amir raised his fist. Amir: OPERATION FIND THE FOURTH SUBJECT IS BACK! Me: It never left. Amir: LIKE THE FOURTH SUBJECT! We all stared at him. Amir: Sorry. That was actually pretty good. Unfortunately... It was. Scene 8 — THE MESSAGE AT 11:11 PM

That night, I was lying in bed when Zayn sent a message.

Zayn: Yaya, are you awake? Me: No. I'm texting in my sleep. Zayn: Serious question. Me: I'm listening. Zayn: Today was the happiest I've felt since I arrived at school. I smiled. Me: You deserve it, bro. Zayn: Thanks for helping me. Me: Anytime. Zayn: And... I think I'm finally ready to remember who I was. I sat up. Me: Are you sure? Zayn: Not completely. But I don't want fear to make every decision for me. I stared at his message. Me: Whatever happens, you won't return alone.

Zayn: The second oath. Me: Exactly. A few seconds passed. Then Zayn sent a photograph. The notebook lay open on his desk. A new message was written across the page. > THE THIRD MEMORY IS READY. My heart started racing. Then another line appeared. > THE SONG HAS BEEN REMEMBERED. And finally— >

THE FOURTH SUBJECT WILL RETURN TOMORROW. I immediately messaged the group. Me: EVERYONE. EMERGENCY MEETING TOMORROW MORNING. Amir: WHAT NOW?! Me: THE FOURTH SUBJECT IS RETURNING.

Amir: FINALLY. Lara: Is everyone safe? Me: As far as we know. Avinia: Then we'll investigate together. Violetta: I'll bring the keychain. Zayn: And I'll bring the notebook. Amir: I'LL BRING SNACKS. Me: WHY ARE YOU LIKE THIS?! Amir: PREPARATION IS KEY. I put my phone down. For the first time in days, I felt hopeful. Zayn had confessed to Violetta. Violetta had chosen to be with him. The second oath had returned. And we'd finally discovered a clue that might lead us to the fourth subject.

Maybe tomorrow, we'd finally learn the truth. Then my phone vibrated one more time. An unknown number. One message. Unknown: Yahya. Don't let Zayn open the notebook tomorrow. I stared at the screen. A second message arrived. Unknown: The third memory doesn't show you who you were. I swallowed. The final message appeared. Unknown: It shows you who you betrayed. My smile vanished. Across the room, the four silver dots appeared again. And from somewhere beyond my window, I heard the melody Violetta had hummed.

Only this time... There were five notes instead of four. TO BE CONTINUED…